



सत्यमेव जयते

13 YEAR WISE

**UPSC CIVIL SERVICES
IAS MAINS**

GENERAL STUDIES

TOPIC-WISE-ANALYSIS GS MAINS QUESTIONS
(2025 - 2013)

- GENERAL STUDIES 1 - INDIAN HERITAGE AND CULTURE, HISTORY AND GEOGRAPHY OF THE WORLD, SOCIETY
- GENERAL STUDIES 2 - GOVERNANCE, CONSTITUTION, POLITY, SOCIAL JUSTICE, INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS
- GENERAL STUDIES 3 - TECHNOLOGY, ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT , BIODIVERSITY, ENVIRONMENT, SECURITY, DISASTER MANAGEMENT
- GENERAL STUDIES 4 - ETHICS INTEGRITY APTITUDE

General Studies 1:

INDIAN CULTURE WILL COVER THE SALIENT ASPECTS OF ART FORMS, LITERATURE AND ARCHITECTURE FROM ANCIENT TO MODERN TIMES.

1. Discuss the salient features of the Harappan architecture. 2025 (Answer in 150 words) 10
2. Examine the main aspects of Akbar's religious syncretism. 2025 (Answer in 150 words) 10
3. 'The sculptors filled the Chandella artform with resilient vigor and breadth of life.' Elucidate. 2025 (Answer in 150 words) 10.
4. Underline the changes in the field of society and economy from the Rig Vedic to the later Vedic period. 2024 (10 M)
5. Estimate the contribution of Pallavas of Kanchi for the development of art and literature of South India. 2024 (10 M)
6. What were the events that led to Quit India Movement? Point out its results. 2024 (10 M)
7. "Though the great Cholas are no more yet their name is still remembered with great pride because of their highest achievements in the domain of art and architecture". Comment. 2024 (15 M)
8. Explain the role of geographical factors towards the development of Ancient India. 2023 (10 M)
9. What are the main features of Vedic society and religion? Do you think some of the features are still prevailing in Indian society? 2023 (15 M)
10. What were the major technological changes introduced during the Sultanate period? How did those technological changes influence the Indian society? 2023 (15 M)
11. How will you explain the medieval Indian temple sculptures represent the social life of those days? 2022 (10 M)
12. Discuss the main contributions of Gupta period and Chola period to Indian heritage and culture. 2022 (15 M)
13. Discuss the significance of the lion and bull figures in Indian mythology, art and architecture. 2022 (15 M)
14. Evaluate the nature of the Bhakti Literature and its contribution to Indian culture. 2021
15. Indian Philosophy and tradition played a significant role in conceiving and shaping the monuments and their art in India. Discuss. 2020
16. Persian literary sources of medieval India reflect the spirit of the age. Comment 2020
17. The rock-cut architecture represents one of the most important sources of our knowledge of early Indian art and history. Discuss. 2020
18. Pala period is the most significant phase in the history of Buddhism in India. Enumerate. 2020

19. Highlight the Central Asian and Greco -Bactrian elements in Gandhara art. 2019
20. Safeguarding the Indian art heritage is the need of the moment. Discuss 2018
21. Assess the importance of the accounts of the Chinese and Arab travelers in thereconstruction of the history of India. 2018
22. The Bhakti movement received a remarkable re-orientation with the advent of SriChaitanya Mahaprabhu. Discuss. 2018
23. How do you justify the view that the level of excellence of Gupta numismatic art is not atall noticeable in later times? 2017
24. Early Buddhist Stupa-art, while depicting folk motifs and narratives successfullyexpounds Buddhist ideals. Elucidate. 2016
25. Krishnadeva Raya, the King of Vijayanagar, was not only an accomplished scholarhimself but was also a great patron of learning and literature. Discuss. 2016
26. The ancient civilization in Indian sub-continent differed from those of Egypt, Mesopotamia and Greece in that its culture and traditions have been preserved without abreakdown to the present day. Comment. 2015
27. Mesolithic rock cut architecture of India not only reflects the cultural life of the timesbut also a tine aesthetic sense comparable to modem painting. Critically evaluate this comment. 2015
28. To what extent has the urban planning and culture of the Indus Valley Civilizationprovided inputs to the present-day urbanization? Discuss. 2014
29. Gandhara sculpture owed as much to the Romans as to the Greeks. Explain. 2014
30. Taxila university was one of the oldest universities of the world with which were associated a number of renowned learned personalities of different disciplines. Its strategic location caused its fame to flourish, but unlike Nalanda, it is not considered as a university inthe modern sense. Discuss. 2014
31. Sufis and medieval mystic saints failed to modify either the religious ideas and practicesor the outward structure of Hindu / Muslim societies to any appreciable extent. Comment. 2014
32. Though not very useful from the point of view of a connected political history of SouthIndia, the Sangam literature portrays the social and economic conditions of its time with remarkable vividness. Comment. 2013
33. Discuss the Tandava dance as recorded in the early Indian inscriptions. 2013
34. Chola architecture represents a high watermark in the evolution of temple architecture.Discuss. 2013

MODERN INDIAN HISTORY FROM ABOUT THE MIDDLE OF THE EIGHTEENTH CENTURY UNTIL THE PRESENT- SIGNIFICANT EVENTS, PERSONALITIES, ISSUES; THE FREEDOM STRUGGLE – ITS VARIOUS STAGES AND IMPORTANT CONTRIBUTORS /CONTRIBUTIONS FROM DIFFERENT PARTS OF THE COUNTRY.

1. Mahatma Jotirao Phule's writings and efforts of social reforms touched issues of almost all subaltern classes. Discuss. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. The ethos of civil service in India stand for the combination of professionalism with nationalistic consciousness – Elucidate. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
3. What was the difference between Mahatma Gandhi and Rabindranath Tagore in their approach towards education and nationalism? 2023 (10 M)
4. How did the colonial rule affect the tribals in India and what was the tribal response to the colonial oppression? 2023 (15 M)
5. Why was there a sudden spurt in famines in colonial India since the mid-eighteenth century? Give reasons. 2022 (10 M)
6. To what extent did the role of the moderates prepare a base for the wider freedom movement? Comment. 2021
7. Bring out the constructive programmes of Mahatma Gandhi during Non-Cooperation Movement and Civil Disobedience Movement. 2021
8. Evaluate the policies of Lord Curzon and their long-term implications on the national movements. 2020
9. Since the decade of the 1920s, the national movement acquired various ideological strands and thereby expanded its social base. Discuss. 2020
10. The 1857 Uprising was the culmination the recurrent big and small local rebellions that had occurred in the preceding hundred years of British rule. Elucidate. 2019
11. Examine the linkages between 19th centuries 'Indian Renaissance' and the emergence of
12. national identity. 2019
13. Many voices had strengthened and enriched the nationalist movement during the Gandhian phase. Elaborate. 2019
14. Assess the role of British imperial power in complicating the process of transfer of power during the 1940s. 2019
15. Throw light on the significance of the thoughts of Mahatma Gandhi in the present times. 2018
16. Clarify how mid-eighteenth-century India was beset with the spectre of a fragmented polity. 2017

17. Why did the 'Moderates' fail to carry conviction with the nation about their proclaimed ideology and political goals by the end of the nineteenth century? 2017
18. Examine how the decline of traditional artisanal industry in colonial India crippled the rural economy. 2017
19. The women's questions arose in modern India as a part of the 19th century social reform movement. What were the major issues and debates concerning women in that period? 2017
20. Highlight the importance of the new objectives that got added to the vision of Indian independence since the twenties of the last century. 2017
21. Explain how the Uprising of 1857 constitutes an important watershed in the evolution of British policies towards colonial India. 2016
22. Discuss the role of women in the freedom struggle especially during the Gandhian phase. 2016
23. Highlight the differences in the approach of Subhash Chandra Bose and Mahatma Gandhi in the struggle for freedom. 2016
24. How different would have been the achievement of Indian independence without Mahatma Gandhi? Discuss. 2015
25. It would have been difficult for the Constituent Assembly to complete its historic task of drafting the Constitution for Independent India in just three years but for the experience gained with the Government of India Act, 1935. Discuss. 2015
26. The third battle of Panipat was fought in 1761. Why were so many empire-shaking battles fought at Panipat? 2014
27. Examine critically the various facets of economic policies of the British in India from mid-eighteenth century till independence. 2014
28. In what ways did the naval mutiny prove to be the last nail in the coffin of British colonial aspirations in India? 2014
29. Defying the barriers of age, gender and religion, the Indian women became the torchbearer during the struggle for freedom in India. Discuss. 2013
30. Several foreigners made India their homeland and participated in various movements. Analyze their role in the Indian struggle for freedom. 2013
31. In many ways, Lord Dalhousie was the founder of modern India. Elaborate. 2013

POST-INDEPENDENCE CONSOLIDATION AND REORGANIZATION WITHIN THE COUNTRY.

1. Trace India's consolidation process during early phase of independence in terms of polity, economy, education and international relations. (Answer in 250 words) 2025

2. The political and administrative reorganization of states and territories has been a continuous ongoing process since the mid-nineteenth century. Discuss with examples. 2022 (15 M)
3. Critically discuss the objectives of Bhodan and Gramdan movements initiated by Acharya Vinoba Bhave and their success. 2013
4. Write a critical note on the evolution and significance of the slogan "Jai Jawana Jai Kisan". 2013
5. Discuss the contribution of Maulana Abul Kalam Azad to pre-and post-independent India. 2013
6. Analyze the circumstances that led to Tashkent Agreement in 1966. Discuss the highlights of the agreement. 2013
7. Critically examine the compulsions which prompted India to play a decisive role in the emergence of Bangladesh. 2013
8. Assess the main administrative issues and socio-cultural problems in the integration process of Indian Princely States.

HISTORY OF THE WORLD WILL INCLUDE EVENTS FROM 18TH CENTURY SUCH AS INDUSTRIAL REVOLUTION, WORLD WARS, REDRAW OF NATIONAL BOUNDARIES, COLONIZATION, DECOLONIZATION, POLITICAL PHILOSOPHIES LIKE COMMUNISM, CAPITALISM, SOCIALISM ETC.- THEIR FORMS AND EFFECT ON THE SOCIETY.

1. The French Revolution has enduring relevance to the contemporary world. Explain. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. Bring out the socio-economic effects of the introduction of railways in different countries of the world. 2023 (10 M)
3. Explain how the foundations of the modern world were laid by the American and French revolution. 2019
4. Why indentured labour was taken by the British from India to other colonies? Have they been able to preserve their cultural identity over there?
5. What problems were germane to the decolonization process of Malay Peninsula. 2017
6. The anti-colonial struggles in West Africa were led by the new elite of Western educated Africans. Examine. 2016
7. Why did the industrial revolution first occur in England? Discuss the quality of life of the people there during the industrialization. How does it compare with that in India at present? 2015
8. To what extent can Germany be held responsible for causing the two World Wars? Discuss critically. 2015
9. What were the major political, economic and social developments in the world which motivated the anti-colonial struggle in India? 2014
10. What were the events that led to the Suez Crisis in 1956? How did it deal a final blow to Britain's self-image as a world power? 2014
10. The New Economic Policy – 1921 of Lenin had influenced the policies adopted by India soon after independence. Evaluate. 2014

11. "Latecomer" Industrial revolution in Japan involved certain factors that were markedly different from what west had experience. 2013
12. Africa was chopped into states artificially created by accident of European competition. Analyze. 2013
13. American Revolution was an economic revolt against mercantilism. Substantiate. 2013
14. What policy instruments were deployed to contain the great economic depression? 2013
15. "There arose a serious challenge to the Democratic State System between the two World Wars." Evaluate the statement.

**COMMUNALISM, REGIONALISM, SECULARISM; SOCIAL EMPOWERMENT;
SALIENT FEATURES OF INDIAN SOCIETY; DIVERSITY OF INDIA;**

1. How do you account for the growing fast food industries given that there are increased health concerns in modern society? Illustrate your answer with the Indian experience. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. Do you think marriage as a sacrament in losing its value in Modern India? 2023 (10 M)
3. Explain why suicide among young women is increasing in Indian Society. 2023 (10 M)
4. Child cuddling is now being replaced by mobile phones. Discuss its impact on the socialization of children. 2023 (10 M)
5. Why is caste identity in India both fluid and static? 2023 (15 M)
6. Discuss the impact of post-liberal economy on ethnic identity and communalism. 2023 (15 M)
7. Explore and evaluate the impact of 'Work from Home' on family relationships. 2022 (10 M)
8. How is the growth of Tier 2 cities related to the rise of a new middle class with an emphasis on the culture of consumption? 2022 (10 M)
9. Given the diversities among the tribal communities in India, in which specific contexts should they be considered as a single category? 2022 (10 M)
10. Analyze the salience of 'sect' in Indian society vis-a-vis caste, region and religion. 2022 (15 M)
11. Are tolerance, assimilation and pluralism the key elements in the making of an Indian form of secularism? Justify your answer. 2022 (15 M)
12. Do you agree that regionalism in India appears to be a consequence of rising cultural assertiveness? Argue. 2020
13. Has caste lost its relevance in understanding the multi-cultural Indian Society? Elaborate your answer with illustrations. 2020
14. "Caste system is assuming new identities and associational forms. Hence, caste system cannot be eradicated in India." Comment. 2018

15. How the Indian concept of secularism is different from the western model of secularism? Discuss. 2018
16. 'Communalism arises either due to power struggle or relative deprivation. Argue by giving suitable illustrations. 2018
17. The spirit tolerance and love is not only an interesting feature of Indian society from very early times, but it is also playing an important part at the present. Elaborate. 2017
18. Distinguish between religiousness/religiosity and communalism giving one example of how the former has got transformed into the latter in independent India. 2017
19. In the context of diversity of India, can it be said that the regions form cultural units rather than the States? Give reasons with examples for your viewpoint. 2017
20. What are the two major legal initiatives by the State since Independence, addressing discrimination against Scheduled Tribes (STs)? 2017
21. Has the formation of linguistic States strengthened the cause of Indian Unity? 2016
22. Why are the tribals in India referred to as the Scheduled Tribes? Indicate the major provisions enshrined in the Constitution of India for their upliftment. 2016
23. What is the basis of regionalism? Is it that unequal distribution of benefits of development on regional basis eventually promotes regionalism? Substantiate your answer. 2016
24. Mahatma Gandhi and Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, despite having divergent approaches and strategies, had a common goal of amelioration of the downtrodden. Elucidate. 2015
25. Describe any four cultural elements of diversity in India and rate their relative significance in building a national identity. 2015
26. Debate the issue of whether and how contemporary movements for assertion of Dalit identity work towards annihilation of caste. 2015
27. How do the Indian debates on secularism differ from the debates in the West? 2014
28. Growing feeling of regionalism is an important factor in the generation of demand for a separate state. Discuss 2013
29. Examine the uniqueness of tribal knowledge system when compared with mainstream knowledge and cultural systems. 2021
30. Examine the role of 'Gig Economy' in the process of empowerment of women in India. 2021
31. What are the main socio-economic implications arising out of the development of IT industries in major cities of India? 2021

33. Discuss the main objectives of Population Education and point out the measures to achieve them in India in detail. 2021
34. What is Cryptocurrency? How does it affect global society? Has it been affecting Indian society also? 2021
35. How does Indian society maintain continuity in traditional social values? Enumerate the changes taking place in it. 2021

ROLE OF WOMEN AND WOMEN'S ORGANISATION;

1. "Empowering women is the key to control population growth". Discuss 2019
2. What are the continued challenges for women in India against time and space? 2019
3. 'Women's movement in India has not addressed the issues of women of lower social strata. Substantiate your view. 2018
4. How do you explain the statistics that show that the sex ratio in Tribes in India is more favourable to women than the sex ratio among Scheduled Castes? 2015
5. How does patriarchy impact the position of a middle-class working woman in India? 2014
6. Discuss the various economic and socio-cultural forces that are driving increasing feminization of agriculture in India. 2014
7. Why do some of the most prosperous regions of India have an adverse sex ratio for women? Give your arguments 2014
8. Male membership needs to be encouraged in order to make women's organization free from gender bias. Comment 2013

POVERTY, POPULATION; DEVELOPMENT AND ASSOCIATED ISSUES

1. Does tribal development in India centre around two axes, those of displacement and of rehabilitation? Give your opinion. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. Why did human development fail to keep pace with economic development in India? 2023 (15 M)
3. COVID-19 pandemic accelerated class inequalities and poverty in India. Comment. 2020
4. How have digital initiatives in India contributed to the functioning of the education system in the country? Elaborate your answer. 2020
5. What makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture? Discuss. 2019
6. What are the challenges to our cultural practices in the name of secularism. 2019
7. Do we have cultural pockets of small India all over the nation? Elaborate with examples. 2019
8. Despite implementation of various programmes for eradication of poverty by the government in India, poverty is still existing.' Explain by giving reasons. 2018

9. Discuss whether formation of new states in recent times is beneficial or not for the economy of India. 2018
10. Mention core strategies for the transformation of aspirational districts in India and explain the nature of convergence, collaboration and competition for its success. 2018
10. "An essential condition to eradicate poverty is to liberate the poor from deprivation." Substantiate this statement with suitable examples. 2016
11. Critically examine whether growing population is the cause of poverty OR poverty is the main cause of population increase in India. 2015
12. Discuss the changes in the trends of labour migration within and outside India in the last four decades. 2015
13. The life cycle of a joint family depends on economic factors rather than social values. Discuss. 2014

URBANIZATION: PROBLEMS AND REMEDIES

1. How can Artificial Intelligence (AI) and drones be effectively used along with GIS and RS techniques in locational and areal planning? (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. How does smart city in India, address the issues of urban poverty and distributive justice? (Answer in 150 words) 2025
3. Does urbanization lead to more segregation and/or marginalization of the poor in Indian metropolises? 2023 (15 M)
4. Account for the huge flooding of million cities in India including the smart ones like Hyderabad and Pune. Suggest lasting remedial measures. 2020
5. How is efficient and affordable urban mass transport key to the rapid economic development of India? 2019
6. "The ideal solution of depleting ground water resources in India is water harvesting system." How can it be made effective in urban areas? 2018
7. The growth of cities as I.T. hubs has opened up new avenues employment but has also created new problems. Substantiate this statement with examples. Urbanization 2017
8. With a brief background of quality of urban life in India, introduce the objectives and strategy of the 'Smart City Programme'. 2016
9. Major cities of India are becoming more vulnerable to flood conditions. Discuss. 2016
10. Mumbai, Delhi and Kolkata are the three mega cities of the country but the air pollution is

much more serious problem in Delhi as compared to the other two. Why is this so? 2015

11. Smart cities in India cannot sustain without smart villages. Discuss this statement in the backdrop of rural urban integration. 2015
10. Discussion the various social problems which originated out of the speedy process of urbanization in India. 2013

TOPIC: EFFECTS OF GLOBALIZATION ON INDIAN SOCIETY

1. Do you think that globalization results in only an aggressive consumer culture? Justify your answer. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. Is diversity and pluralism in India under threat due to globalisation? Justify your answer. 2020
3. Customs and traditions suppress reason leading to obscurantism. Do you agree? 2020
4. Are we losing our local identity for the global identity? Discuss. 2019
5. 'Globalization is generally said to promote cultural homogenization but due to this cultural specificity appear to be strengthened in the Indian Society. Elucidate. 2018
6. To what extent globalization has influenced the core of cultural diversity in India? Explain. 2016
7. Discuss the positive and negative effects of globalization on women in India. (In 2013, UPSC asked about Globalization effect on Elderly). 2015
8. Critically examine the effects of globalization on the aged population in India. 2013

SALIENT FEATURES OF WORLD PHYSICAL GEOGRAPHY; IMPORTANT GEOPHYSICAL PHENOMENA (EARTHQUAKES, TSUNAMI, VOLCANOES, CYCLONES); GEOGRAPHICAL FEATURES AND LOCATION

1. Discuss how the changes in shape and sizes of continents and ocean basins of the planet take place due to tectonic movements of the crustal masses. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. What are Tsunamis? How and where are they formed? What are their consequences? Explain with examples. (Answer in 150 words) 2025/
3. Why is the South-West monsoon called 'Purvaiya' (easterly) in Bhojpur Region? How has this directional seasonal wind system influenced the cultural ethos of the region? 2023 (10 M)
4. Describe the characteristics and types of primary rocks. 2022 (10 M)
5. Discuss the meaning of color-coded weather warnings for cyclone prone areas given by India Meteorological department. 2022 (10 M)

6. Discuss the natural resource potentials of 'Deccan trap'. 2022 (10 M)
7. What are the forces that influence ocean currents? Describe their role in fishing industry of the world. 2022 (15 M)
8. Troposphere is a very significant atmospheric layer that determines weather processes. How? 2022 (15 M)
9. Differentiate the causes of landslides in the Himalayan region and Western Ghats. 2021
10. Despite India being one of the countries of the Gondwanaland, its mining industry contributes much less to its Gross Domestic Product (GDP) in percentage. Discuss. 2021
11. What are the environmental implications of the reclamation of the water bodies into urban land use? Explain with examples. 2021
12. Mention the global occurrence of volcanic eruptions in 2021 and their impact on regional environment. 2021
13. Why is India considered as a sub-continent? Elaborate your answer. 2021
14. Discuss the geophysical characteristics of Circum-Pacific Zone. 2020
15. Why is Indian Regional Navigational Satellite System (IRNSS) needed? How does it help in navigation? 2018
16. Define mantle plume and explain its role in plate tectonics. 2018
17. How does the Juno Mission of NASA help to understand the origin and evolution of the Earth? 2017
18. "The Himalayas are highly prone to landslides." Discuss the causes and suggest suitable measures of mitigation. 2016
19. Explain the formation of thousands of islands in Indonesian and Philippines archipelagos. 2014
20. Why are the world's fold mountain systems located along the margins of continents? Bring out the association between the global distribution of Fold Mountains and the earthquakes and volcanoes. 2014
21. What do you understand by the theory of continental drift? Discuss the prominent evidences in its support. 2013
22. There is no formation of deltas by rivers of the Western Ghat. Why? 2013
23. Major hot deserts in northern hemisphere are located between 20-30 degree north and on the western side of the continents. Why? 2013
24. Bring out the causes for more frequent landslides in the Himalayas than in Western Ghats. 2013

GEOGRAPHICAL FEATURES AND THEIR LOCATION- CHANGES IN CRITICAL GEOGRAPHICAL

FEATURES (INCLUDING WATER BODIES AND ICE-CAPS) AND IN FLORA AND FAUNA AND THE EFFECTS OF SUCH CHANGES.

1. How are climate change and the sea level rise affecting the very existence of many island nations? Discuss with examples. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. Discuss the consequences of climate change on the food security in tropical countries. 2023 (10 M)
3. How are the fjords formed? Why do they constitute some of the most picturesque areas of the world? 2023 (10 M)
4. Identify and discuss the factors responsible for diversity of natural vegetation in India. Assess the significance of wildlife sanctuaries in rain forests regions of India. 2023 (15 M)
5. Examine the status of forest resources of India and its resultant impact on climate change. 2020
6. How will the melting of Himalayan glaciers have a far-reaching impact on the water resources of India? 2020
7. The interlinking of rivers can provide viable solutions to the multi-dimensional inter-related problems of droughts, floods and interrupted navigation. Critically examine. 2020
8. The process of desertification does not have climate boundaries. Justify with examples. 2020
9. Assess the impact of global warming on coral life system with examples. 2019
10. How do ocean currents and water masses differ in their impacts on marine life and the coastal environment? Give suitable examples? 2019
11. Discuss the causes of depletion of mangroves and explain their importance in maintaining coastal ecology. 2019
12. How can the mountain ecosystem be restored from the negative impact of development initiatives and tourism? 2019
13. What is water stress? How and why does it differ regionally in India? 2019
14. What are the consequences of spreading of 'Dead Zones' on marine ecosystem? 2018
15. In spite of adverse environmental impact, coal mining is still inevitable for development." Discuss 2017

16. Mention the advantages of the cultivation of pulse because of which the year 2016 was declared as the International Year of Pulses by the United Nations. 2017
17. How does the cryosphere affect global climate? 2017
18. Account for variations in oceanic salinity and discuss its multi-dimensional effects. 2017
19. In what way can flood be converted into a sustainable source of irrigation and allweather inland navigation in India? 2017
20. What characteristics can be assigned to monsoon climate that succeeds in feeding more than 50 percent of the won population residing in Monsoon Asia? 2017
21. Discuss the concept of air mass and explain its role in macro-climatic changes. 2016
22. Explain the factors responsible for the origin of ocean currents. How do they influence regional climates, fishing and navigation? 2015
23. How far do you agree that the behavior of the Indian monsoon has been changing due to humanizing landscapes? Discuss. 2015
24. Tropical cyclones are largely confined to South China Sea, Bay of Bengal and Gulf of Mexico. Why? 2014
25. Most of the unusual climatic happenings are explained as an outcome of the ElNino effect. Do you agree?
26. Bring out the relationship between the shrinking Himalayan glaciers and the symptoms of climate change in the Indian sub-continent. 2014
27. The recent cyclone on the east coast of India was called "Phailin". How are the tropical cyclones named across the world? 2013
28. Bring out the causes for the formation of heat islands in the urban habitat of the world. 2013
29. What do you understand by the phenomenon of temperature inversion in meteorology? How does it affect the weather and the habitants of the place? 2013
30. Briefly mention the alignment of major mountain ranges of the world and explain their impact on local weather conditions, with examples.2021
31. How do the melting of the Arctic ice and glaciers of the Antarctic differently affect the weather patterns and human activities on the Earth? Explain.2021
32. Discuss the multi-dimensional implications of uneven distribution of mineral oil in the

TOPIC: DISTRIBUTION OF KEY NATURAL RESOURCES ACROSS THE WORLD (INCLUDING SOUTH ASIA AND THE INDIAN SUBCONTINENT)

1. Discuss the distribution and density of population in the Ganga River Basin with special reference to land, soil and water resources. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. Give a geographical explanation of the distribution of off-shore oil reserves of the world. How are they different from the on-shore occurrences of oil reserves? (Answer in 250 words) 2025
3. Explain briefly the ecological and economic benefits of solar energy generation in India with suitable examples. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
4. Why is the world today confronted with a crisis of availability of and access to freshwater resources? 2023 (10 M)
5. Comment on the resource potentials of the long coastline of India and highlight the status of natural hazard preparedness in these areas. 2023 (15 M)
6. Examine the potential of wind energy in India and explain the reasons for their limited spatial spread. 2022 (10 M)
7. India has immense potential of solar energy though there are regional variations in its developments. Elaborate. 2020
8. Can the strategy of regional-resource based manufacturing help in promoting employment in India? 2019
9. Why is India taking keen interest in resources of Arctic Region? 2018
10. The effective management of land and water resources will drastically reduce the human miseries. Explain 2016
11. South China Sea has assumed great geopolitical significance in the present context. Comment. 2016
12. Present an account of the Indus Water Treaty and examine its ecological, economic and political implications in the context of changing bilateral relations. 2016
13. Enumerate the problems and prospects of inland water transport in India. 2016
14. In what way micro-watershed Development projects help in water conservation in drought prone and semi-arid regions of India. 2016
15. What are the economic significances of discovery of oil in Arctic Sea and its possible environmental consequences? 2015
16. India is well endowed with fresh water resources. Critically examine why it still suffers from water scarcity. 2015
17. The states of Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand reaching

the limits of their ecological carrying capacity due to tourism. Critically evaluate. 2015

18. Critically evaluate the various resources of the oceans which can be harnessed to meet the resource crisis in the world. 2014
19. How does India see its place in the economic space of rising natural resource rich Africa? 2014
20. With growing scarcity of fossil fuels, the atomic energy is gaining more and more significance in India. Discuss the availability of raw material required for the generation of atomic energy in India and in the world. 2013
21. It is said the India has substantial reserves of shale oil and gas, which can feed the needs of country for quarter century. However, tapping of the resources doesn't 2013

TOPIC: FACTORS RESPONSIBLE FOR THE LOCATION OF PRIMARY, SECONDARY, AND TERTIARY SECTOR INDUSTRIES IN VARIOUS PARTS OF THE WORLD (INCLUDING INDIA)

1. What are non-farm primary activities? How are these activities related to physiographic features in India? Discuss with suitable examples. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. From being net food importer in 1960s, India has emerged as a net food exporter to the world. Provide reasons. 2023 (15 M)
3. Describing the distribution of rubber producing countries, indicate the major environmental issues faced by them. 2022 (15 M)
4. Mention the significance of straits and isthmus in international trade. 2022 (15 M)
5. Elucidate the relationship between globalization and new technology in a world of scarce resources, with special reference to India. 2022 (15 M)
6. Account for the present location of iron and steel industries away from the source of raw material, by giving examples. 2020
7. Discuss the factors for localization of agro-based food processing industries of North-West India. 2019
8. Define blue revolution, explain the problems and strategies for pisciculture development in India. 2018
9. What is the significance of Industrial Corridors in India? Identify industrial corridors, explain their main characteristics. 2018
10. Petroleum refineries are not necessarily located nearer to crude oil producing areas, particularly in many of the developing countries. Explain its implications. 2017
11. Whereas the British planters had developed tea gardens all along the Shivaliks and Lesser Himalayas from Assam to Himachal Pradesh, in effect they did not succeed beyond the Darjeeling area. Explain. 2014
12. Account for the change in the spatial pattern of the Iron and Steel industry in the

world.2014

13. Why did the Green Revolution in India virtually by-pass the eastern region despite fertile soil and good availability of water? 2014
14. Do you agree that there is a growing trend of opening new sugar mills in the Southern states of India? Discuss with justification 2013
15. Analyse the factors for highly decentralized cotton textile industry in India 2013

POLITY AND GOVERNANCE

Indian Constitution: Historical underpinnings, evolution, features, amendments, significant

provisions and basic structure

1. Indian Constitution has conferred the amending power on the ordinary legislative institutions with a few procedural hurdles. In view of this statement, examine the procedural and substantive limitations on the amending power of the Parliament to change the Constitution. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. "The Constitution of India is a living instrument with capabilities of enormous dynamism. It is a constitution made for a progressive society". Illustrate with special reference to the expanding horizons of the right to life and personal liberty. 2023 (15 M)
3. Explain the constitutional perspectives of Gender Justice with the help of relevant Constitutional Provisions and case laws. 2023 (15 M)
4. "Right of movement and residence throughout the territory of India are freely available to the Indian citizens, but these rights are not absolute. Comment. 2022 (15 M)
5. Constitutional Morality' is rooted in the Constitution itself and is founded on its essential facets. Explain the doctrine of 'Constitutional Morality' with the help of relevant judicial decisions. (2021) 10
6. "Parliament's power to amend the Constitution is a limited power and it cannot be enlarged into absolute power." In the light of this statement explain whether Parliament under Article 368 of the Constitution can destroy the Basic Structure of the Constitution by expanding its amending power? (2019) 15
7. Examine the scope of Fundamental Rights in the light of the latest judgement of the Supreme Court on Right to Privacy. (2017) 15
8. Discuss each adjective attached to the word 'Republic' in the 'Preamble'. Are they Defendable in the present circumstances? (2016) 12.5
9. Did the Government of India Act, 1935 lay down a federal constitution? Discuss. (2016) 12.5

10. Discuss the possible factors that inhibit India from enacting for its citizen a uniform civil code as provided for in the Directive Principles of State Policy. (2015) 12.5
11. Starting from inventing the 'basic structure' doctrine, the judiciary has played a highly proactive role in ensuring that India develops into a thriving democracy. In light of the statement, evaluate the role played by judicial activism in achieving the ideals of democracy. (2014) 12.5
12. What do you understand by the concept "freedom of speech and expression"? Does it cover hate speech also? Why do the films in India stand on a slightly different plane from other forms of expression? Discuss. (2014) 12.5
13. Discuss Section 66A of IT Act, with reference to its alleged violation of Art 19. (2013) 10
14. 'The Supreme Court of India keeps a check on arbitrary power of the Parliament in amending the Constitution.' Discuss critically. (2013) 10
15. The size of the cabinet should be as big as governmental work justifies and as big as the Prime Minister can manage as a team. How far is the efficacy of a government then inversely related to the size of the cabinet? Discuss. (2014) 12.5
16. Many State Governments further bifurcate geographical administrative areas like Districts and Talukas for better governance. In light of the above, can it also be justified that more number of smaller States would bring in effective governance at State level? Discuss. (2013) 10

Functions and responsibilities of the Union and the States, Issues and challenges pertaining to the federal structure

1. Examine the evolving pattern of Centre-State financial relations in the context of planned development in India. How far have the recent reforms impacted the fiscal federalism in India? (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. Account for the legal and political factors responsible for the reduced frequency of using Article 356 by the Union Governments since mid-1990s. 2023 (15 M)
3. Explain the significance of the 101st Constitutional Amendment Act. To what extent does it reflect the accommodative spirit of federalism? 2023 (15 M)
4. While the national political parties in India favor centralization, the regional parties are in favor of State autonomy." Comment. 2022 (15 M)
5. The jurisdiction of the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) regarding lodging an FIR and conducting probe within a particular state is being questioned by various States. However, the power of States to withhold consent to the CBI is not absolute. Explain with special reference to the federal character of India. (2021) 15
6. How far do you think cooperation, competition and confrontation have shaped the nature of federation in India? Cite some recent examples to validate your answer (2020) 15
7. Indian constitution exhibits centralising tendencies to maintain unity and integrity

of the nation.

8. Elucidate in the perspective of the Epidemic Diseases Act, 1897; The Disaster Management Act, 2005
9. And recently passed Farm Acts. (2020) 15
10. From the resolution of contentious issues regarding distribution of legislative powers by the courts, 'Principle of Federal Supremacy' and 'Harmonious Construction' have emerged. Explain. (2019) 10
11. Explain the salient features of the constitution (One Hundred and First Amendment) Act, 2016. Do you think it is efficacious enough 'to remove cascading effect of taxes and provide for common national market for goods and services'? (2017) 15
12. To what extent is Article 370 of the Indian Constitution, bearing marginal note "Temporary provision with respect to the State of Jammu and Kashmir", temporary? Discuss the future prospects of this provision in the context of Indian polity. (2016) 12.5
13. The concept of cooperative federalism has been increasingly emphasised in recent years. Highlight the drawbacks in the existing structure and the extent to which cooperative federalism would answer the shortcomings. (2015) 12.5
14. Though the federal principle is dominant in our Constitution and that principle is one of its basic features, but it is equally true that federalism under the Indian Constitution leans in favour of a strong Centre, a feature that militates against the concept of strong federalism. Discuss. (2014) 12.5

Devolution of powers and finances up to local levels and challenges

1. "The states in India seem reluctant to empower urban local bodies both functionally as well as financially." Comment. 2023 (10 M)
2. To what extent, in your opinion, as the decentralization of power in India changed the governance landscape at the grassroots? 2022 (10 M)
3. The strength sustenance of local institutions in India has shifted from their formative phase of 'Functions, Functionaries and Funds' to the contemporary stage of 'Functionality'. Highlight the critical challenges faced by local institutions in terms of
4. their functionality in recent times. (2020) 15
5. "The reservation of seats for women in the institutions of local self- government has had a limited impact on the patriarchal character of the Indian Political Process." Comment. (2019) 15
6. Assess the importance of the Panchayat system in India as a part of local government. Apart from government grants, what sources the Panchayats can look out for financing development projects? (2018) 15
7. "The local self-government system in India has not proved to be effective instrument of governance". Critically examine the statement and give your views to improve the situation. (2017) 10

8. In absence of well-educated and organised local level government system, 'Panchayats' and 'Samitis' have remained mainly political institutions and not effective instruments of governance. Critically discuss. (2015) 12.5
9. Khap panchayats have been in the news for functioning as extra-constitutional authorities, often delivering pronouncements amounting to human rights violations. Discuss critically the actions taken by the legislative, executive and the judiciary to set the things right in this regard. (2015) 12.5

Separation of powers between various organs, dispute redressal mechanisms and institutions

1. Discuss the desirability of greater representation to women in the higher judiciary to ensure diversity, equity and inclusiveness. (2021) 10
2. Judicial Legislation is antithetical to the doctrine of separation of powers as envisaged in the Indian Constitution. In this context justify the filing of large number of public interest petitions praying for issuing guidelines to executive authorities. (2020) 15
3. Do you think that constitution of India does not accept principle of strict separation of powers rather it is based on the principle of 'checks and balance'? Explain (2019) 10
4. Whether the Supreme Court Judgment (July 2018) can settle the political tussle between the Lt. Governor and elected government of Delhi? Examine. (2018) 15
6. Discuss the essentials of the 69th Constitutional Amendment Act and anomalies, if any, that have led to recent reported conflicts between the elected representatives and institution of Lieutenant Governor in the administration of Delhi. Do you think that this will give rise to a new trend in the functioning of the Indian Federal Politics? (2016) 12.5

Parliament and State Legislatures – structure, functioning, conduct of business, powers & privileges and issues arising out of these

1. Discuss the nature of Jammu and Kashmir Legislative Assembly after the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganization Act, 2019. Briefly describe the powers and functions of the Assembly of the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. Discuss the role of Presiding Officers of state legislatures in maintaining order and impartiality in conducting legislative work and in facilitating best democratic practices. 2023 (10 M)
3. Explain the structure of the Parliamentary Committee system. How far have the financial committees helped in the institutionalization of Indian Parliament? 2023 (15 M)
4. Do Department -related Parliamentary Standing Committees keep the administration on its toes and inspire reverence for parliamentary control? Evaluate the working of such committees with suitable examples. (2021) 15
5. Explain the constitutional provisions under which Legislative Councils are

established. Review the working and current status of Legislative Councils with suitable illustrations. (2021) 15

6. To what extent, in your view, the Parliament is able to ensure accountability of the executive in India? (2021) 10
7. "Once a speaker, Always a speaker"! Do you think the practice should be adopted to impart objectivity to the office of the Speaker of Lok Sabha? What could be its implications for the robust functioning of parliamentary business in India. (2020) 10
8. Rajya Sabha has been transformed from a 'useless stepney tyre' to the most useful supporting organ in past few decades. Highlight the factors as well as the areas in which this transformation could be visible. (2020) 15
9. Individual Parliamentarian's role as the national lawmaker is on a decline, which in turn, has adversely impacted the quality of debates and their outcome. Discuss. (2019) 15
10. Why do you think the committees are considered to be useful for parliamentary work? Discuss, in this context, the role of the Estimates Committee. (2018) 10
11. The Indian Constitution has provisions for holding a joint session of the two houses of the Parliament. Enumerate the occasions when this would normally happen and also the occasions when it cannot, with reasons thereof. (2017) 15
12. "The Indian party system is passing through a phase of transition which looks to be full of contradictions and paradoxes." Discuss. (2016) 12.5
13. What was held in the Coelho case? In this context, can you say that judicial review is of key importance amongst the basic features of the Constitution? (2016) 12.5
14. The 'Powers, Privileges and Immunities of Parliament and its Members' as envisaged in Article 105 of the Constitution leave room for a large number of un-codified and un-enumerated privileges to continue. Assess the reasons for the absence of legal codification of the 'parliamentary privileges. How can this problem be addressed? (2014) 12.5.
15. The role of individual MPs (Members of Parliament) has diminished over the years and as a result healthy constructive debates on policy issues are not usually witnessed. How far can this be attributed to the anti-defection law which was legislated but with a different intention? (2013) 10
16. Constitutional mechanisms to resolve the inter-state water disputes have failed to address and solve the problems. Is the failure due to structural or process inadequacy or both? Discuss. (2013) 10

Structure, organization and functioning of the Executive and the Judiciary; Ministries and Departments of the Government

1. Discuss the evolution of collegium system in India. Critically examine the advantages and disadvantages of the system of appointment of the Judges of the Supreme Court of India and that of the USA. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. "Constitutional morality is the fulcrum which acts as an essential check upon the high functionaries and citizens alike..." In view of the above observation of the

Supreme Court, explain the concept of constitutional morality and its application to ensure balance between judicial independence and judicial accountability in India. (Answer in 250 words) 2025

3. Comment on the need of administrative tribunals as compared to the court system. Assess the impact of the recent tribunal reforms through rationalization of tribunals made in 2021. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
4. Who are entitled to receive free legal aid? Assess the role of the National Legal Services Authority (NALSA) in rendering free legal aid in India. 2023 (10 M)
5. "Constitutionally guaranteed judicial independence is a prerequisite of democracy". Comment. 2023 (10 M)
6. "The most significant achievement of modern law in India is the constitutionalization of environmental problems by the Supreme Court." Discuss this statement with the help of relevant case laws. 2022 (10 M)
7. Discuss the role of the Vice –Presidents of India as the chairman of the Rajyasabha. 2022 (15 M)
8. Discuss the essential conditions for exercise of the legislative powers by the Governor. Discuss the legality of re-promulgation of ordinances by the Governor without placing them before the Legislature. 2022 (15 M)
9. "The Attorney-General is the chief legal adviser and lawyer of the Government of India." Discuss. (2019)15
10. Under what circumstances can the Financial Emergency be proclaimed by the President of India? What consequences follow when such a declaration remain in force? (2018) 10
11. How far do you agree with the view that tribunals curtail the jurisdiction of ordinary courts? In view of the above, discuss the constitutional validity and competency of the tribunals in India? (2018) 15
12. Critically examine the Supreme Court's judgement on 'National Judicial Appointments Commission Act, 2014' with reference to appointment of judges of higher judiciary in India. (2017) 10
13. Resorting to ordinances has always raised concern on violation of the spirit of separation of powers doctrine. While noting the rationales justifying the power to promulgate ordinances, analyse whether the decisions of the Supreme Court on the issue have further facilitated resorting to this power. Should the power to promulgate the ordinances be repealed? (2015) 12.5
14. What are the major changes brought in the Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996 through the recent Ordinance promulgated by the President? How far will it improve India's dispute resolution mechanism? Discuss. (2015) 12.5
15. Does the right to clean environment entail legal regulation on burning crackers during Diwali? Discuss in the light of Article 21 of Indian Constitution and Judgement(s) of the Apex court in this regard. (2015) 12.5

16. Instances of President's delay in commuting death sentences has come under public debate as denial of justice. Should there be a time limit specified for the President to accept/reject such petitions? Analyse. (2014) 12.5

Comparison of the Indian constitutional scheme with that of other countries

1. Compare and contrast the President's power to pardon in India and in the USA. Are there any limits to it in both the countries? What are 'preemptive pardons'? (Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. Compare and contrast the British and Indian approaches to Parliamentary sovereignty. 2023 (10 M)
3. Critically examine the procedures through which the Presidents of India and France are elected. 2022 (15 M)
4. Analyse the distinguishing features of the notion of Equality in the Constitutions of the USA and India. (2021) 15
5. The judicial systems in India and UK seem to be converging as well as diverging in the recent times. Highlight the key points of convergence and divergence between the two nations in terms of their judicial practices. (2020) 10
6. What can France learn from the Indian Constitution's approach to secularism? (2019) 10
7. India and USA are the two large democracies. Examine the basic tenets on which the two political systems are based. (2018) 15

Salient features of the Representation of People's Act

Discuss the 'corrupt practices' for the purpose of the Representation of the People Act, 1951. Analyse whether the increase in the assets of the legislators and/or their associates, disproportionate to their known sources of income, would constitute 'undue influence' and consequently a corrupt practice. 2025

"There is a need for simplification of procedure for disqualification of persons found guilty of corrupt practices under the Representation of peoples Act" Comment (2020) 10

On what grounds a people's representative can be disqualified under the Representation of People Act, 1951? Also mention the remedies available to such person against his disqualification. (2019) 15

'Simultaneous election to the Lok Sabha and the State Assemblies will limit the amount of time and money spent in electioneering but it will reduce the government's accountability to the people' Discuss. (2017) 10

To enhance the quality of democracy in India the Election Commission of India has proposed electoral reforms in 2016.

What are the suggested reforms and how far are they significant to make democracy successful? (2017) 15

Appointment to various Constitutional Posts, Powers, Functions and Responsibilities of various Constitutional Bodies.

“The Attorney General of India plays a crucial role in guiding the legal framework of the Union Government and ensuring sound governance through legal counsel.” Discuss his responsibilities, rights and limitations in this regard. (Answer in 150 words) 2025

Statutory, Regulatory and various Quasi-judicial Bodies.

The National Commission for Protection of Child Rights has to address the challenges faced by children in the digital era. Examine the existing policies and suggest measures the Commission can initiate to tackle the issue. (Answer in 250 words) 2025

Governance and Policy Government policies and interventions for development in various sectors and issues arising out of their design and implementation.

1. The crucial aspect of development process has been the inadequate attention paid to Human Resource Development in India. Suggest measures that can address this adequacy. 2023 (10 M)
2. “Development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable, by its nature, are discriminatory in approach.” Do you agree? Give reasons for your answer. 2023 (15 M)
3. Skill development programs have succeed in increasing human resources supply to various sectors. In the context of the statement analyze the linkages between education, skill and employment. 2023 (15 M)
4. The Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 remains only a legal document without intense sensitization of government functionaries and citizens regarding disability. Comment. 2022 (10 M)
5. Reforming the government delivery system through the Direct Benefit Transfer Scheme is a progressive step, but it has its limitations too. Comment. 2022 (10 M)
6. Besides the welfare schemes, India needs deft management of inflation and unemployment to serve the poor and the underprivileged sections of the society. Discuss. 2022 (15 M)
7. The Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009 remains inadequate in promoting incentive-based system for children’s education without generating awareness about the importance of schooling. Analyze 2022 (15 M)
8. Discuss the procedures to decide the disputes arising out of the election of a Member of the Parliament or State Legislature under The Representation of the People Act, 1951. What are the grounds on which the election of any returned candidate may be declared void? What remedy is available to the aggrieved party against the decision? Refer to the case laws. 2022 (15 M)
9. “Besides being a moral imperative of Welfare State, primary health structure is a necessary precondition for sustainable development.” Analyse. (2021) 10
10. ‘In the context of neo-liberal paradigm of development planning, multi-level planning is expected to make operations cost effective and remove many

implementation blockages.’- Discuss. (2019) 15

11. “Policy Contradictions among various competing sectors and stakeholders have resulted in inadequate ‘protection and prevention of degradation’ to environment.” Comment with relevant illustrations. (2018) 10
12. Has the Indian governmental system responded adequately to the demands of Liberalization, Privatization and Globalization started in 1991? What can the government do to be responsive to this important change? (2016) 12.5
13. “For achieving the desired objectives, it is necessary to ensure that the regulatory institutions remain independent and autonomous.” Discuss in the light of experiences in recent past. (2015) 12.5
14. Two parallel run schemes of the Government, viz. the Aadhaar Card and NPR, one as voluntary and the other as compulsory, have led to debates at national levels and also litigations. On merits, discuss whether or not both schemes need run concurrently. Analyse the potential of the schemes to achieve developmental benefits and equitable growth. (2014) 12.5
15. Though 100 percent FDI is already allowed in non-news media like a trade publication and general entertainment channel, the Government is mulling over the proposal for increased FDI in news media for quite some time. What difference would an increase in FDI make? Critically evaluate the pros and cons. (2014) 12.5
16. The setting up of a Rail Tariff Authority to regulate fares will subject the cash strapped Indian Railways to demand subsidy for obligation to operate non-profitable routes and services. Taking into account the experience in the power sector, discuss if the proposed reform is expected to benefit the consumers, the Indian Railways or the private container operators. (2014) 12.5
17. An athlete participates in Olympics for personal triumph and nation’s glory; victors are showered with cash incentives by various agencies, on their return. Discuss the merit of state sponsored talent hunt and its cultivation as against the rationale of a reward mechanism as encouragement. (2014) 12.5
18. Recent directives from Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas are perceived by the ‘Nagas’ as a threat to override the exceptional status enjoyed by the State. Discuss in light of Article 371A of the Indian Constitution. (2013) 10

Pressure groups & formal/informal associations & their role in Polity

1. What are environmental pressure groups? Discuss their role in raising awareness, influencing policies and advocating for environmental protection in India. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. “Pressure groups play a vital role in influencing public policy making in India.” Explain how the business associations contribute to public policies. (2021) 10
3. What are the methods used by the Farmers organizations to influence the policy-makers in India and how effective are these methods? (2019) 10
4. How do pressure groups influence Indian political process? Do you agree with this view that informal pressure groups have emerged as powerful as formal pressure

groups in recent years? (2017) 10

5. Pressure group politics is sometimes seen as the informal face of politics. With regards to the above, assess the structure and functioning of pressure groups in India. (2013) 10

Development processes and the development industry- the role of NGOs, SHGs, various groups and associations, donors, charities, institutional and other stakeholders

1. "In contemporary development models, decision-making and problem-solving responsibilities are not located close to the source of information and execution defeating the objectives of development." Critically evaluate. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. Civil Society Organizations are often perceived as being anti-State actors than non-State actors. Do you agree? Justify. (Answer in 150 words) 10 2025
3. Discuss the contribution of civil society groups for women's effective and meaningful participation and representation in state legislatures in India. 2023 (15 M)
4. The Gati-Shakti Yojana needs meticulous coordination between the government and the private sector to achieve the goal of connectivity. Discuss. 2022 (10 M)
5. Do you agree with the view that increasing dependence on donor agencies for development reduces the importance of community participation in the development process? Justify your answer. 2022 (15 M)
6. Can Civil Society and Non-Governmental Organizations present an alternative model of public service delivery to benefit the common citizen. Discuss the challenges of this alternative model. (2021) 15
7. "Micro-Finance as an anti-poverty vaccine, is aimed at asset creation and income security of the rural poor in India". Evaluate the role of Self-Help Groups in achieving the twin objectives along with empowering women in rural India. (2020) 15
8. The need for cooperation among various service sector has been an inherent component of development discourse. Partnership bridges bring the gap among the sectors. It also sets in motion a culture of 'Collaboration' and 'team spirit'. In the light of statements above examine India's Development process. (2019) 15
9. Despite Consistent experience of High growth, India still goes with the lowest indicators of human development. Examine the issues that make balanced and inclusive development elusive. (2019) 10
10. The emergence of Self Help Groups (SHGs) in contemporary times points to the slow but steady withdrawal of the state from developmental activities'. Examine the role of the SHGs in developmental activities and the measures taken by the Government of India to promote the SHGs. (2017) 15
11. "In the Indian governance system, the role of non-state actors has been only marginal." Critically examine this statement. (2016) 12.5

12. "Effectiveness of the government system at various levels and people's participation in the governance system are interdependent" Discuss their relationship in the context of India. (2016) 12.5
13. Examine critically the recent changes in the rules governing foreign funding of NGOs under the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA), 1976. (2015) 12.5
14. The Self Help Group (SHG) Bank Linkage Programme (SBLP), which is India's own innovation, has proved to be one of the most effective poverty alleviation and women empowerment programmes. Elucidate. (2015) 12.5
15. How can the role of NGOs be strengthened in India for development works relating to protection of the environment? Discuss throwing light on the major constraints. (2015) 12.5
16. The penetration of Self Help Groups (SHGs) in rural areas in promoting participation in development programmes is facing socio-cultural hurdles. Examine. (2014) 12.5
17. legitimacy and accountability of Self Help Groups (SHGs) and their patrons, the micro- finance outfits, need systematic assessment and scrutiny for the sustained success of the concept. Discuss. (2013) 10

Important aspects of governance, transparency and accountability, e-governance-applications,

Models.

1. e-governance projects have a built-in bias towards technology and back-end integration than user-centric designs. Examine. (Answer in 150 words) 10 2025
2. e-governance, as a critical tool of governance, has ushered in effectiveness, transparency and accountability in governments. What inadequacies hamper the enhancement of these features? 2023 (10 M)
3. "The emergence of Fourth Industrial Revolution (Digital Revolution) has initiated e-Governance as an integral part of government". Discuss. (2020) 10
4. Implementation of information and Communication Technology (ICT) based Projects /Programmes usually suffers in terms of certain vital factors. Identify these factors, and suggest measures for their effective implementation. (2019) 10
5. E-governance is not only about utilization of the power of new technology, but also much about critical importance of the 'use value' of information. Explain. (2018) 10
6. Electronic cash transfer system for the welfare schemes is an ambitious project to minimize corruption, eliminate wastage and facilitate reforms. Comment. (2013) 10

Citizens charters, Transparency & accountability & institutional & other measures

1. "Recent amendments to the Right to information Act will have profound impact on the
the
autonomy and independence of the Information Commission". Discuss (2020) 10
3. The Citizen's Charter is an ideal instrument of organizational transparency and accountability, but it has its own limitations. Identify the limitations and suggest measures for greater effectiveness of the Citizens' Charter. (2018) 15
4. Discuss the role of Public Accounts Committee in establishing accountability of the government to the people. (2017) 10
5. In the light of Satyam Scandal (2009), discuss the changes brought in corporate governance to ensure transparency, accountability. (2015) 12.5
6. "If amendment bill to the Whistleblowers Protection Act, 2011 tabled in the Parliament is passed, there may be no one left to protect." Critically evaluate. (2015) 12.5
7. Though Citizens' charters have been formulated by many public service delivery organizations, there is no corresponding improvement in the level of citizens' satisfaction and quality of services being provided. Analyse. (2013) 10

Role of civil services in a democracy

1. "Institutional quality is crucial driver of economic performance". In this context suggest reforms in Civil Services for strengthening democracy. (2020) 10
2. Initially Civil Services in India were designed to achieve the goals of neutrality and effectiveness, which seems to be lacking in the present context. Do you agree with the view that drastic reforms are required in Civil Services. Comment. (2017) 15
3. In the integrity index of Transparency International, India stands very low. Discuss briefly the legal, political, social and cultural factors that have caused the decline of public morality in India. (2016) 12.5
4. "Traditional bureaucratic structure and culture have hampered the process of socio-economic development in India." Comment. (2016) 12.5
5. Has the Cadre based Civil Services Organization been the cause of slow change in India? Critically examine. (2014) 12.5
6. 'A national Lokpal, however strong it may be, cannot resolve the problems of immorality in public affairs.' Discuss. (2013) 10

Social Justice

1. Inequality in the ownership pattern of resources is one of the major causes of poverty. Discuss in the context of 'paradox of poverty'. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. Women's social capital complements in advancing empowerment and gender equity. Explain. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
3. Discuss the desirability of greater representation to women in the higher judiciary to ensure diversity, equity and inclusiveness.
4. Can the vicious cycle of gender inequality, poverty and malnutrition be broken through microfinancing of women SHGs? Explain with examples.
5. "Though women in post-Independent India have excelled in various fields, the social attitude towards women and the feminist movement has been patriarchal." Apart from women education and women empowerment schemes, what interventions can help change this milieu?

2020

1. In order to enhance the prospects of social development, sound and adequate health care policies are needed particularly in the fields of geriatric and maternal health care. Discuss.
2. "Micro-Finance as an anti-poverty vaccine is aimed at asset creation and income security of the rural poor in India". Evaluate the role of Self-Help Groups in achieving the twin objectives along with empowering women in rural India.
3. National Education Policy 2020 is in conformity with the Sustainable Development Goal-4 (2030). It intends to restructure and reorient the education system in India. Critically examine the statement.

2019

1. Despite Consistent experience of high growth, India still goes with the lowest indicators of human development. Examine the issues that make balanced and inclusive development elusive.
2. There is a growing divergence in the relationship between poverty and hunger in India. The shrinking of social expenditure by the government is forcing the poor to spend more on non-food essential items squeezing their food-budget – Elucidate.

2018

1. Appropriate local community level healthcare intervention is a prerequisite to achieve 'Health for All' in India. Explain.
2. Multiplicity of various commissions for the vulnerable sections of the society leads to problems of overlapping jurisdiction and duplication of functions. Is it better to merge all commissions into an umbrella Human Rights Commission? Argue your case.
3. The Citizen's Charter is an ideal instrument of organisational transparency and accountability, but it has its own limitations. Identify the limitations and suggest measures for greater effectiveness of the Citizen's Charters.
4. How do pressure groups influence the Indian political process? Do you agree with this

view that informal pressure groups have emerged as more powerful than formal pressure groups in recent years? (150 words)

5. 'The emergence of Self Help Groups(SHG) in contemporary times points to the slow but steady withdrawal of the state from developmental activities'. Examine the role of the SHGs in developmental activities and the measures taken by the Government of India to promote the SHGs.
6. Initially Civil Services in India were designed to achieve the goals of neutrality and effectiveness, which seems to be lacking in the present context. Do you agree with the view that drastic reforms are required in Civil Services. Comment (250 words)

2016

1. Professor Amartya Sen has advocated important reforms in the realms of primary education and primary health care. What are your suggestions to improve their status and performance?
2. In the integrity index of Transparency International, India stands very low. Discuss briefly the legal, political, social and cultural factors that have caused the decline of public morality in India.
3. "Traditional bureaucratic structure and culture have hampered the process of socio-economic development in India." Comment.
4. "Demographic Dividend in India will remain only theoretical unless our manpower
5. becomes more educated, aware, skilled and creative." What measures have been taken by the government to enhance the capacity of our population to be more productive and employable?

2015

1. How can the role of NGOs be strengthened in India for development works relating to protection of the environment? Discuss throwing light on the major constraints.
2. The quality of higher education in India requires major improvements to make it internationally competitive. Do you think that the entry of foreign educational institutions would help improve the quality of higher and technical education in the country? Discuss.
3. Public health system has limitations in providing universal health coverage. Do you think that the private sector could help in bridging the gap? What other viable alternatives would you suggest?
4. Though there have been several different estimates of poverty in India, all indicate reduction in poverty levels over time. Do you agree? Critically examine with reference to urban and rural poverty indicators.
5. The penetration of Self Help Groups (SHGs) in rural areas in promoting participation in development programmes is facing socio-cultural hurdles. Examine.
6. An athlete participates in Olympics for personal triumph and nation's glory; victors are showered with cash incentives by various agencies, on their return. Discuss the merit

of state sponsored talent hunt and its cultivation as against the rationale of a reward mechanism as encouragement.

7. Should the premier institutes like IITs/IIMs be allowed to retain premier status, allowed more academic independence in designing courses and also decide mode/criteria of selection of students. Discuss in light of the growing challenges.

2013

1. Pressure group politics is sometimes seen as the informal face of politics. With regards to the above, assess the structure and functioning of pressure groups in India.
2. The legitimacy and accountability of Self Help Groups (SHGs) and their patrons, the micro- finance outfits, need systematic assessment and scrutiny for the sustained success of the concept. Discuss.
3. The basis of providing urban amenities in rural areas (PURA) is rooted in establishing connectivity. Comment.
4. Identify the Millennium Development Goals (MDGs) that are related to health. Discuss the success of the actions taken by the Government for achieving the same.
5. Though Citizen's charters have been formulated by many public service delivery organizations, there is no corresponding improvement in the level of citizens' satisfaction and quality of services being provided. Analyse.

International Relations

2025

1. "The reform process in the United Nations remains unresolved, because of the delicate imbalance of East and West and entanglement of the USA vs. Russo-Chinese alliance." Examine and critically evaluate the East-West policy confrontations in this regard. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. "Energy security constitutes the dominant kingpin of India's foreign policy, and is linked with India's overarching influence in Middle Eastern countries." How would you integrate energy security with India's foreign policy trajectories in the coming years? (Answer in 250 words) 2025
3. India-Africa digital partnership is achieving mutual respect, co-development and long-term institutional partnerships. Elaborate. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
4. "With the waning of globalization, post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism." Elucidate. (Answer in 150 words) 2025

2023

1. 'Virus of Conflict is affecting the functioning of the SCO'. In the light of the above statement point out the role of India in mitigating problems. 2023 (10 M)
2. Indian diaspora has scaled new heights in the West. Describe its economic and political benefits for India. 2023 (10 M)
3. 'The expansion and strengthening of NATO and a stronger US-Europe strategic partnership works well in India.' What is your opinion about this statement? Give reasons

and examples to support your answer. 2023 (15 M)

4. 'Sea is an important Component of the Cosmos'. Discuss in the light of the above statement the role of the IMO (International Maritime Organization) in protecting environment and enhancing maritime safety and security. 2023 (15 M)

5. India is an age-old friend of Sri Lanka.' Discuss India's role in the recent crisis in Sri Lanka in the light of the preceding statement. 2022 (10 M)

2022

1. Do you think that BIMSTEC is a parallel organization like the SAARC? What are the similarities and dissimilarities between the two? How are Indian foreign policy objectives realized by forming this new organization? 2022 (10 M)

2. How will 12U2 (India, Israel, UAE and USA) grouping transform India's position in global politics? 2022 (15 M)

3. Clean energy is the order of the day. Describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics. 2022 (15 M)

2021

1. "If the last few decades were of Asia's growth story, the next few are expected to be of Africa's." In the light of this statement, examine India's influence in Africa in recent years.

2. "The USA is facing an existential threat in the form of a China, that is much more

3. challenging than the erstwhile Soviet Union." Explain.

4. Critically examine the aims and objectives of SCO. What importance does it hold for India?

5. The newly tri-nation partnership AUKUS is aimed at countering China's ambitions in the Indo-Pacific region. Is it going to supersede the existing partnerships in the region? Discuss the strength and impact of AUKUS in the present scenario.

6. What is the significance of Indo-US defence deals over Indo-Russian defence deals? Discuss with reference to stability in the Indo-Pacific region.

7. 'Quadrilateral Security Dialogue (QUAD)' is transforming itself into a trade bloc from a military alliance, in present times – Discuss.

8. "The incidence and intensity of poverty are more important in determining poverty based on income alone". In this context analyze the latest United Nations Multidimensional Poverty Index Report.

9. 'Indian diaspora has a decisive role to play in the politics and economy of America and European Countries'. Comment with examples.

10. Critically examine the role of WHO in providing global health security during the COVID- 19 pandemic. 2019

1. 'The time has come for India and Japan to build a strong contemporary relationship, one involving global and strategic partnerships that will have a great significance for Asia and the

world as a whole.' Comment.

2. 'Too little cash, too much politics, leave UNESCO fighting for life.' Discuss the statement in the light of the US' withdrawal and its accusation of the cultural body as being 'anti-Israel bias'.
3. "The long sustained image of India as a leader of the oppressed and marginalised nations has disappeared on account of its newfound role in the emerging global order.' Elaborate
4. What introduces friction into the ties between India and the United States is that Washington is still unable to find for India a position in its global strategy, which would satisfy India's national self-esteem and ambitions'. Explain with suitable examples.

2018

1. "India's relations with Israel have, of late, acquired a depth and diversity, which cannot be rolled back." Discuss.
2. A number of outside powers have entrenched themselves in Central Asia, which is a zone of interest to India. Discuss the implications, in this context, of India's joining the Ashgabat Agreement, 2018.
3. Indian and the USA are two large democracies. Examine the basic tenets on which the two political systems are based.
4. What are the key areas of reform if the WTO has to survive in the present context of 'Trade War', especially keeping in mind the interest of India?
5. In what ways would the ongoing US-Iran Nuclear Pact Controversy affect the national interest of India? How should India respond to its situation?

1. 'China is using its economic relations and positive trade surplus as tools to develop potential military power status in Asia', In the light of this statement, discuss its impact on India as her neighbor.
2. What are the main functions of the United Nations Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC)? Explain different functional commissions attached to it.
3. The question of India's Energy Security constitutes the most important part of India's economic progress. Analyze India's energy policy cooperation with West Asian Countries. (250 words)
4. Indian Diaspora has an important role to play in South-East Asian countries' economy and society. Appraise the role of Indian Diaspora in South- East Asia in this context (250 words)

2016

1. "The broader aims and objectives of WTO are to manage and promote international trade in the era of globalization. But the Doha round of negotiations seems doomed due to differences between the developed and the developing countries." Discuss in the Indian perspective.
2. Evaluate the economic and strategic dimensions of India's Look East Policy in the
3. context of the post-Cold War international scenario.
4. "Increasing cross-border terrorist attacks in India and growing interference in the internal affairs of member-states by Pakistan are not conducive for the future of SAARC (South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation)." Explain with suitable examples.
5. What are the aims and objectives of the McBride Commission of UNESCO? What is India's

position on these?

2015

1. Increasing interest of India in Africa has its pros and cons. Critically examine.
2. Discuss the impediments India is facing in its pursuit of a permanent seat in the UN Security Council.
3. Project 'Mausam' is considered a unique foreign policy initiative of the Indian Government to improve relationships with its neighbors. Does the project have a strategic dimension? Discuss.
4. Terrorist activities and mutual distrust have clouded India-Pakistan relations. To what extent the use of soft power like sports and cultural exchanges could help generate goodwill between the two countries? Discuss with suitable examples. 2014
5. With respect to the South China Sea, maritime territorial disputes and rising tension affirm the need for safeguarding maritime security to ensure freedom of navigation and over flight throughout the region. In this context, discuss the bilateral issues between India and China.
6. The aim of Information Technology Agreements (ITAs) is to lower all taxes and tariffs on Information technology products by signatories to zero. What impact would such
7. agreements have on India's interests?
8. Some of the International funding agencies have special terms for economic participation stipulating a substantial component of the aid used for sourcing equipment from the leading countries. Discuss the merits of such terms and it, there exists a strong case not to accept such conditions in the Indian context.
9. India has recently signed to become a founding member of the New Development Bank (NDB) and also the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB). How will the role of the two Banks be different? Discuss the strategic significance of these two Banks for India.
10. WTO is an important international institution where decisions are taken to affect countries in a profound manner. What is the mandate of WTO and how binding are their decisions? Critically analyse India's stand on the latest round of talks on Food security.

2013

1. The proposed withdrawal of the International Security Assistance Force (ISAF) from Afghanistan in 2014 is fraught with major security implications for the countries of the region. Examine in light of the fact that India is faced with a plethora of challenges and needs to safeguard its own strategic interests.
2. What do you understand by 'The String of Pearls'? How does it impact India? Briefly outline the steps taken by India to counter this.
3. Economic ties between India and Japan while growing in recent years are still far below their potential. Elucidate the policy constraints which are inhibiting this growth.
4. The protests in Shahbag Square in Dhaka in Bangladesh reveal a fundamental split in society between the nationalists and Islamic forces. What is its significance for India?
5. Discuss the political developments in the Maldives in the last two years. Should they be of any cause of concern to India?
6. In respect of India — Sri Lanka relations, discuss how domestic factors influence foreign policy.

7. The World Bank and the IMF, collectively known as the Bretton Woods Institutions, are the two inter-governmental pillars supporting the structure of the world's economic and financial order. Superficially, the World Bank and the IMF exhibit many common characteristics, yet their role, functions and mandate are distinctly different. Elucidate.

General Studies 3:

INDIAN ECONOMY AND ISSUES RELATED TO PLANNING, MOBILISATION OF RESOURCES, GROWTH, DEVELOPMENT, EMPLOYMENT;

1. What are the challenges before the Indian economy when the world is moving away from free trade and multilateralism to protectionism and bilateralism? How can these challenges be met?
(Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. Distinguish between the Human Development Index (HDI) and the Inequality-adjusted Human Development Index (IHDI) with special reference to India. Why is the IHDI considered a better indicator of inclusive growth?
(Answer in 150 words) 2025
3. Faster economic growth requires increased share of the manufacturing sector in GDP, particularly of MSMEs. Comment on the present policies of the Government in this regard. 2023 (10 M)
4. What is the status of digitalization in the Indian economy? Examine the problems faced in this regard and suggest improvements. 2023 (10 M)
5. Most of the unemployment in India is structural in nature. Examine the methodology adopted to compute unemployment in the country and suggest improvements. 2023 (15 M)
6. The increase in life expectancy in the country has led to newer health challenges in the community. What are those challenges and what steps need to be taken to meet them? 2022 (10 M)
7. Economic growth in the recent past has been led by increase in labor activity." Explain this statement. Suggest the growth pattern that will lead to creation of more jobs without compromising labor productivity. 2022 (15 M)
8. Explain the meaning of investment in an economy in terms of capital formation. Discuss the factors to be considered while designing a concession agreement between a public entity and a private entity. 2020
9. Define potential GDP and explain its determinants. What are the factors that have been inhibiting India from realizing its potential GDP 2020
10. Do you agree with the view that steady GDP growth and low inflation have left the Indian economy in good shape? Give reasons in support of your arguments. 2019
11. How are the principles followed by the NITI Aayog different from those followed by the erstwhile Planning Commission in India? 2018

12. Among several factors for India's potential growth, savings rate is the most effective one. Do you agree? What are the other factors available for growth potential?2017
13. Account for the failure of manufacturing sector in achieving the goal of labor- intensive exports rather than capital-intensive exports. Suggest measures for more labour-intensive rather than capital-intensive exports.2017
14. The nature of economic growth in India is described as jobless growth. Do you agree with this view? Give arguments in favour of your answer.2015
15. Craze for gold in Indians have led to a surge in import of gold in recent years and put pressure on balance of payments and external value of rupee. In view of this, examine the merits of Gold Monetization Scheme.2015
16. "Success of 'Make in India' programme depends on the success of 'Skill India' programme and radical labour reforms." Discuss with logical arguments. 2015
17. While we found India's demographic dividend, we ignore the dropping rates of employability. What are we missing while doing so? Where will the jobs that India desperately needs come from? Explain.2014
18. Explain the difference between computing methodology of India's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) before the year 2015 and after the year 2015. (2021)
19. Distinguish between Capital Budget and Revenue Budget. Explain the components of both these Budgets.2021
20. Do you agree that the Indian economy has recently experienced V-shaped recovery ? Give reasons in support of your answer.2021
21. "Investment in Infrastructure is essential for more rapid and inclusive economic growth". Discuss in the light of India's experience.2021

INCLUSIVE GROWTH AND ISSUES THEREIN

1. Distinguish between 'care economy' and 'monetized economy'. How can care economy be brought into monetized economy through women empowerment? 2023 (15 M)
2. Is inclusive growth possible under market economy? State the significance of financial inclusion in achieving economic growth in India. 2022 (10 M)
3. Explain intra-generational and inter-generational issues of equity from the perspective of inclusive growth and sustainable development. 2020
4. It is argued that the strategy of inclusive growth is intended to meet the objectives of inclusiveness and sustainability together. Comment on this statement.2019
5. What are the salient features of 'inclusive growth'? Has India been experiencing such a growth process? Analyze and suggest measures for inclusive growth.2017
6. Pradhan Mantri Jan-Dhan Yojana (PMJDY) is necessary for bringing unbanked to the institutional finance fold. Do you agree with this for financial inclusion of the poorer section of the Indian society? Give arguments to justify your opinion.2016
7. Comment on the challenges for inclusive growth which include careless and useless manpower in the Indian context. Suggest measures to be taken for facing these challenges.2016

8. Capitalism has guided the world economy to unprecedented prosperity. However, it often encourages shortsightedness and contributes to wide disparities between the rich and the poor. In this light, would it be correct to believe and adopt capitalism driving inclusive growth in India? Discuss.2014
9. With a consideration towards the strategy of inclusive growth, the new companies bill, 2013 has indirectly made CSR a mandatory obligation. Discuss the challenges expected in its implementation in right earnest. Also discuss other provisions in the bill and their implications.2013

GOVERNMENT BUDGETING

1. Explain how the Fiscal Health Index (FHI) can be used as a tool for assessing the fiscal performance of states in India. In what way would it encourage the states to adopt prudent and sustainable fiscal policies? (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. Explain the rationale behind the Goods and Services Tax (Compensation to States) Act of 2017. How has COVID-19 impacted the GST compensation fund and created new federal tensions?2020
3. Enumerate the indirect taxes which have been subsumed in the Goods and Services Tax (GST) in India. Also, comment on the revenue implications of the GST introduced in India since July 2017.2019
4. The public expenditure management is a challenge to the government of India in the context of budget-making during the post-liberalization period. Clarify it.2019
5. Comment on the important changes introduced in respect of the Long-term Capital Gains Tax (LCGT) and Dividend Distribution Tax (DDT) in the Union Budget for 2018-2019.(2018
6. One of the intended objectives of Union Budget 2017-18 is to 'transform, energize and clean India'. Analyze the measures proposed in the Budget 2017-18 to achieve the objective.2017
7. Women empowerment in India needs gender budgeting. What are the requirements and status of gender budgeting in the Indian context?2016
8. In what way could replacement of price subsidy with Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) change the scenario of subsidies in India? Discuss.2015
9. What are the reasons for introduction of Fiscal responsibility and Budget Management (FRBM) act, 2003? Discuss critically its salient features and their effectiveness.2013
10. What is meaning of the term tax-expenditure? Taking housing sector as an example, discuss how it influences budgetary policies of the government. 2013
11. Discussion the rationale for introducing Good and services tax in India. Bring out critically the reasons for delay in roll out for its regime.2013

INFRASTRUCTURE (ENERGY, PORTS, ROADS, AIRPORTS, RAILWAYS); INVESTMENT MODELS

1. How can India achieve energy independence through clean technology by 2047? How can biotechnology play a crucial role in this endeavour? (Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. The fusion energy programme in India has steadily evolved over the past few decades. Mention India's contributions to the international fusion energy project – International Thermonuclear Experimental Reactor (ITER). What will be the implications of the success of this project for the future of global energy? (Answer in 150 words) 2025
3. With growing energy needs should India keep on expanding its nuclear energy programme? Discuss the facts and fears associated with nuclear energy.2018

4. Access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy is the sine qua non to achieve Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). Comment on the progress made in India in this regard. 2018
5. Examine the developments of Airports in India through Joint Ventures under Public- Private Partnership (PPP) model. What are the challenges faced by the authorities in this regard? 2017
6. What are 'Smart Cities? Examine their relevance for urban development in India. Will it increase rural-urban differences? Give arguments for Smart Villages' in the light of PURA and RURBAN Mission. 2016
7. Justify the need for FDI for the development of the Indian economy. Why there is gap between MOUs signed and actual FDIs? Suggest remedial steps to be taken for increasing actual FDIs in India. 2016
8. There is a clear acknowledgement that Special Economic Zones (SEZs) are a tool of industrial development, manufacturing and exports. Recognizing this potential, the whole instrumentality of SEZs requires augmentation. Discuss the issues plaguing the success of SEZs with respect to taxation, governing laws and administration. 2015
9. The right to fair compensation and transparency land acquisition, rehabilitation and resettlement act, 2013 has come into effect from 1 January 2014. What implication would it have on industrialization and agriculture in India? 2014
10. National urban transport policy emphasizes on moving people instead of moving vehicles. Discuss critically the success of various strategies of the government in this regard. 2014
11. Explain how private public partnership agreements, in longer gestation infrastructure projects, can transfer unsuitable liabilities to the future. What arrangements need to be put in place to ensure that successive generations' capacities are not compromised? 2014
12. Adaptation of PPP model for infrastructure development of the country has not been free from criticism. Critically discuss the pros and cons of the model. 2013

EFFECTS OF LIBERALISATION ON THE ECONOMY; CHANGES IN INDUSTRIAL POLICY & THEIR EFFECTS ON INDUSTRIAL GROWTH

1. India aims to become a semiconductor manufacturing hub. What are the challenges faced by the semiconductor industry in India? Mention the salient features of the India Semiconductor Mission. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. Discuss the rationale of the Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme. What are its achievements? In what way can the functioning and outcomes of the scheme be improved? (Answer in 250 words) 2025
3. Why is Public Private Partnership (PPP) required in infrastructural projects? Examine the role of PPP model in the redevelopment of Railway Stations in India. 2022 (10 M)
4. How would the recent phenomena of protectionism and currency manipulations in world trade affect macroeconomic stability of India? 2018
5. "Industrial growth rate has lagged behind in the overall growth of Gross-Domestic-Product(GDP) in the post-reform period" Give reasons. How far the recent changes in Industrial Policy are capable of increasing the industrial growth rate? 2017

6. How globalization has led to the reduction of employment in the formal sector of the Indian economy? Is increased informalization detrimental to the development of the country? 2016
7. Normally countries shift from agriculture to industry and then later to services, but India shifted directly from agriculture to services. What are the reasons for the huge growth of services vis-a-vis industry in the country? Can India become a developed country without a strong industrial base? 2014
8. Foreign direct investment in the defence sector is now said to be liberalised. What influence this is expected to have on Indian defence and economy in the short and long run? 2014
9. Examine the impact of liberalization on companies owned by Indian. Are they competing with the MNCs satisfactorily? 2013
10. Discuss the impact of FDI entry into multi-trade retail sector on supply chain management in commodity trade pattern of the economy. 2013
11. Though India allowed foreign direct investment (FDI) in what is called multi brand retail through joint venture route in September 2012, the FDI even after a year, has not picked up. Discuss the reasons. 2013

CROPPING-IRRIGATION

1. Elaborate the scope and significance of supply chain management of agricultural commodities in India. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. Explain the factors influencing the decision of the farmers on the selection of high value crops in India. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
3. Explain the changes in cropping pattern in India in the context of changes in consumption pattern and marketing conditions. 2023 (15 M)
4. What are the major factors responsible for making rice-wheat system a success? In spite of this success how has this system become a bane in India? 2020
5. Suggest measures to improve water storage and irrigation system to make its judicious use under depleting scenario. 2020
6. How can biotechnology improve the living standards of farmers? 2019
7. How far is the Integrated Farming System (IFS) helpful in sustaining agricultural production? 2019
8. Elaborate on the impact of the National Watershed Project in increasing agricultural production from water-stressed areas. 2019
9. How was India benefited from the contributions of Sir M. Visvesvaraya and Dr. M. S. Swaminathan in the fields of water engineering and agricultural science respectively? 2019
10. Sikkim is the first 'Organic State' in India. What are the ecological and economical benefits of Organic State? 2018
11. Assess the role of National Horticulture Mission (NHM) in boosting the production, productivity and income of horticulture farms. How far has it succeeded in increasing the income of farmers? 2018
12. How has the emphasis on certain crops brought about changes in cropping patterns in recent past? Elaborate the emphasis on millets production and consumption. 2018

13. What are the major reasons for declining rice and wheat yield in the cropping system? How crop diversification is helpful to stabilize the yield of the crop in the system? 2017
14. What is water-use efficiency? Describe the role of micro-irrigation in increasing the water-use efficiency. 2016
15. What is allelopathy? Discuss its role in major cropping systems of irrigated agriculture. 2016
16. Given the vulnerability of Indian agriculture to vagaries of nature, discuss the need for crop insurance and bring out the salient features of the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY) 2016
17. How did land reforms in some parts of the country help to improve the socio-economic conditions of marginal and small farmers ? 2021
18. How and to what extent would micro-irrigation help in solving India's water crisis ? 2021
19. What are the salient features of the National Food Security Act, 2013 ? How has the Food Security Bill helped in eliminating hunger and malnutrition in India? 2021
20. What are the present challenges before crop diversification ? How do emerging technologies provide an opportunity for crop diversification? 2021

E-TECHNOLOGY TO AID FARMERS, TECHNOLOGY MISSIONS;

1. How does nanotechnology offer significant advancements in the field of agriculture? How can this technology help to uplift the socio-economic status of farmers? (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. How does e-Technology help farmers in production and marketing of agricultural produce? Explain it. 2023 (10 M)
3. What is Integrated Farming System? How is it helpful to small and marginal farmers in India? 2022 (15 M)
4. Explain various types of revolutions, took place in Agriculture after Independence in India. How these revolutions have helped in poverty alleviation and food security in India? 2017
5. How can the 'Digital India' programme help farmers to improve farm productivity and income? What steps has the Government taken in this regard? 2015

FOOD PROCESSING AND RELATED INDUSTRIES IN INDIA (SCOPE & SIGNIFICANCE, LOCATION, UPSTREAM-DOWNSTREAM REQUIREMENTS, SUPPLY CHAIN MANAGEMENT); STORAGE, TRANSPORT & MARKETING OF AGRO-PRODUCE AND RELATED ISSUES & CONSTRAINTS; ECONOMICS OF ANIMAL-REARING

1. Examine the scope of the food processing industries in India. Elaborate the measures taken by the government in the food processing industries for generating employment opportunities. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. Elaborate the scope and significance of the food processing industry in India. 2022 (10 M)

3. What are the main bottlenecks in upstream and downstream process of marketing of agricultural products in India? 2022 (15 M)
4. What are the main constraints in transport and marketing of agricultural produce in India? 2020
5. How is science interwoven deeply with our lives? What are the striking changes in agriculture triggered off by the science-based technologies? 2020
6. What are the challenges and opportunities of food processing sector in the country? How can income of the farmers be substantially increased by encouraging food processing? 2020
7. Elaborate on the policy taken by the government of India to meet the challenges of the food processing sector. 2019
8. Examine the role of supermarkets in supply chain management of fruits, vegetables and food items. How do they eliminate number of intermediaries? 2018
9. What are the reasons for poor acceptance of cost-effective small processing unit? How the food processing unit will be helpful to uplift the socio-economic status of poor farmers? 2017
10. Livestock rearing has a big potential for providing non-farm employment and income in rural areas. Discuss suggesting suitable measures to promote this sector in India. 2015
11. In view of the declining average size of land holdings in India which has made agriculture non-viable for a majority of farmers, should contract farming and land leasing be promoted in agriculture? Critically evaluate the pros and cons. 2015
12. What are the impediments in marketing and supply chain management in industry in India? Can e-commerce help in overcoming these bottlenecks? 2015
13. There is also a point of view that agriculture produce market committees (APMCs) set up under the state acts have not only impeded the development of agriculture but also have been the cause of food inflation in India. Critically examine. 2014
14. India needs to strengthen measures to promote the pink revolution in food industry for better nutrition and health. Critically elucidate the statement. 2013

LAND REFORMS IN INDIA

1. State the objectives and measures of land reforms in India. Discuss how land ceiling policy on landholding can be considered as an effective reform under economic criteria. 2023 (10 M)
2. Discuss the role of land reforms in agricultural development. Identify the factors that were responsible for the success of land reforms in India. 2016
3. Establish the relationship between land reform, agriculture productivity and elimination of poverty in Indian Economy. Discuss the difficulty in designing and implementation of the agriculture friendly land reforms in India. 2013

FARM SUBSIDIES AND MSP AND ISSUES THEREIN (DIRECT AND INDIRECT); PDS (OBJECTIVES, FUNCTIONING, LIMITATIONS, REVAMPING, ISSUES OF BUFFER STOCKS & FOOD SECURITY)

1. What are the direct and indirect subsidies provided to farm sector in India? Discuss the

issues raised by the World Trade Organization (WTO) in relation to agricultural subsidies. 2023 (15 M)

2. What are the major challenges of Public Distribution System (PDS) in India? How can it be made effective and transparent? 2022 (10 M)
3. What are the reformatory steps taken by the government to make food grain distribution system more effective? 2019
4. What do you mean by Minimum Support Price (MSP)? How will MSP rescue the farmers from the low-income trap? 2018
5. How do subsidies affect the cropping pattern, crop diversity and economy of farmers? What is the significance of crop insurance, minimum support price and food processing for small and marginal farmers? 2017
6. "In the villages itself no form of credit organisation will be suitable except the cooperative society." – All India rural credit survey. Discuss this statement in the background of agriculture finance in India. What constraints and challenges do 2014 financial institutions supplying agricultural finances? How can technology be used to better reach and serve rural clients?
7. Food security bill is expected to eliminate hunger and malnutrition in India. Critically discuss various apprehensions in its effective implementation along with the concerns it has generated in WTO. 2013
8. What are the different types of agriculture subsidies given to farmers at the national and state levels? Critically analyze the agriculture subsidy regime with the reference to the distortions created by it. 2013

DISASTERS & DISASTER MANAGEMENT

1. Seawater intrusion in the coastal aquifers is a major concern in India. What are the causes of seawater intrusion and the remedial measures to combat this hazard? (Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. Dam failures are always catastrophic, especially on the downstream side, resulting in a colossal loss of life and property. Analyze the various causes of dam failures. Give two examples of large dam failures. 2023 (10 M)
3. Explain the mechanism and occurrence of cloudburst in the context of the Indian subcontinent. Discuss two recent examples. 2022 (10 M)
4. Discuss the recent measures initiated in disaster management by the Government of India departing from the earlier reactive approach. 2020
5. Disaster preparedness is the first step in any disaster management process. Explain how hazard zonation mapping will help in disaster mitigation in the case of landslides. 2019
6. Vulnerability is an essential element for defining disaster impacts and its threat to people. How and in what ways can vulnerability to disasters be characterized? Discuss different types of vulnerability with reference to disasters. 2019
7. Describe various measures taken in India for Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR) before and after signing 'Sendai Framework for DRR (2015-2030)'. How is this framework different from 'Hyogo Framework for Action, 2005? 2018

8. On December 2004, tsunami brought havoc on 14 countries including India. Discuss the factors responsible for occurrence of Tsunami and its effects on life and economy. In the light of guidelines of NDMA (2010) describe the mechanisms for preparedness to reduce the risk during such events. 2017
9. The frequency of urban floods due to high intensity rainfall is increasing over the years. Discussing the reasons for urban floods. highlight the mechanisms for preparedness to reduce the risk during such events. 2016
10. With reference to National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA) guidelines, discuss the measures to be adopted to mitigate the impact of the recent incidents of cloudbursts in many places of Uttarakhand. 2016
11. The frequency of earthquakes appears to have increased in the Indian subcontinent. However, India's preparedness for mitigating their impact has significant gaps. Discuss various aspects. 2015
12. Drought has been recognised as a disaster in view of its party expense, temporal duration, slow onset and lasting effect on various vulnerable sections. With a focus on the September 2010 guidelines from the National disaster management authority, discuss the mechanism for preparedness to deal with the El Nino and La Nina fallouts in India. 2014
13. How important are vulnerability and risk assessment for pre-disaster management? As an administrator, what are key areas that you would focus in a disaster management 2013

ENVIRONMENTAL CONSERVATION; ENVIRONMENTAL POLLUTION AND DEGRADATION; ENVIRONMENTAL IMPACT ASSESSMENT

1. Write a review on India's climate commitments under the Paris Agreement (2015) and mention how these have been further strengthened in COP26 (2021). In this direction, how has the first Nationally Determined Contribution intended by India been updated in 2022? (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. Mineral resources are fundamental to the country's economy and these are exploited by mining. Why is mining considered an environmental hazard? Explain the remedial measures required to reduce the environmental hazard due to mining. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
3. Examine the factors responsible for depleting groundwater in India. What are the steps taken by the government to mitigate such depletion of groundwater? (Answer in 250 words) 2025
4. What is Carbon Capture, Utilization and Storage (CCUS)? What is the potential role of CCUS in tackling climate change? (Answer in 150 words) 2025
5. Discuss several ways in which microorganisms can help in meeting the current fuel shortage. 2023 (10 M)
6. What is oil pollution? What are its impacts on the marine ecosystem? In what way is oil pollution particularly harmful for a country like India? 2023 (10 M)
7. Comment on the National Wetland Conservation Programme initiated by the Government of India and name a few India's wetlands of international importance

included in the Ramsar Sites. 2023 (15 M)

8. The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) has predicted a global sea level rise of about one meter by AD 2100. What would be its impact in India and the other countries in the Indian Ocean region? 2023 (15 M)
9. Discuss in detail the photochemical smog emphasizing its formation, effects and mitigation. Explain the 1999 Gothenburg Protocol. 2022 (10 M)
10. Do you think India will meet 50 percent of its energy needs from renewable energy by 2030? Justify your answer. How will the shift of subsidies from fossil fuels to renewables help achieve the above objective? Explain. 2022 (15 M)
11. Discuss global warming and mention its effects on the global climate. Explain the control measures to bring down the level of greenhouse gases which cause global warming, in the light of the Kyoto Protocol, 1997. 2022 (15 M)
12. Explain the causes and effects of coastal erosion in India. What are the available coastal management techniques for combating the hazard? 2022 (15 M)
13. How does the draft Environment Impact Assessment (EIA) Notification, 2020 differ from the existing EIA Notification, 2006? 2020
14. What are the key features of the National Clean Air Programme (NCAP) initiated by the Government of India? 2020
15. What are the salient features of the Jal Shakti Abhiyan launched by the Government of India for water conservation and water security? 2020
16. Define the concept of carrying capacity of an ecosystem as relevant to an environment. Explain how understanding this concept is vital while planning for sustainable development of a region. 2019
17. What are the impediments in disposing the huge quantities of discarded solid wastes which are continuously being generated? How do we remove safely the toxic wastes that have been accumulating in our habitable environment? 2018
18. What is wetland? Explain the Ramsar concept of 'wise use' in the context of wetland conservation. Cite two examples of Ramsar sites from India. 2018
19. How does biodiversity vary in India? How is the Biological Diversity Act, 2002 helpful in conservation of flora and fauna? 2018
20. 'Climate Change' is a global problem. How India will be affected by climate change? How Himalayan and coastal states of India will be affected by climate change? 2017
21. Rehabilitation of human settlements is one of the important environmental impacts which always attracts controversy while planning major projects. Discuss the measures suggested for mitigation of this impact while proposing major developmental projects. 2016
22. What are the consequences of illegal mining? Discuss the ministry of environment and forests' concept of "GO AND NO GO" zones for coal mining. 2013
23. Give an account of the current status and the targets to be achieved pertaining to renewable energy sources in the country. Discuss in brief the importance of National Programme on Light Emitting Diodes (LEDs). 2016

24. To what factors can the recent dramatic fall in equipment costs and tariff of solar energy be attributed? What implications does the trend have for the thermal power producers and the related industry? 2015
25. Should the pursuit of carbon credit and clean development mechanism set up under UNFCCC be maintained even though there has been a massive slide in the value of carbon credit? Discuss with respect to India's energy needs for economic growth. 2014
26. Environmental impact assessment studies are increasingly undertaken before project is cleared by the government. Discuss the environmental impacts of coal-fired thermal plants located at Pitheads. 2014
27. Write a note on India's green energy corridor to alleviate the problems of conventional energy. 2013
28. Coastal sand mining, whether legal or illegal, poses one of the biggest threats to our environment. Analyse the impact of sand mining along the Indian coasts, citing specific examples. 2019
29. Not many years ago, river linking was a concept but it is becoming reality in the country. Discuss the advantages of river linking and its possible impact on the environment. 2017
30. What do you understand by run of the river hydroelectricity project? How is it different from any other hydroelectricity project? 2013
31. The Namami Gange and National mission for clean Ganga (NMCG) programmes and causes of mixed results from the previous schemes. What quantum leaps can help preserve the river Ganga better than incremental inputs? 2015
32. Enumerate the National Water Policy of India. Taking river Ganges as an example, discuss the strategies which may be adopted for river water pollution control and management. What are the legal provisions for management and handling of hazardous wastes in India? 2013
33. Explain the purpose of the Green Grid Initiative launched at World Leaders Summit of the COP26 UN Climate Initiative launched at World Leaders November, 2021. When was this idea first floated in the International Solar Alliance (ISA)? 2021
34. Describe the key points of the revised Global Air Quality Guidelines (AQGs) recently released by the World Health Organisation (WHO). How are these different from its last update? In What changes in India's National Clean Air Programme are required to achieve these revised standards ? 2021
35. Discuss about the vulnerability of India to earthquake related hazards. Give examples including the salient features of major disasters caused by earthquakes in different parts of India during the last three decades. 2021
36. Describe the major outcomes of the 26th session of the Conference of the Parties (COP) to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC). What are the commitments made by India in this conference? 2021
37. Describe the various causes and the effects of landslides. Mention the important components of the National Landslide Risk Management Strategy. 2021

S&T DEVELOPMENTS AND EVERYDAY APPLICATIONS & EFFECTS; AWARENESS IN FIELDS OF IT, SPACE, COMPUTERS, ROBOTICS, NANOTECH, BIOTECH, IPR ISSUES

1. Introduce the concept of Artificial Intelligence (AI). How does AI help clinical diagnosis? Do you perceive any threat to privacy of the individual in the use of AI in

the healthcare? 2023 (10 M)

2. What is the main task of India's third moon mission which could not be achieved in its earlier mission? List the countries that have achieved this task. Introduce the subsystems in the spacecraft launched and explain the role of the 'Virtual Launch Control Centre' at the Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre which contributed to the successful launch from Sriharikota. 2023 (15 M)
3. Each year a large amount of plant material, cellulose, is deposited on the surface of Planet Earth. What are the natural processes this cellulose undergoes before yielding carbon dioxide, water and other end products? 2022 (10 M)
4. Launched on 25th December, 2021, James Webb Space Telescope has been much in the news since then. What are its unique features which make it superior to its predecessor Space Telescopes? What are the key goals of this mission? What potential benefits does it hold for the human race? 2022 (15 M)
5. What is the basic principle behind vaccine development? How do vaccines work? What approaches were adopted by the Indian vaccine manufacturers to produce COVID-19 vaccines? 2022 (15 M)
6. What do you understand by nanotechnology and how is it helping in health sector? 2020
7. COVID-19 pandemic has caused unprecedented devastation worldwide. However, technological advancements are being availed readily to win over the crisis. Give an account of how technology was sought to aid management of the pandemic. 2020
8. Describe the benefits of deriving electric energy from sunlight in contrast to the conventional energy generation. What are the initiatives offered by our Government for this purpose? 2020
9. Why is there so much activity in the field of biotechnology in our country? How has this activity benefitted the field of biopharma? 2018
10. Stem cell therapy is gaining popularity in India to treat a wide variety of medical conditions including Leukemia, Thalassemia, damaged cornea and several burns. Describe briefly what stem cell therapy is and what advantages it has over other treatments? 2017
11. India's Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (TKDL) which has a database containing formatted information on more than 2 million medicinal formulations is proving a powerful weapon in the country's fight against erroneous patents. Discuss the pros and cons making this database publicly available under open-source licensing. 2015
12. What are the areas of prohibitive labour that can be sustainably managed by robots? Discuss the initiatives that can propel research in premier research institutes for substantive and gainful innovation. 2015
13. In a globalized world, intellectual property rights assume significance and are a source of litigation. Broadly distinguish between the terms – copyrights, patents and trade secrets. 2014
14. What do you understand by Umpire decision review in cricket? Discuss its various components. Explain how silicon tape on the edge of a bat may fool the system? 2013
15. What is an FRP composite material? How are they manufactured? Discuss their applications in aviation and automobile industry 2013

16. Bring out the circumstances in 2005 which forced amendment to section 3(d) in the Indian Patent Law, 1970. Discuss how it has been utilized by Supreme court in its judgment rejecting Novartis patent application for "Glivec". Discuss briefly the pros and cons of the decision.2013
17. How does the 3D printing technology work? List out the advantages and disadvantages of the technology.2013
18. What do you understand by fixed dose drug combinations (FDCs)? Discuss their merits and demerits.2013

ACHIEVEMENTS OF INDIANS IN S&T; INDIGENISATION OF TECHNOLOGY & DEVELOPMENT OF NEW TECHNOLOGY

1. The adoption of electric vehicles is rapidly growing worldwide. How do electric vehicles contribute to reducing carbon emissions and what are the key benefits they offer compared to traditional combustion engine vehicles? 2023 (15 M)
2. What is India's plan to have its own space station and how will it benefit our space programme? 2019
3. How is the government of India protecting traditional knowledge of medicine from patenting by pharmaceutical companies? 2019
4. Discuss the work of 'Bose-Einstein Statistics' done by Prof. Satyendra Nath Bose and show how it revolutionized the field of Physics. 2018
5. India has achieved remarkable successes in unmanned space missions including the Chandrayaan and Mars Orbiter Mission, but has not ventured into manned space mission, both in terms of technology and logistics? Explain critically.2017
6. Give an account of the growth and development of nuclear science and technology in India. What is the advantage of fast breeder reactor programme in India? 2017
7. Discuss India's achievements in the field of Space Science and Technology. How the application of this technology has helped India in its socio-economic development?2016
8. Why is nanotechnology one of the key technologies of the 21st century? Describe the salient features of Indian Government's Mission on Nanoscience and Technology and the scope of its application in the development process of the country.2016
9. What do you understand by 'Standard Positioning Systems' and 'Protection Positioning Systems' in the GPS era? Discuss the advantages India perceives from its ambitious IRNSS programme employing just seven satellites.2015
10. Scientific research in Indian universities is declining, because a career in science is not as attractive as our business operations, engineering or administration, and the universities are becoming consumer oriented. Critically comment.2014
11. Can overuse and the availability of antibiotics without doctor's prescription, the contributors to the emergence of drug-resistant diseases in India? What are the available mechanisms for monitoring and control? Critically discuss the various issues involved.2014
12. How is S- 400 air defence system technically superior to any other system presently available in the world? 2021

13. What are the research and developmental achievements in applied biotechnology? How will these achievements help to uplift the poorer sections of the society? 2021
14. The Nobel Prize in Physics of 2014 was jointly awarded to Akasaki, Amano and Nakamura for the invention of Blue LEDs in 1990s. How has this invention impacted the everyday life of human beings? 2021

LINKAGES BETWEEN DEVELOPMENT & SPREAD OF EXTREMISM; LINKAGES OF ORGANIZED CRIME AND TERRORISM

1. **The Government of India recently stated that Left Wing Extremism (LWE) will be eliminated by 2026. What do you understand by LWE and how are the people affected by it? What measures have been taken by the government to eliminate LWE? (Answer in 150 words) 2025**
2. **Terrorism is a global scourge. How has it manifested in India? Elaborate with contemporary examples. What are the counter measures adopted by the State? Explain. (Answer in 150 words) 2025**
3. Give out the major sources of terror funding in India and efforts being made to curtail these sources. In the light of this, also discuss the aim and objective of the 'No Money for Terror [NMFT]' Conference recently held at New Delhi in November 2022. 2023 (15 M)
4. Discuss the types of organized crimes. Describe the linkages between terrorists and organized crime that exist at the national and transnational levels. 2022 (10 M)
5. Naxalism is a social, economic and developmental issue manifesting as a violent internal security threat. In this context, discuss the emerging issues and suggest a multilayered strategy to tackle the menace of Naxalism. 2022 (15 M)
6. What are the determinants of left-wing extremism in Eastern part of India? What strategy should Government of India, civil administration and security forces adopt to counter the threat in the affected areas? 2020
7. The banning of 'Jamaat-e - Islamic' in Jammu and Kashmir brought into focus the role of over-ground workers (OGWs) in assisting terrorist organizations. Examine the role played by OGWs in assisting terrorist organizations in insurgency affected areas. Discuss measures to neutralize the influence of OGWs. 2019
8. The Indian government has recently strengthened the anti-terrorism laws by amending the unlawful activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA), 1967 and the NIA Act. Analyze the changes in the context of prevailing security environment while discussing the scope and reasons for opposing the UAPA by human rights organizations. 2019
9. Left Wing Extremism (LWE) is showing a downward trend, but still affects many parts of the country. Briefly explain the Government of India's approach to counter the challenges posed by LWE. 2018
10. Mob violence is emerging as a serious law and order problem in India. By giving suitable examples, analyze the causes and consequences of such violence. 2017
11. The scourge of terrorism is a grave challenge to national security. What solutions do you suggest to curb this growing menace? What are the major sources of terrorist funding?

2017

12. The north-eastern region of India has been infested with insurgency for a very long time. Analyze the major reasons for the survival of armed insurgency in this region. 2017
13. "Terrorism is emerging as a competitive industry over the last few decades." Analyze the above statement. 2016
14. The persisting drives of the government for development of large industries in backward areas have resulted in isolating the tribal population and the farmers who face multiple displacements with Malkangiri and Naxalbari foci, discuss the corrective strategies needed to win the left-wing extremism (LWE) doctrine affected citizens back into the mainstream of social and economic growth. 2015
15. Religious indoctrination via digital media has resulted in Indian youth joining the ISIS. What is ISIS and its mission? How can ISIS be dangerous for the internal security of our country? 2015
16. Article 244 of Indian Constitution relates to Administration of Scheduled areas and tribal areas. Analyze the impact of non-implementation of the provisions of fifth schedule on the growth of Left-Wing Extremism. 2013

BORDER AREAS (SECURITY CHALLENGES AND MANAGEMENT THEREOF); SECURITY FORCES & AGENCIES (MANDATE); ROLE OF EXTERNAL STATE & NON-STATE ACTORS IN CREATING INTERNAL SECURITY CHALLENGES

1. Why is maritime security vital to protect India's sea trade? Discuss maritime and coastal security challenges and the way forward. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
2. What are the major challenges to internal security and peace process in the North-Eastern States? Map the various peace accords and agreements initiated by the government in the past decade. (Answer in 250 words) 2025
3. Winning of 'Hearts and Minds' in terrorism affected areas is an essential step in restoring the trust of the population. Discuss the measures adopted by the Government in this respect as part of the conflict resolution in Jammu and Kashmir. 2023 (10 M)
4. The use of unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) by our adversaries across the borders to ferry arms/ammunitions, drugs, etc., is a serious threat to the internal security. Comment on the measures being taken to tackle this threat. 2023 (10 M)
5. What are the internal security challenges being faced by India? Give out the role of Central Intelligence and Investigative Agencies tasked to counter such threats. 2023 (15 M)
6. What are the maritime security challenges in India? Discuss the organizational, technical and procedural initiatives taken to improve the maritime security. 2022 (10 M)
7. For effective border area management, discuss the steps required to be taken to deny local support to militants and also suggest ways to manage favourable perception among locals. 2020

8. Analyze internal security threats and trans-border crimes along Myanmar, Bangladesh and Pakistan borders including Line of Control (LoC). Also discuss the role played by various security forces in this regard.2020
9. Cross-border movement of insurgents is only one of the several security challenges facing the policing of the border in North-East India. Examine the various challenges currently emanating across the India-Myanmar border. Also, discuss the steps to counter the challenges.2019
10. The China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC) is viewed as a cardinal subset of China's larger 'One Belt One Road' initiative. Give a brief description of CPEC and enumerate the reasons why India has distanced itself from the same.2018
11. The terms 'Hot Pursuit' and 'Surgical Strikes' are often used in connection with armed action against terrorist attacks. Discuss the strategic impact of such actions. 2016
12. Border management is a complex task due to difficult terrain and hostile relations with some countries. Elucidate the challenges and strategies for effective border management.2016
13. International civil aviation laws provide all countries complete and exclusive sovereignty over the airspace above the territory. What do you understand by airspace? What are the implications of these laws on the space above this airspace? 2014
14. Discuss the challenges which this poses and suggests ways to contain the threat.
15. The diverse nature of India as a multireligious and multi-ethnic society is not immune to the impact of radicalism which has been in her neighbourhood. Discuss along with the strategies to be adopted to counter this environment.2014
16. How illegal trans-border migration does pose a threat to India's security? Discuss the strategies to curb this, bring out the factors which give impetus to such migration.2014
17. In 2012, the longitudinal marking of the high-risk areas for piracy was moved from 65° East to 78° east in the Arabian Sea by International Maritime organisation. What impact does this have on India's maritime security concerns?2014
18. China and Pakistan have entered into an agreement for development of an economic corridor. What threat does it dispose for India's security? Critically examine.2014
19. How far are India's internal security challenges linked with border management, particularly in view of the long porous borders with most countries of South Asia and Myanmar?2013
20. Discuss how emerging technologies and globalisation contribute to money laundering. Elaborate measures to tackle the problem of money laundering both at national and international levels.2021
21. Keeping in view India's internal security, analyse the impact of cross-border cyber attacks. Also discuss defensive measures against these sophisticated attacks.2021
22. Analyse the multidimensional challenges posed by external state and non-state actors, to the internal security of India. Also discuss measures required to be taken to combat these threats.2021
23. Analyse the complexity and intensity of terrorism, its causes, linkages and obnoxious nexus. Also suggest measures required to be taken to eradicate the menace of terrorism. 2021

MONEY LAUNDERING & ITS PREVENTION

1. India's proximity to two of the world's biggest illicit opium-growing states has enhanced her internal security concerns. Explain the linkages between drug trafficking and other illicit activities such as gunrunning, money laundering and human trafficking. What counter-measures should be taken to prevent the same? 2018
2. Money laundering poses a serious threat to country's economic sovereignty. What is its significance for India and what steps are required to be taken to control this menace? 2013

BASICS OF CYBER SECURITY; ROLE OF MEDIA AND SOCIAL-NETWORKING SITES IN INTERNAL SECURITY CHALLENGES; INTERNAL SECURITY CHALLENGES THROUGH COMMUNICATION NETWORKS

1. What are the different elements of cyber security? Keeping in view the challenges in cyber security, examine the extent to which India has successfully developed a comprehensive National Cyber Security Strategy. 2022 (15 M)
2. Discuss different types of cybercrimes and measures required to be taken to fight the menace. 2020
3. What is the Cyber Dome Project? Explain how it can be useful in controlling internet crimes in India. 2019
4. Data security has assumed significant importance in the digitized world due to rising cybercrimes. The Justice B. N. Srikrishna Committee Report addresses issues related to data security. What, in your view, are the strengths and weaknesses of the Report relating to protection of personal data in cyber space? 2018
5. Discuss the potential threats of Cyber-attack and the security framework to prevent it. 2017
6. Use of Internet and social media by non-state actors for subversive activities is a major concern. How have these been misused in the recent past? Suggest effective guidelines to curb the above threat. 2016
7. Discuss the advantage and security implications of cloud hosting of server vis-a-vis in-house machine-based hosting for government businesses. 2015
8. Considering the threats cyberspace poses for the country, India needs a "Digital Armed Force" to prevent crimes. Critically evaluate the National Cyber Security Policy, 2013 outlining the challenges perceived in its effective implementation. 2015
9. What is digital signature? What does its authentication mean? Give various salient features of a digital signature. 2013
10. What is a social networking site and what security implications do these sites present? 2013
11. Cyber warfare is considered by some defense analysts to be a larger threat than even AI

Qaeda or terrorism. What do you understand by Cyber warfare? Outline the cyber threats which India is vulnerable to and bring out the state of the country's preparedness to deal with the same. 2013

SECURITY FORCES AND THEIR MANDATES

1. Human rights activists constantly highlight the view that the Armed Forces (Special Powers) Act, 1958 (AFSPA) is a draconian act leading to cases of human rights

abuses by the security forces. What sections of AFSPA are opposed by the activists? Critically evaluate the requirement with reference to the view held by the Apex Court. 2015

Ethics and human interface

The topic 'Ethics' has the following sub-topics:

1. Definition of ethics
2. Essence of ethics
3. Determinants of ethics
4. Dimensions of ethics
5. Difference between ethics, morality, and law
6. Consequence of ethical behaviour
7. Non moral, amoral, and immoral
8. Branches of ethics
9. Normative ethics
10. Meta ethics
11. Applied ethics
12. Bio ethics
13. Environmental ethics
14. Ethics in private and public life

➤ Human values

1. Introduction to values, Types of values
2. Morals, values and ethics
3. Inculcating values
4. Role of society
5. Role of family
6. Role of education institutes
7. Reformers and administrators
8. Raja Ram Mohan Roy
9. Max weber
10. Plato
11. Aristotle
12. Teachings from great leaders
13. Gandhi
14. Vivekananda
15. Gautam buddha

16. Bhimrao Ambedkar

17. Sardar Patel

➤ **Attitude**

The topic 'Attitude' has the following subtopics:

1. Its Influence and Relation with Thought and Behaviour
2. Moral and Political Attitudes
3. Social Influence and Persuasion
4. Functions of attitude -Utilitarian, Social, Symbolic
5. Attitude and Behaviour
6. Cognitive Dissonance
7. Social influence
8. Persuasion
9. Moral and Political attitudes

➤ **Aptitude**

The topic 'Aptitude' has the following subtopics:

1. Foundational Values for Civil Service
2. Integrity
3. Impartiality and Non-partisanship
4. Objectivity
5. Dedication to Public Service
6. Empathy
7. Tolerance and Compassion towards the weaker-sections
8. Neutrality
9. Anonymity
10. Integrity
11. Humility
12. Adaptability
13. Perseverance
14. Magnanimity

➤ **Moral Thinkers and Philosophers**

The topic 'Moral Thinkers and Philosophers'

1. Gandhi
2. John Rawls
3. Vivekananda
4. J s mills
5. Max weber
6. Jeremy Bentham
7. Other Contributions of the thinkers from India and the World,

➤ **Emotional Intelligence**

The topic 'Emotional Intelligence' has the following subtopics:

1. Concepts, and their Utilities and
2. Application in Administration and Governance
3. Significance
4. Max weber's Ideal Bureaucracy
5. Utilities of Emotional Intelligence
6. Emotional Quotient
7. Components of emotional intelligence
8. Application of Emotional Intelligence
9. Motivation

➤ **Public Organisations**

The topic 'Public Organisations' has the following subtopics:

1. Civil Service Values and Ethics in Public Administration
2. Status and Problems
3. Ethical Concerns and Dilemmas in Government and Private Institutions
4. Laws, Rules, Regulations and Conscience as Sources of Ethical Guidance
5. Accountability and Ethical Governance
6. Strengthening of Ethical and Moral Values in Governance
7. Ethical Issues in International Relations and Funding
8. Corporate Governance
9. Ethical Governance
10. Impartiality & Non-partisanship
11. Political neutrality
12. Ethics and accountability
13. Accountability vs responsibility
14. Accountability and transparency
15. Ethical dilemmas-Conflict of interest, Conflict of duties, Conflict in administrations, Action of private institution
16. Resolving ethical dilemmas-Utilitarian approach, Rights approach, Justice approach, Common good approach, Virtue approach

➤ **Probity in Governance**

The topic 'Probity in Governance' has the following subtopics:

1. Concept of Public Service
2. Philosophical Basis of Governance and Probity
3. Information Sharing and Transparency in Government
4. Right to Information
5. Codes of Ethics
6. Codes of Conduct
7. Citizen's Charters
8. Work Culture
9. Quality of Service Delivery
10. Utilization of Public Funds

➤ **International ethics**

1. Morality vs national interest
2. Ethical issues in international funding
3. Humanitarian intervention
4. War and ethics
5. Information flow and ethics

CASE

STUDIES

2025

1. Vijay was Deputy Commissioner of remote district of Hilly Northern State of the country for the last two years. In the month of August heavy rains lashed the complete state followed by cloud burst in the upper reaches of the said district. The damage was very heavy in the complete state especially in the affected district. The complete road network and telecommunication were disrupted and the buildings were damaged extensively. People's houses have been destroyed and they were forced to stay in open. More than 200 people have been killed and about 5000 were badly injured. The Civil Administration under Vijay got activated and started conducting rescue and relief operations. Temporary shelter camps and hospitals were established to provide shelter and medical facilities to the homeless and injured people. Helicopter services were pressed in, for evacuating sick and old people from remote areas. Vijay got a message from his hometown in Kerala that his mother was seriously sick. After two days Vijay received the unfortunate message that his mother has expired. Vijay has no close relative except one elder sister who was US citizen and staying there for last several years. In the meantime, the situation in the affected district deteriorated further due to resumption of heavy rains after a gap of five days. At the same time, continuous messages were coming on his mobile from his hometown to reach at the earliest for performing last rites of his mother.

(a) What are the options available with Vijay?

(b) What are the ethical dilemma being faced by Vijay?

(c) Critically evaluate and examine each of these options identified by Vijay.

(d) Which of the options, do you think, would be most appropriate for Vijay to adopt and why?

(Answer in 250 words) 20

2. In line with the Directive Principles of State Policy enshrined in the Indian Constitution, the government has a constitutional obligation to ensure basic needs – “Roti, Kapda aur Makan (Food, Clothes and Shelter)” – for the under-privileged. Pursuing this mandate, the district administration proposed clearing a portion of forest land to develop housing for the homeless and economically weaker sections of the society.

The proposed land, however, is an ecologically sensitive zone densely populated with age-old trees, medicinal plants and vital biodiversity. Besides, these forests help to regulate micro-climate and rainfalls; provide habitat for wildlife, support soil fertility and prevent land/soil erosion and sustain livelihoods of tribal and nomadic communities.

In spite of the ecological and social costs, the administration argues in favour of the said proposal by highlighting that this very initiative would provide housing to human rights

as a critical welfare priority. Besides it, it fulfils the government's duty to uplift and empower the poor through inclusive housing development. Further, these forest areas have become unsafe due to wild-animal threats and recurring human-wild life conflicts. Lastly, clearing forest-zones may help to curb anti-social elements allegedly using these areas as hideouts, thereby enhancing law and order.

(a) Can deforestation be ethically justified in the pursuit of social welfare objectives like, housing for the homeless?

(b) What are the socio-economic, administrative and ethical challenges in balancing environmental conservation with human development?

(c) What substantial alternatives or policy interventions can be proposed to ensure that both environmental integrity and human dignity are protected? (Answer in 250 words)

20

3. Subash is Secretary, PWD in the State Government. He is a senior officer, known for his competence, integrity and dedication to work. He enjoys the trust and confidence of Minister Incharge of PWD and Programme Implementation. As a part of his job profile, he is responsible for policy formulation, execution of projects relating to infrastructure initiatives in the State. Besides, he oversees the technical and administrative aspects relating to planning, designing and construction etc.

Subash's Minister is an important Minister in the state and significant growth in urban infrastructure development and road network has been registered during his tenure. He is very keen for launching of ambitious road construction project in the near future. Subash is in regular touch with the Minister and is working various modalities of road construction project. Regular meetings, interactions and presentations are made by him to the Minister before a formal public announcement of the project is made by the Minister. Subash's only son Vikas is in real estate business. His son from his own sources is aware that a mega road project is on the anvil and announcement in this regard is expected anytime. He is very keen to know from his father the exact location of the upcoming project. He knows that there would be quantum jump in the prices of land at the proposed location. Buying land at this stage at cheaper prices would pay him rich dividends. He is pleading with him (his father) day in and day out to share him location of the proposed project. He assured him that he would handle the matter discreetly as it would not attract any adverse notice as he in the normal course, keeps on buying land as a part of his business. He feels pressurised because of constant pleadings by his son.

Another significant aspect of the matter pertained to the extra/undue interest in the above project by the Minister PWD. His nephew was also having big infrastructure project company. In fact, the Minister has also introduced his nephew to him and indicated to him to take care of his nephew's business interest in the forthcoming project. The Minister encouraged him to act fast in the matter as early announcement and execution of mega road project would enhance his status in the party and public life. In the above backdrop, Subash is in a fix as to the future course of action.

(a) Discuss the ethical issues involved in the case.

(b) Critically examine the options available to Subash in the above situation.

(c) Which of the above would be most appropriate and why?

(Answer in 250 words)

4. Rajesh is a Group A officer with nine years of service. He is posted as Administrative Officer in an Oil Public Sector undertaking. As an Administrative Officer he is responsible for managing and coordinating various administrative tasks to ensure smooth functioning of office. He also manages office supplies, equipment etc.

Rajesh is now sufficient senior and is expecting his next promotion in JAG (Junior Administrative Grade) in the next one or two years. He knows that promotion is based on examination of ACRs/Performance Appraisal of last few years (5 years or so) of an officer by a DPC (Departmental Promotion Committee) and an officer lacking requisite grading of ACRs may not be found fit for promotion. Consequences of losing promotion may entail financial and reputational loss and set-back for career progression. Though he also puts his best efforts in official discharge of his duties, yet he is unsure of assessment by his superior officer. He is now putting extra efforts so that he gets thumping report at the end of financial year.

As Administrative Officer, Rajesh is regularly interacting with his immediate boss, who is his reporting officer for writing his ACR. One day he calls Rajesh and wants him to buy computer-related stationery on priority from a particular vendor. Rajesh instructs his office to initiate action for procuring these items. During the day, the dealing Assistant brings an estimate of Rupees Thirty Five Lakhs covering all stationery items from the same vendor. It is noticed that as per delegated financial powers, as provided in the GFR (General Financial Rules) as applicable in that Organisation, expenditure for office items exceeding Rupees Thirty Lakhs requires sanction of the next higher authority (boss in the present case). Rajesh knows that immediate superior would expect all these purchases should be done at his level and may not appreciate such lack of initiative on his part. During discussions with office, he learns that common practice of splitting of expenditure (where large order is divided into a series of smaller ones) is followed to avoid obtaining sanction from higher authority. This practice is against the rules and may come to the adverse notice of Audit. Rajesh is perturbed. He is unsure of taking decision in the matter.

- (a) What are the options available with Rajesh in the above situation?
- (b) What are the ethical issues involved in this case?
- (c) Which would be the most appropriate option for Rajesh and why? (Answer in 250 words) 20

5. Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Program, MGNREGA was earlier known as National Rural Employment Scheme, NREGA. It is an Indian Social Welfare Program that aimed at fulfilling the 'Right to Work' provisions made in the Constitution. MGNREGA was launched in 2006 under Rural Employment Sector by the Ministry of Rural Development.

Main objective of the program is to give legal guarantee of wage employment to the adult members of rural households who are willing to do unskilled manual labour work subject to a maximum of 100 days per year for every household. Every rural household has the right to register under the scheme, job card is issued to the registered, Job Card holder can seek employment; State Government shall pay 25% of minimum wage for the first 30 days as compensatory daily unemployment allowance to the families and of wage for remaining period of the year. MGNREGA work was undertaken by various Gram Panchayats.

You have been appointed as an Administrator Incharge of the District. You have been given the responsibility of monitoring MGNREGA work undertaken by various Gram Panchayats. You are also given the authority to give technical sanctions to all MGNREGA works.

In one of the Panchayats in your jurisdiction, you notice that your predecessor has mismanaged the Program in terms of:

- (i) Money not disbursed to actual job-seekers.
- (ii) Muster Rolls of the Labourers not properly maintained.
- (iii) Mismatch between the work done and payments made.
- (iv) Payments made to fictitious persons.
- (v) Job Cards were given without looking into the need of person.
- (vi) Mismanagement of funds and to the extent of siphoning of funds.
- (vii) Approved works that never existed.
 - a) What is your reaction to the above situation and how do you restore the proper functioning of MGNREGA Program in this regard?
 - b) (b) What actions would you initiate, to solve the various issues listed above?
 - c) (c) How would you deal with the above situation? (Answer in 250 words) 20

6. Ashok is Divisional Commissioner of one of the border districts of the North East State. A few years back, Military has taken over the neighbouring country after overthrowing the elected civil government. Civil war situation is prevailing in the country especially in last two years. However, internal situation further deteriorated due to rebel groups taking over control of certain populated areas near own border. Due to intense fight between military and rebel groups, civilian casualties has increased manifold in recent past. In the meantime, in one night Ashok got information from the local police guarding the border check post that there are about 200-250 people mainly women and children trying to cross over to our side of the border. There are also about 10 soldiers with their weapons in military uniform part of this group who wants to cross over. Women and Children are also crying and begging for help. A few of them are injured and bleeding profusely need immediate medical care. Ashok tried to contact Home Secretary of the State but failed to do so due to poor connectivity mainly due to inclement weather.

- (a) What are the options available with Ashok to cope with the situation?
- (b) What are the ethical and legal dilemmas being faced by Ashok?
- (c) Which of the options, do you think would be more appropriate for Ashok to adopt and why?
- (d) In the present situation, what are the extra precautionary measures to be taken by the Border Guarding Police in dealing with soldiers in uniform?

(Answer in 250 words) 20

2023

1) You are heading a leading technical institute in the country. The institute is planning to convene an interview panel shortly under your chairmanship for the selection of the post of professors. A few days before the interview, you get a call from the Personal Secretary (PS) of a senior government functionary seeking your intervention in favour of the selection of a close relative of the functionary for this post. The PS also informs you that he is aware of the long pending and urgent proposals of your institute for grant

of funds for modernization, which are awaiting the functionary's approval. He assures you that he would get these proposals cleared. What are the options available to you? Evaluate each of these options and choose the option which you would adopt, giving reasons.

2) You are the Executive Director of an upcoming InfoTech Company which is making a name for itself in the market. Mr. A, who is a star performer, is heading the marketing team. In a short period of one year, he has helped in doubling the revenues as well as creating high brand equity for the Company so much so that you are thinking of promoting him. However, you have been receiving information from many corners about his attitude towards the female colleagues; particularly his habit of making loose comments on women. In addition, he regularly sends indecent SMS to all the team members including his female colleagues. One day, late in the evening, Mrs. X, who is one of Mr. A's team members, comes to you visibly disturbed. She complains against the continued misconduct of Mr. A, who has been making undesirable advances towards her and has even tried to touch her inappropriately in his cabin. She tendered her resignation and left your office.

What are the options available to you?

Evaluate each of these options and choose the option you would adopt, giving reasons

3) You are working as an Executive Engineer in the construction cell of a Municipal Corporation and are presently in-charge of the construction of a flyover. There are two Junior Engineers under you who have the responsibility of day-to-day inspection of the site and are reporting to you, while you are finally reporting to the Chief Engineer who heads the cell. While the construction is heading towards completion, the Junior Engineers have been regularly reporting that all construction is taking place as per design specifications. However, in one of your surprise inspections, you have noticed some serious deviations and lacunae which, in your opinion, are likely to affect the safety of the flyover. Rectification of these lacunae at this stage would require a substantial amount of demolition and rework which will cause a tangible loss to the contractor and will also delay completion. There is a lot of public pressure on the Corporation to get this construction completed because of heavy traffic congestion in the area. When you brought this matter to the notice of the Chief Engineer, he advised you that in his opinion it is not a very serious lapse and may be ignored. He advised for further expediting the project for completion in time. However, you are convinced that this was a serious matter which might affect public safety and should not be left unaddressed.

What will you do in such a situation? Some of the options are given below. Evaluate the merits and demerits of each of these options and finally suggest what course of action you would like to take, giving reasons.

4) Sivakasi in Tamil Nadu is known for its manufacturing clusters on firecrackers and matches. The local economy of the area is largely dependent on firecrackers industry. It has led to tangible economic development and improved standard of living in the area.

So far as child labour norms for hazardous industries like firecrackers industry are

concerned, International Labour Organization (ILO) has set the minimum age as 18 years. In India, however, this age is 14 years.

The units in industrial clusters of firecrackers can be classified into registered and non-registered entities. One typical unit is household-based work. Though the law is clear on the use of child labour employment norms in registered/non-registered units, it does not include household-based works. Household-based work means children working under the supervision of their parents/relatives. To evade child labour norms, several units project themselves as household-based works but employ children from outside. Needless to say that employing children saves the costs for these units leading to higher profits to the owners.

On your visit to one of the units at Sivakasi, the owner takes you around the unit which has about 10-15 children below 14 years of age. The owner tells you that in his household-based unit, the children are all his relatives. You notice that several children smirk, when the owner tells you this. On deeper enquiry, you figure out that neither the owner nor the children are able to satisfactorily establish their relationship with each other.

Bring out and discuss the ethical issues involved in the above case. What would be your reaction after your above visit?

5) A Public Information Officer has received an application under RTI Act. Having gathered the information, the PIO discovers that the information pertains to some of the decisions taken by him, which were found to be not altogether right. There were other employees also who party to these decisions were. Disclosure of the information is likely to lead to disciplinary action with possibility of punishment against him as well as some of his colleagues. Non-disclosure or part disclosure or camouflaged disclosure of information will result into lesser punishment or no punishment.

The PIO is otherwise an honest and conscientious person but this particular decision, on which the RTI application has been filed, turned out to be wrong. He comes to you for advice. The following are some suggested options. Please evaluate the merits and demerits of each of the options:

The PIO could refer the matter to his superior officer and seek his advice and act strictly in accordance with the advice, even though he is not completely in agreement with the advice of the superior.

The PIO could proceed on leave and leave the matter to be dealt by his successor in office or request for transfer of the application to another PIO.

The PIO could weigh the consequences of disclosing the information truthfully, including the effect on his career, and reply in a manner that would not place him or his career in jeopardy, but at the same time a little compromise can be made on the contents of the information.

The PIO could consult his other colleagues who are party to the decision and take action as per their advice.

Also please indicate (without necessarily restricting to the above options) what you would like to advise, giving proper reasons. (20 marks| 250 words)

6). As a senior officer in the Finance Ministry, you have access to some confidential and crucial information about policy decisions that the Government is about to announce. These decisions are likely to have far-reaching impact on the housing and construction industry. If the builders have access to this information beforehand, they can make huge profits. One of the builders has done a lot of quality work for the Government and is known to be close to

your immediate superior, who asks you to disclose this information to the said builder. (20 marks| 250 words)

What are the options available to you?

Evaluate each of these options and choose the option which you would adopt, giving reasons

2014

1) Rameshwar successfully cleared the prestigious civil services examination and was excited about the opportunity that he would get through the civil services to serve the country.

However, soon after joining the services, he realized that things are not as rosy as he had imagined. He found a number of malpractices prevailing in the department assigned to him. For example, funds under various schemes and grants were being misappropriated. The official facilities were frequently being used for personal needs by the officers and staff.

After some time, he noticed that the process of recruiting the staff was also not up to the mark. Prospective candidates were required to write an examination in which a lot of cheating was going on. Some candidates were provided external help in the examination. Rameshwar brought these incidents to the notice of his seniors. However, he was advised to keep his eyes, ears and mouth shut and ignore all these things which were taking place with the connivance of the higher-ups. Rameshwar felt highly disillusioned and uncomfortable.

He comes to you seeking your advice. Indicate various options that you think are available in this situation. How would you help him to evaluate these options and choose the most appropriate path to be adopted?

2.) In our country, the migration of rural people to towns and cities is increasing drastically. This is causing serious problems both in the rural as well as in the urban areas. In fact, things are becoming really unmanageable. Can you analyse this problem in detail and indicate not only the socioeconomic but also the emotional and attitudinal factors responsible for this problem? Also, distinctly bring out why Educated youth are trying to shift to urban areas

Landless poor people are migrating to urban slums Even some farmers are selling off the land and trying to settle in urban areas taking petty jobs.

What feasible steps can you suggest which will be effective in controlling this serious problem in our

country?

3) You are a no-nonsense, honest officer. You have been transferred to a remote district to head a department that is notorious for its inefficiency and callousness. You find that the main cause of the poor state of affairs is the indiscipline of a section of employees. They do not work themselves and also disrupt the working of others. You first warned the troublemakers to mend their ways or else face disciplinary action. When the warning had little effect, you issued a show cause notice to the ringleaders. As a retaliatory measure, these troublemakers instigated a woman employee amongst them to file a complaint of sexual harassment against you with the Women's Commission. The Commission promptly

seeks your explanation. The matter is also publicized in the media to embarrass you further. Some of the options to handle this situation could be as follows :

Give your explanation to the Commission and go soft on the disciplinary action. Ignore the Commission and proceed firmly with the disciplinary action. Brief your higher-ups, seek directions from them and act accordingly.

Suggest any other possible option(s). Evaluate all of them and suggest the best course of action, giving your reasons for it

4) Suppose one of your close friends, who is also aspiring for civil services, comes to you for discussing some of the issues related to ethical conduct in public service. He raises the following points:

In the present times, when unethical environment is quite prevalent, individual attempts to stick to ethical principles may cause a lot of problems in one's career. It may also cause hardship to the family members as well as risk to one's life. Why should we not be pragmatic and follow the path of least resistance, and be happy with doing whatever good we can?

When so many people are adopting wrong means and are grossly harming the system, what difference would it make if only a small minority tries to be ethical? They are going to be rather ineffective and are bound to get frustrated.

If we become fussy about ethical considerations, will it not hamper the economic progress of our country? After all, in the present age of high competition, we cannot afford to be left behind in the race of development.

It is understandable that we should not get involved in grossly unethical practices, but giving and accepting small gratifications and doing small favours increases everybody's motivation. It also makes the system more efficient. What is wrong in adopting such practices?

Critically analyze the above viewpoints. On the basis of this analysis, what will be your advice to your friend? 250 words.

5) Now-a-days, there is an increasing thrust on economic development all around the globe. At the same time, there is also an increasing concern about environmental

degradation caused by development. Many a time, we face a direct conflict between developmental activity and environmental quality. It is neither feasible to stop or curtail the development process, nor it is advisable to keep degrading the environment, as it threatens our very survival.

Discuss some feasible strategies which could be adopted to eliminate this conflict and which could lead to sustainable development. 250 words

6) In our country, the migration of rural people to towns and cities is increasing drastically. This is causing serious problems both in the rural as well as in the urban areas. In fact, things are becoming really unmanageable. Can you analyze this problem in detail and indicate not

only the socio-economic but also the emotional and attitudinal factors responsible for this problem? Also, distinctly bring out why—

Educated rural youth are trying to shift to urban areas; Landless poor people are migrating to urban slums;

Even some farmers are selling off their land and trying to settle in urban areas taking up petty jobs.

What feasible steps can you suggest which will be effective in controlling this serious problem of our country?

7) Suppose you are the CEO of a company that manufactures specialized electronic equipment used by a government department. You have submitted your bid for the supply of this equipment to the department. Both the quality and cost of your offer are better than those of the competitors. Yet the concerned officer is demanding a hefty bribe for approving the tender. Getting the order is important both for you and for your company. Not getting the order would mean closing a production line. It may also affect your own career. However, as a value-conscious person, you do not want to give bribe.

Valid arguments can be advanced both for giving the bribe and getting the order, and for refusing to pay the bribe and risking the loss of the order. What those arguments could be? Could there be any better way to get out of this dilemma? If so outline the main elements of this third way, pointing out its merits. 250 words.

2015

1) One of the scientists working in the R&D laboratory of a major pharmaceutical company discovers that one of the company's best selling veterinary drugs has the potential to cure a currently incurable liver disease which is prevalent in tribal areas. However, developing a variant of the drug suitable for human beings entailed a lot of research and development having a huge expenditure to the extent of Rs. 50 crores. It was unlikely that the company would recover the cost as the disease was rampant only in poverty-stricken areas having very little market otherwise. If you were the CEO, then identify the various actions that you could take. Evaluate the pros and cons of each of

your actions?

2) You are recently posted as district development officer of a district. Shortly thereafter you found that there is considerable tension in the rural areas of your district on the issue of sending girls to schools. The elders of the village feel that many problems have come up because girls are being educated and they are stepping out of the safe environment of the household. They are of the view that the girls should be quickly married off with minimum education. The girls are also competing for jobs after education, which have traditionally remained in boys' exclusive domain, adding to unemployment amongst male population.

The younger generation feels that in the present era, girls should have equal opportunities for education and employment, and other means of livelihood. The entire locality is divided

between the elders and the younger lot and further sub-divided between sexes in both generations. You come to know that in Panchayat or in other local bodies or even in buscrossroads, the issue is being acrimoniously debated.

One day you are informed that an unpleasant incident has taken place. Some girls were molested, when they were en route to schools. The incident led to clashes between several groups and a law and order problem has arisen. The elders after heated discussion have taken a joint decision not to allow girls to go to school and to socially boycott all such families, which do not follow their dictate.

What steps would you take to ensure girls' safety without disrupting their education?

How would you manage and mould matriarchic attitude of the village elders to ensure harmony in the inter-generational relations?

3) You are heading a district administration in a particular department. Your senior officer calls you from the State Headquarters and tells you that a plot in Rampur village is to have a building constructed on it for a school. A visit is scheduled during which he will visit the site along with the chief engineer and the senior architect. He wants you to check out all the papers relating to it and to ensure that the visit is properly arranged. You examine the file which relates to the period before you joined the department. The land was acquired from the local Panchayat at a nominal cost and the papers show that clearance certificates are available from the two of the three authorities who have to certify the site's suitability. There is no certification by the architect available on file. You decide to visit Rampur to ensure that all is in order as stated on file. When you visit Rampur, you find that the plot under reference is part of Thakurgarh Fort and that the walls, ramparts, etc., are running across it. The fort is well away from the main village, therefore a school here will be a serious inconvenience for the children. However, the area near the village has potential to expand into a larger residential area. The development charges on the existing plot, at the fort, will be very high and the question of heritage site has not been addressed. Moreover, the Sarpanch, at the time of acquisition of the land, was a relative of your predecessor. The whole transaction appears to have been done with some vested interest.

List the likely vested interests of the concerned parties.

Some of the options for action available to you are listed below. Discuss the merits and demerits of each of the options :

You can await the visit of the superior officer and let him take a decision. You can seek his advice in writing or on phone.

You can consult your predecessor/colleagues, etc., and then decide what to do.

You can find out if any alternate plot can be got in exchange and then send a comprehensive written report.

Can you suggest any other option with proper justification?

4) You are the Sarpanch of a Panchayat. There is a primary school run by the government in your area. Midday meals are provided to the children attending the school. The Headmaster has now appointed a new cook in the school to prepare the meals. However, when it is found that the cook is from Dalit community, almost half of the children belonging to higher castes are not allowed to take meals by their parents. Consequently the attendance in the school falls sharply. This could result in the possibility of discontinuation of midday meal scheme, thereafter of teaching staff and subsequent closing down the school.

Discuss some feasible strategies to overcome the conflict and to create right ambience.

What should be the responsibilities of different social segments and agencies to create positive social ambience for accepting such changes?

5) There is a disaster-prone State having frequent landslides, forest fires, cloudbursts, flash floods and earthquakes, etc. Some of these are seasonal and often unpredictable. The magnitude of the disaster is always unanticipated. During one of the seasons, a cloudburst caused devastating floods and landslides leading to high casualties. There was major damage to infrastructure like roads, bridges and power generating units. This led to more than 100000 pilgrims, tourists and other locals trapped across different routes and locations. The people trapped in your area of responsibility included senior citizens, patients in hospitals, women and children, hikers, tourists, ruling party's regional president along with his family, additional jail. As secretary State and prisoners in jail.

As a civil services officer of the State, what would be the order in which you would rescue these people and why? Give justifications.

6) A private company is known for its efficiency, transparency and employee welfare. The company though owned by a private individual has a cooperative character where employees feel a sense of ownership. The company employs nearly 700 personnel and they have voluntarily decided not to form a union.

One day suddenly in the morning, about 40 men belonging to a political party gatecrashed into the factory demanding jobs in the factory. They threatened the management and employees, and also used foul language. The employees feel demoralized. It was clear that those people who gate-crashed wanted to be on the

payroll of the company as well as continue as the volunteers/members of the party. The company maintains high standards in integrity and does not extend favours to civil administration that also includes law enforcement agency. Such incidents occur in public sector also.

Assume you are the CEO of the company. What would you do to diffuse the volatile situation on the date of gate-crashing with the violent mob sitting inside the company

What could be the long-term solution to the issue discussed in the case?

Every solution/action that you suggest will have a positive and a negative impact on you (as CEO), the employees and the performance of the employees. Analyze the consequences of each of your suggested actions. (250 words)

2016

1.) A fresh engineering graduate gets a job in the prestigious chemical industry. She likes the work. The salary is also good. However, after a few months, she accidentally discovers that highly toxic Waste is being secretly discharged into a river nearby. This is causing health problems to the villagers downstream who depend on the river for their water needs. She is perturbed and mentions her concern to her colleagues who have been with the company for longer periods. They advise her to keep quiet as anyone who mentions the topic is summarily dismissed. She cannot risk losing her job as she is the sole bread-winner for her family and has to support her ailing parents and siblings. At first, she thinks that if her seniors are keeping quiet, why should she stick out her neck. But her conscience pricks her to do something to save the river and the people who depend upon it. At heart, she feels that the advice of silence given by her friends is not correct though she cannot give reasons for it. She thinks you are a wise person and seeks your advice. What arguments can you advance to show her that keeping quiet is not morally right? What course of action would you advise her to adopt and why?

2.) You are a young, aspiring and sincere employee in a government office working as an assistant to the director of your department. Since you have joined recently, you need to learn and progress. Luckily your superior is very kind and ready to train you for your job. He is a very intelligent and well-informed person having knowledge of various departments. In short, you respect your boss and are looking forward to learning a lot from him. Since you have good tuning with the boss, he started depending on you. One day due to ill health he invited you to his place for finishing some urgent work. You reached his house and before you could ring the bell you heard shouting noises. You waited for a while. After entering the house, the boss greeted you and explained the work. But you were constantly disturbed by the crying of a woman. At last, you inquired with the boss but his answer did not satisfy you. The next day, you were compelled to inquire further in the office and found out that his behaviour is very bad at home with his wife. He also beats up his wife. His wife is not well educated and is a simple woman in comparison to her husband. You see that though your boss is a nice person in the office, he is engaged in domestic violence at home. In such a situation, you are left with the following options. Analyse each option with its consequences. Just ignore thinking about it because it is their personal matter. Report the case to the

appropriate authority. Your own innovative approach towards the situation.

3.) ABC Ltd. is a large transnational company having diversified business activities with a huge shareholder base. The company is continuously expanding generating employment. The company, in its expansion and diversification program, decides to establish a new plant at Vikaspuri, an area that is underdeveloped. The new plant is designed to use energy-

efficient technology that will help the company to save production costs by 20%. The company's decision goes well with the Government policy of attracting investment to develop such underdeveloped regions. The government has also announced a tax holiday for five years for the companies that invest in

underdeveloped areas. However, the new plant may bring chaos for the inhabitants of Vikaspuri region, which is otherwise tranquil. The new plant may result in an increased cost of living, aliens migrating to the region, disturbing the social and economic order. The company sensing the possible protest tried to educate the people of Vikaspuri region and the public in general that its Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) policy would help overcome the likely difficulties of the residents of Vikaspuri region. In spite of this, the protests began and some of the residents decided to approach the judiciary as their plea before the Government did not yield any result. Identify the issues involved

4) Suppose you are an officer in-charge of implementing a social service scheme to provide support to old and destitute women. An old and illiterate woman comes to you to avail the benefits of the scheme. However, she has no documents to show that she fulfils the eligibility criteria. But after meeting her and listening to her you feel that she certainly needs support. Your enquiries also show that she is really destitute and living in a pitiable condition. You are in a dilemma as to what to do. Putting her under the scheme without documents would clearly be violation of rules. But denying her the support would be cruel and inhuman.

Can you think of a rational way to resolve this dilemma? Give your reasons for it.)

5) Land needed for mining, dams and other large-scale projects is acquired mostly from Adivasis, hill dwellers and rural communities. The displaced persons are paid monetary compensation as per the legal provisions. However, the payment is often tardy. In any case, it cannot sustain the displaced families for long. These people do not possess marketable skills to engage in some other occupation. They end up as low paid migrant labourers. Moreover, their living is destroyed. Thus, the benefits of traditional ways of community development go to industries, industrialists and urban communities whereas the costs are passed on to these poor helpless people. This unjust distribution of costs and benefits is unethical. Suppose you have been entrusted with the task of drafting a better compensation-cum-rehabilitation policy for such displaced persons, how would you approach the problem and what would be the main elements of your suggested policy? (250 words)

6) Saraswathi was a successful IT professional in USA. Moved by the patriotic sense of doing something for the country she returned to India. Together with some other like-

mindful friends, she formed an NGO to build a school for a poor rural community.

The objective of the school was to provide the best quality modern education at a nominal cost. She soon discovered that she has to seek permission from a number of Government agencies. The rules and procedures were quite confusing and cumbersome. What

frustrated her most was the delays, callous attitude of officials and constant demand of bribes. Her experience and the experience of many others like her has deterred people from taking up social service projects.

A measure of Government control over voluntary social work is necessary. But it should not be exercised in a coercive or corrupt manner. What measures can you suggest to ensure that due control is exercised but well meaning, honest NGO efforts are not thwarted?

2017

1. You are aspiring to become an IAS officer and you have cleared various stages and now you have been selected for the personal interview. On the day of the interview, on the way to the venue, you saw an accident where a mother and child who happen to be your relatives were badly injured. They needed immediate help. What would you have done in such a situation? Justify your action.

2. You are the manager of a spare parts company A and you have to negotiate a deal with the manager of a large manufacturing company B. The deal is highly competitive and sealing the deal is critical for your company. The deal is being worked out over dinner. After dinner, the manager of manufacturing company B offered to drop you to the hotel in his car. On the way to the hotel, he happens to hit a motorcycle injuring the motorcyclist badly. You know the manager was driving fast and thus lost control. The law enforcement officer comes to investigate the issue and you are the sole eyewitness to it. Knowing the strict laws pertaining to road accidents you are aware that your honest account of the incident would lead to the prosecution of the manager and as a consequence the deal is likely to be jeopardised, which is of immense importance to your company. What are the dilemmas you face?

What will be your response to the situation?

3) A building permitted for three floors, while being extended illegally to 6 floors by a builder, collapses. As a consequence, a number of innocent labourers including women and children died. These labourers are migrants of different places. The government immediately announced cash relief to the aggrieved families and arrested the builder. Give reasons for such incidents taking place across the country. Suggest measures to prevent their occurrence. (250 Words, 20)

4) You are an honest and responsible civil servant. You often observe the following:

There is a general perception that adhering to ethical conduct one may face difficulties to oneself and cause problems for the family, whereas unfair practices may help to reach the career goals.

When the number of people adopting unfair means is large, a small minority having an penchant towards ethical means makes no difference.

Sticking to ethical means is detrimental to the larger developmental goals
While one may not involve oneself in large unethical practices, but giving and accepting small gifts makes the system more efficient.

Examine the above statements with their merits and demerits.

5) You are a Public Information Officer (PIO) in a government department. You are aware that the RTI Act 2005 envisages transparency and accountability in administration. The act has functioned as a check on the supposedly arbitrarily administrative behaviour and actions. However, as a PIO you have observed that there are citizens who filed RTI applications not for themselves but on behalf of such stakeholders who purportedly want to have access to information to further their own interests. At the same time there are these RTI activists who routinely file RTI applications and attempt to extort money from the decision makers. This type of RTI activism has affected the functioning of the administration adversely and also possibly jeopardises the genuineness of the applications which are essentially aimed at getting justice. What measures would you suggest to separate genuine and non-genuine applications? Give merits and demerits of your suggestions. (250 Words, 20)

6) You are the head of the Human Resources department of an organisation. One day one of the workers died on duty. His family was demanding compensation. However, the company denied compensation because it was revealed in investigation that he was drunk at the time of the accident. The workers of the company went to strike demanding compensation for the family of the deceased. The Chairman of the management board has asked for your recommendation. What recommendation would you provide the management? Discuss the merits and demerits of each of the recommendations. (250 Words, 20)

2018

As a senior officer in the Ministry, you have access to important policy decisions and upcoming big announcements such as road construction projects before they are notified in the public domain. The Ministry is about to announce a mega road project for which the drawings are already in place. Sufficient care was taken by the planners to make use of the government land with the minimum land acquisition from private parties. The compensation rate for private parties was also finalized as per government rules. Care was also taken to minimize deforestation. Once the project is announced, it is expected that there will be a huge spurt in real estate prices in and around that area. Meanwhile, the Minister concerned insists that you realign the road in such a way that it comes closer to his 20 acres farmhouse. He also suggests that he would facilitate the purchase of a big plot of land in your wife's name at the prevailing rate which is very nominal, in and around the proposed mega road project. He also tries to convince you by saying that there is no harm in it as he is buying the land legally. He even promises to supplement

your savings in case you do not have sufficient funds to buy the land. However, by the act of realignment, a lot of agricultural lands has to be acquired, thereby causing a considerable financial burden on the government, and also the displacement of the farmers. As if this is not enough, it will involve cutting down a large number of trees denuding the area of its green cover. Faced with this situation, what will you do? Critically examine various conflicts of interest and explain what your responsibilities are as a public servant.

1. Edward Snowden, a computer expert and former CIA administrator, released confidential

Government documents to the press about the existence of Government surveillance programmes.

According to many legal experts and the US Government, his action violated the Espionage act of 1971, which identified the leak of State secret as an act of treason. Yet, despite the fact that he broke the law, Snowden argued that he had a moral obligation to act. He gave a justification for his

“Whistle blowing” by stating that he had a duty “to inform the public as to that which is done in their name and that which is done against them.” According to Snowden, the Government’s violation of

privacy had to be exposed regardless of legality since more substantive issues of social action and public morality were involved here. Many agreed with Snowden. Few argued that he broke the law and compromised national security, for which he should be held accountable. Do you agree that Snowden’s actions were ethically justified even if legally prohibited? Why or why not?

Make an argument by weighing the competing values in this case

- 3) Rakesh is a responsible district level officer, who enjoys the trust of his higher officials. Knowing his honesty, the government entrusted him with the responsibility of identifying the beneficiaries under a health care scheme meant for senior citizens. The criteria to be a beneficiary are the following:

60 years of age or above.

Belonging to a reserved community.

Family income of less than 1 Lakh rupees per annum.

Post-treatment prognosis is likely to be high to make a positive difference to the quality of life of the beneficiary.

One day, an old couple visited Rakesh’s office with their application. They have been the residents of a village in his district since their birth. The old man is diagnosed with a

rare condition that causes obstruction in the large intestine. As a consequence, he has severe abdominal pain frequently that prevents him from doing any physical labour. The couple has no children to support them. The expert surgeon whom they contacted is willing to do the surgery without charging any fee. However, the couple will have to bear the cost of incidental charges, such as medicines, hospitalization, etc., to the tune of rupees one lakh.

The couple fulfils all the criteria except criterion 'b'. However, any financial aid would certainly make a significant difference in their quality of life. How should Rakesh respond to the situation?

4) Dr X is a leading medical practitioner in a city. He has set up a charitable trust through which he plans to establish a super-speciality hospital in the city to cater to the medical needs of all sections of the society. Incidentally, that part of the State had been neglected over the years. The proposed hospital would be a boon for the region. You are heading the tax investigation agency of that region. During an inspection of the doctor's clinic, your officers have found out some major irregularities. A few of them are substantial which had resulted in considerable withholding of tax that should be paid by him now. The doctor is cooperative. He undertakes to pay the tax immediately. However, there are certain other deficiencies in his tax compliance which are purely technical in nature. If these technical defaults are pursued by the agency, considerable time and energy of the doctor will be diverted to issues which are not so serious, urgent or even helpful to the tax collection process. Further, in all probability, it will hamper the prospects of the hospital coming up. There are two options before you:



I

A

S



Taking a broader view, ensure substantial tax compliance and ignore defaults that are merely technical in nature.

Pursue the matter strictly and proceed on all fronts, whether substantial or merely technical.

As the head of the tax agency, which course of action will you opt and why?

5) It is a State where prohibition is in force. You are recently appointed as the Superintendent of Police of a district notorious for illicit distillation of liquor. The illicit liquor leads to many deaths, reported and unreported, and causes a major problem for the district authorities. The approach till now had been to view it as a law and order problem and tackle it accordingly. Raids, arrests, police cases, and criminal trials – all these had only limited impact. The problem remains as serious as ever. Your inspections show that the parts of the district where the distillation flourishes are economically, industrially and educationally backward. Agriculture is badly affected by poor irrigation facilities. Frequent clashes among communities gave boost to illicit distillation. No major initiatives had taken place in the past either from the government's side or from social organizations to improve the lot of the people. Which new approach will you adopt to bring the problem under control?

6) A big corporate house is engaged in manufacturing industrial chemicals on a large scale. It proposes to set up an additional unit. Many states rejected its proposal due to the detrimental effect on the environment. But one state government acceded to the request and permitted the unit close to a city, brushing aside all opposition. The unit was set up 10 years ago and was in full swing till recently. The pollution caused by the industrial effluents was affecting the land, water and crops in the area. It was also causing serious health problems to human beings and animals. This gave rise to a series of agitation thousands of people took part, creating a law and order problem necessitating stern police action. Following the public outcry, the State government ordered the closure of the factory. The closure of the factory resulted in the unemployment of not only those workers who were engaged in the factory but also those who were working in the ancillary units. It also very badly affected those industries which depended on the chemicals manufactured by it. As a senior officer entrusted with the responsibility of handling this issue, how are you going to address it?

2019

1.) An apparel manufacturing company having a large number of women employees was losing sales due to various factors. The company hired a reputed marketing executive, who increased the volume of sales within a short span of time. However, some unconfirmed reports came up regarding

his indulgence in sexual harassment at the workplace. After some time a woman employee launched a formal complaint to the management against the marketing executive about sexually harassing her. Faced with the companies' indifference, in not taking cognizance of her grievances, she lodged an FIR with the police. Realizing the

sensitivity and gravity of the situation, the company called the woman employee to negotiate. In that, she was offered a hefty sum of money to withdraw the complaint and the FIR and also give in writing that the marketing executive is not involved in the case. Identify the ethical issues involved in this case. What options are available to the woman employee?

2) In a modern democratic polity, there is a concept of the political executive and permanent executive. Elected people's representatives form the political executive and bureaucracy form the permanent executive. Ministers frame policy decisions and bureaucrats execute these. In the initial decades after independence, the relationship between the permanent executives and the political executives were characterized by mutual understanding, respect, and cooperation, without encroaching upon each other's domain.

However, in subsequent decades, the situation has changed. There are instances of the political executive insisting upon the permanent executives to follow its agenda. Respect for an appreciation of upright bureaucrats has declined. There is an increasing tendency among the political executive to get involved in routine administrative matters such as transfers, posting etc. Under this scenario, there is a definitive trend towards 'politicization of bureaucracy'. The rising materialism and acquisitiveness in social life has also adversely impacted upon the ethical values of both the permanent executive and the political executive.

What are the consequences of this 'politicization of bureaucracy'? Discuss.

3) You are heading the rescue operations in an area affected by severe natural calamity, thousands of people are rendered homeless and deprived of food, drinking water and other basic amenities. Rescue work has been disrupted by heavy rainfall and damaged supply routes. The local people are seething with anger against the delayed limited rescue operations. When your team reaches the affected area, the people there heckle and even assault some of the team members. One of your team members is even severely injured. Faced with this crisis some team member pleads with you to call off the operations freeing threats to their life.

In such trying circumstances, what will be your response? Examine the qualities of a public servant which will be required to manage the situations.

4) In one of the districts of a frontier state, narcotics menace has been rampant. This has resulted in money laundering, mushrooming of poppy farming, arms smuggling and near stalling of education. The system is on the verge of collapse. The situation has been further worsened by unconfirmed reports that local politicians, as well as some senior police officers, are providing surreptitious patronage to the drug mafia. At that point of time a woman police officer, known for her skills in handling such situations is appointed as superintendent of police to bring the situation to normalcy.

If you are the same police officer, identify the various dimensions of the crisis. Based on your understanding, suggest measures to deal with the crisis.

5) In recent times, there has been an increasing concern in India to develop effective

civil service ethics, code of conduct, transparency measures, ethics and integrity systems and anti-corruption agencies. In view of this, there is a need being felt to focus on three specific areas, which are directly relevant to the problems of internalizing integrity and ethics in the civil services. These are as follows:

Anticipating specific threats to ethical standards and integrity in the civil services,

Strengthening the ethical competence of civil servant and

Developing administrative processes and practices which promote ethical values and integrity in civil services.

Suggest institutional measures to address the above three issues. (250 words) (20 marks)

6) Honesty and uprightness are the hallmarks of civil servants. Civil servants possessing these qualities are considered as a backbone of any strong organizations. In the line of duty, they take various decisions, at times some become bonafide mistakes. As long as such decisions are not taken intentionally and do not benefit personally, the officer cannot be said to be guilty. Though such decisions may, at times, lead to unforeseen adverse consequences in the long term.

In the recent past, a few instances have surfaced wherein civil servants have been implicated for bonafide mistakes. They have often been prosecuted and even imprisoned. These instances have greatly rattled the moral fibre of the civil servants.

How does this trend affect the functioning of civil services? What measures can be taken to ensure that honest civil servants are not implicated for bonafide mistakes on their part?

Justify your answer. (250 words) (20 marks)

2020

1.) Rajesh Kumar is a senior public servant, with a reputation of honesty and forthrightness, currently posted in the Finance Ministry as Head of the Budget Division. His department is presently busy organising the budgetary support to the states, four of which are due to go to the polls within the financial year.

This year's annual budget had allotted 78300 crores for the National Housing Scheme (NHS), a centrally sponsored social housing scheme for the weaker sections of society. 775 crores have been drawn for NHS till June. The Ministry of Commerce had long been pursuing a case for setting up a Special Economic Zone (SEZ) in a southern state to boost exports. After two years of detailed

discussions between the centre and state, the Union Cabinet approved the project in August. The process was initiated to acquire the necessary land.

Eighteen months ago, a leading Public Sector Unit (PSU) had projected the need for setting up a large natural gas processing plant in a northern state for the regional gas grid. The required land is already in possession of the PSU. The gas grid is an essential component of the national energy security strategy. After three rounds of global bidding, the project was allotted to an MNC, M/s XYZ Hydrocarbons. The first tranche of payment to the MNC is scheduled to be made in December.

Finance Ministry was asked for a timely allocation of an additional 6000 crores for these

two developmental projects. It was decided to recommend re-appropriation of this entire amount from the NHS allocation. The file was forwarded to the Budget Department for their comments and further processing. On studying the case file, Rajesh Kumar realized that this re-appropriation may cause an inordinate delay in the execution of NHS, a project much publicized in the rallies of senior politicians. Correspondingly, the non-availability of finances would cause a financial loss in the SEZ and national embarrassment due to delayed payment in an international project. Rajesh Kumar discussed the matter with his seniors. He was conveyed that this politically sensitive situation needs to be processed immediately. Rajesh Kumar realized that diversion of funds from NHS could raise difficult questions for the government in the Parliament.

Discuss the following with reference to this case:

Ethical issues involved in re-appropriation of funds from a welfare project to the developmental projects. Given the need for proper utilization of public funds, discuss the options available to Rajesh Kumar. Is resigning a worthy option?

2.) The Chairman of Bharat Missiles Ltd (BML) was watching a program on TV wherein the Prime Minister was addressing the nation on the necessity of developing a self-reliant India. He subconsciously nodded in agreement and smiled to himself as he mentally reviewed BML's journey in the past two decades. BML had admirably progressed from producing first-generation anti-tank guided missiles (ATGMS) to designing and producing state of the art ATGM weapon systems that would be the envy of any army. He sighed in reconciliation with his assumptions that the government would probably not alter the status quo of a ban on the export of military weaponry. To his surprise, the very next day he got a telephone call from the Director-General, Ministry of Defence, asking him to discuss the modalities of increasing BML production of ATGMS as there is a possibility of exporting the same to a friendly foreign country. The Director-General wanted the Chairman to discuss the details with his staff at Delhi next week. Two days later, at a press conference, the defence minister stated that he aims to double the current weapons export levels within five years. This would give an impetus to financing the development and manufacture of indigenous weapons in the country. He also stated that all indigenous arms manufacturing nations have a very good record of the international arms trade. As Chairman of BML, what are your views on the following points? As an arms exporter of a responsible nation like India, what are the ethical issues involved in the arms trade? List five ethical factors that would influence the decision to sell arms to foreign governments.

3.) Rampura, a remote district inhabited by a tribal population, is marked by extreme backwardness and abject poverty. Agriculture is the mainstay of the local population, though it is primarily subsistence due to the very small landholdings. There is an insignificant industrial or mining activity. Even the targeted welfare programs have inadequately benefited the tribal population. In this Restrictive scenario, the youth has begun to migrate to other states to supplement the family income. The plight of minor girls is that their parents are persuaded by labour contractors to send them to work in the Bt Cotton farms of a nearby state. The soft fingers of the minor girls are well suited

for plucking the cotton. The inadequate living and working conditions in these farms have caused serious health issues for the minor girls. NGOs in the districts of domicile and the cotton farms appear to be compromised and have not effectively espoused the twin issues of child labour and development of the area. You are appointed as the District Collector of Rampura. Identify the ethical issues involved. Which specific steps will you initiate to ameliorate the conditions of minor girls of your district and to improve the overall economic scenario in the district?

4) Migrant workers have always remained at the socio-economic margins of our society, silently serving as the instrumental labour force of urban economics. The pandemic has brought them into national focus.

On announcement of a countrywide lockdown, a very large number of migrant workers decided to move back from their places of employment to their native villages. The non-availability of transport created its own problems. Added to this was the fear of starvation and inconvenience to their families. This caused, the migrant workers to demand wages and transport facilities for returning to their villages. Their mental agony was accentuated by multiple factors such as a sudden loss of livelihood, possibility of lack of food and inability to assist in harvesting their rabi crop due to not being able to reach home in time. Reports of inadequate response of some districts in providing the essential boarding and lodging arrangements along the way multiplied their fears.

You have learnt many lessons from this situation when you were tasked to oversee the functioning of the District Disaster Relief Force in your district. In your opinion what ethical issues arose in the current migrant crisis? What do you understand by an ethical care giving state? What assistance can the civil society render to mitigate the sufferings of migrants in similar situations?

5) You are a municipal commissioner of a large city, having the reputation of a very honest and upright officer. A huge multipurpose mall is under construction in your city in which a large number of daily wage earners are employed. One night, during monsoons, a big chunk

of the roof collapsed causing instant death of four labourers including two minors. Many more were seriously injured requiring immediate medical attention. The mishap resulted in a big hue and cry, forcing the government to institute an enquiry.

Your preliminary enquiry has revealed a series of anomalies. The material used for the construction was of poor quality. Despite the approved building plans permitting only one basement, an additional basement has been constructed. This was overlooked during the periodic inspections by the building inspector of the municipal corporation. In your enquiry, you noticed that the construction of the mall was given the green signal despite encroaching on areas earmarked for a green belt and a slip road in the Zonal Master Plan of the city. The permission to construct the mall was accorded by the previous Municipal Commissioner who is not only your senior and well known to you professionally, but also a good friend.

Prima facie, the case appears to be of a widespread nexus between officials of the Municipal Corporation and the builders. Your colleagues are putting pressure on you to go slow in the enquiry. The builder, who is rich and influential, happens to be a close relative of a powerful minister in the state cabinet. The builder is persuading you to hush up the matter, promising you a fortune to do so. He also hinted that if this matter is not resolved at the earliest in his favour there is somebody in his office who is waiting to file a case against you under the POSH act.

Discuss the ethical issues involved in the case. What are the options available to you in this situation? Explain your selected course of action. (250 words)

6) Parmal is a small but underdeveloped district. It has a rocky terrain that is not suitable for agriculture, though some subsistence agriculture is being done on small plots of land. The area receives adequate rainfall and has an irrigation canal flowing through it. Amria, its administrative centre, is a medium-sized town. It houses a large district hospital, an Industrial Training Institute and some privately owned skill training centres. It has all the facilities of a district headquarters. A trunk railway line passes approximately 50 kilometers from Amria. Its poor connectivity is a major reason for the absence of any major industry therein. The state government offers a 10 year tax holiday as an incentive to new industry.

VISHNU
★ I A S ★

In 2010 Anil, an industrialist decided to take benefits to set up Amria Plastic Works (APW) in Noora village, about 20km from Amria. While the factory was being built, Anil hired the required key labour and got them trained at the skill training centres at Amria. This act of his made the key personnel very loyal to APW.

APW started production in 2011 with the labour drawn fully from Noora village. The villagers were very happy to get employment near their homes and were motivated by the key personnel to meet the production targets with high quality. APW started making large profits, a sizeable portion of which was used to improve the quality of life in Noora. By 2016, Noora could boast of a greener village and a renovated village temple. Anil liaised with the local MLA to increase the frequency of the bus services to Amria. The government also opened a primary health care centre and primary school at Noora in buildings constructed by APW. APW used its CSR funds to set up women's self-help groups, subsidize primary education to the village children and procure an ambulance for use by its employees and the needy.

In 2019, there was a minor fire in APW. It was quickly extinguished as fire safety protocols were in place in the factory. Investigations revealed that the factory had been using electricity in excess of its authorized capacity. This was soon rectified. The next year, due to nationwide lockdown, the requirement of production fell for four months. Anil decided that all employees would be paid regularly. He employed them to plant trees and improve the village habitat.

APW had developed a reputation of high-quality production and a motivated workforce.

Critically analyse the story of APW and state the ethical issues involved. Do you consider APW as a role model for the development of backward areas? Give reasons. (250 words)

2021

1) Sunil is a young civil servant and has a reputation for his competence, integrity, dedication and relentless pursuit of difficult and onerous jobs. Considering his profile, he was picked up by his bosses to handle a very challenging and sensitive assignment. He was posted in a tribal dominated district notorious for illegal sand mining. Excavating sand from river belt and transporting through trucks and selling them in black market was rampant. This illegal sand mining mafia was operating with the support of local functionaries and tribal musclemen who in turn were bribing selected poor tribals and had kept the tribals under fear and intimidation.

Sunil being a sharp and energetic officer immediately grasped the ground realities and the modus operandi followed by the mafia through their devious and dubious mechanism. On making inquiries, he gathered that some of their own office employees are in hand and glove with them and have developed close unholy nexus. Sunil initiated stringent action against them and started conducting raids on their illegal operations of movement of trucks filled with sand. The mafia got rattled as not many officers in the past had taken such steps against the mafia. Some of the office employees who were allegedly close to mafia informed them that the officer is determined to clean up the

mafia's illegal sand mining operations in that the district and may cause them irreparable damage.

The mafia turned hostile and launched counter-offensive. The tribal musclemen and mafias started threatening him with dire consequences. His family (wife and old mother) were stalked and were under virtual surveillance and thus causing mental torture, agony and stress to all of them. The matter assumed serious proportions when a muscleman came to his office and threatened him to stop raids, etc., otherwise, his fate will not be different than some of his predecessors (ten years back one officer was killed by the mafia).

Identify the different options available to Sunil in attending to this situation. Critically evaluate each of the options listed by you.

Which of the above, do you think, would be the most appropriate for Sunil to adopt and why?

2. You are Vice Principal of a degree college in one of the middle – class towns. Principal has recently retired and management is looking for his replacement. There are also feelers that the management may promote you as Principal. In the meantime, during annual examination the flying squad came from the university caught two students red-handed involving in unfair means. A senior lecturer of the college was personally helping these students in this act. This senior lecturer also happens to be close to the management. One of

the students was son of a local politician who was responsible in getting college affiliated to the present reputed university. The second student was son of a local businessman who has donated maximum funds for running of the college. You immediately informed the management regarding this unfortunate incident. The management told you to resolve the issue with flying squad at any cost. They further said that such incident will not only tarnish the image of the college but also the politician and businessman are very important personalities for the functioning of the college. You were also given hint that your further promotion to Principal depends on your capability in resolving this issue with flying squad. In the meantime, you were intimidated by your administrative officer that certain members of the student union are protesting outside the college gate against the senior lecturer and the students involved in this incident and demanding strict action against defaulters.

Discuss the ethical issues involved in the case.

Critically examine the options available with you as Vice Principal. What option will you adopt and why?

General Studies 4:

Ethics and Human Interface- Dimensions of ethics; Ethics in public & private relationships

1. Differentiate 'moral intuition' from 'moral reasoning' with suitable examples. 2023 (10 M)
2. What does this quotations mean to you in the present context: "Falsehood takes the place of truth when it results in unblemished common good."- Tirukkural. (150 words) 2018
3. With regard to the morality of actions, one view is that means is of paramount importance and the other view is that the ends justify the means. Which view do you think is more appropriate? Justify your answer. (150 words)2018
4. The crisis of ethical values in modern times is traced to a narrow perception of the good life. Discuss.2017
5. Without commonly shared and widely entrenched moral values and obligations, neither the law, nor democratic government, nor even the market economy will function properly. What do you understand by this statement? Explain with illustration in the contemporary times.2017
6. Explain how ethics contributes to social and human well-being.2016
7. Law and ethics are considered to be the two tools for controlling human conduct so as to make it conducive to civilized social existence. (a) Discuss how they achieve this objective. (b) Giving examples, show how the two differ in their approaches.2016
8. What is meant by 'environmental ethics? Why is it important to study? Discuss any ne environmental issue from the viewpoint of environmental ethics.2015
9. Differentiate between the following (200 words); a) Law and Ethics; b) Ethical management and Management of ethics; c) Discrimination and Preferential treatment; d) Personal ethics and Professional ethics2015
10. Human beings should always be treated as 'ends' in themselves and never as merely means. Explain the meaning and significance of this statement, giving its implications in the modern techno-economic society.2014
11. What do you understand by 'values' and 'ethics? In what way is it important to be ethical along with being professionally competent?2013
12. Some people feel that values keep changing with time and situation, while others strongly believe that
13. there are certain universal and eternal human values. Give your perception in this regard with due justification.2013
- (a) Identify five ethical traits on which one can plot the performance of a civil servant. Justify their inclusion in the matrix.
- (b) Identify ten essential values that are needed to be an effective public servant. Describe the /ways and means to prevent non-ethical behaviour in the public servants. 2021

Emotional intelligence & Allied Topics

1. "Those who in trouble untroubled are, Will trouble trouble itself." – Thiruvalluvar (Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. "What really matters for success, character, happiness and lifelong achievements is a definite set of emotional skills — your EQ — not just purely cognitive abilities that are measured by conventional IQ tests." Do you agree with this view? Give reasons in support of your answer. 2023 (10 M)
3. What are the main components of emotional intelligence (EI) ? Can they be learned? discuss. (150 words) 2020
4. "Emotional Intelligence is the ability to make your emotions work for you instead of against you." Do you agree with this view? Discuss. (150 words, 10m) 2019
5. What does this quotations mean to you in the present context: Anger and intolerance are the enemies of correct understanding. " _ Mahatma Gandhi. (150 words) 2018
6. words) 2018
7. "In doing a good thing, everything is permitted which is not prohibited expressly or by clear implication". Examine the statement with suitable examples in the context of a public servant discharging his/her duties. (150 words) 2018
8. How will you apply emotional intelligence in administrative practices? 2017
9. Anger is a harmful negative emotion. It is injurious to both personal life and work life. (a) Discuss how it leads to negative emotions and undesirable behaviours. (b) How can it be managed and controlled? 2016
10. All human beings aspire for happiness. Do you agree? What does happiness mean to you? Explain with examples. 2014
11. What is 'emotional intelligence' and how can it be developed in people? How does it help an individual in taking ethical decisions? 2013
12. What do you understand by the term 'voice of conscience'? How do you prepare yourself to heed to the voice of conscience? 2013
13. What is meant by 'crisis of conscience'? Narrate one incident in your life when you are faced with such a crisis and how you resolved the same. 2013

Thinkers and Reformers

1. What are the major teachings of Mahavir? Explain their relevance in the contemporary world. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. Ethics is knowing the difference between what you have the right to do and what is right to do.'-Potter Stewart. 2022 (10 M)
3. "If a country is to be corruption free and become a nation of beautiful minds, I strongly feel there are three key societal members who can make a difference. They are the father, the mother and the teacher." – Abdul Kalam. 2022 (10 M)

4. "Judge your success by what you had to give up in order to get it." - Dalai Lama. 2022 (10 M)
5. "The simplest acts of kindness are by far more powerful than a thousand heads bowing in prayer." – Mahatma Gandhi. 2023 (10 M)
6. "To awaken the people, it is the women who must be awakened. Once she is on the move, the family moves, the village moves, the nation moves."-Jawaharlal Nehru. 2023 (10 M)
7. "Do not hate anybody, because that hatred that comes out from you must, in the long run, come back to you. If you love, that love will come back to you, completing the circle."- Swami Vivekananda. 2023 (10 M)
8. What were the major teachings of Guru Nanak? Explain their relevance in the contemporary world. 2023 (10 M)
9. What teachings of Buddha are most relevant today and why? Discuss. 2020
10. What are the main factors responsible for gender responsibility in India? Discuss the contribution of Savitribai Phule in this regard. 2020
11. "Condemn none: if you can stretch out a helping hand do so. If not fold your hands, bless your brothers and let them go their own way." – Swami Vivekanand 2020
12. "The best way to find yourself is to lose yourself in service of others." Mahatma andhi 2020
13. "A system of morality which is based on relative emotional values is a mere illusion, a thoroughly vulgar conception which has nothing sound in it and nothing true." – Socrates.2020
14. "An unexamined life is not worth living." – Socrates 2019
15. "A man is but the product of his thoughts. What he thinks, he becomes." – .K.Gandhi 2019
16. "Where there is righteousness in the heart, there is beauty in the character. When there is beauty in the character, there is harmony in the home. When there is harmony in the home, there is order in the nation. When there is order in the nation, there is peace in the world." – A.P.J. Abdul alam 2019
17. "Great ambition is the passion of a great character. Those endowed with it may perform very good or very bad acts. All depends on the principles which direct them." – Napoleon Bonaparte. Stating examples mention the rulers (i) who have harmed society and country, (ii) who worked for he development of society and country.2017
18. Discuss Mahatma Gandhi's concept of seven sins.2016
19. Analyse John Rawls's concept of social justice in the Indian context.2016
20. Corruption causes misuse of government treasury, administrative inefficiency and bstruction in the path of national Development. Discuss Kautilya's views.2016
21. Max Weber said that it is not wise to apply to public administration the sort of moral and ethical norms we apply to matters of personal conscience. It is important to realise that the State bureaucracy might possess its own independent bureaucratic morality. Critically analyse this tatement.2016
22. "e weak can never forgive; forgiveness is the attribute of the strong."2015

23. We can easily forgive a child who is afraid of the dark; the real tragedy of life is when men are afraid of the light.2015
24. Which eminent personality has inspired you the most in the context of ethical conduct in life? Give the gist of his/her teachings giving specific examples, describe how you have been able to apply these teachings for your own ethical development.
25. 2014
26. There is enough on this earth for every one's need but for no one's greed. Mahatma andhi.2013
27. Nearly all men can withstand adversity, but if you want to test a man's character, ive him power. —Abraham Lincoln2013
28. I count him braver who overcomes his desires than him who overcomes his enemies. ristotle2013
29. What does each of the following quotations mean to you? 2021
- (a) "Every work has got to pass through hundreds of difficulties before succeeding. hose that persevere will see the light, sooner or later.-Swami Vivekananda
 - (b) "We can never obtain peace in the outer world until and unless we obtain peace within ourselves." – Dalai Lama
 - (c) Life doesn't make any sense without interdependence. We need each other, and he sooner we learn that, it is better for us all." -Erik Erikson word

Attitude

- 1) "The greatest discovery of my generation is that a human being can alter his life by altering his attitudes." – William James (Answer in 150 words)
- 2) Attitude is an important component that goes as input in the elopement of human How to build a suitable needed for a public servant? (Answer in 150 words)
- 3) In case of crisis of conscience does emotional intelligence help to overcome the same without compromising the ethical or moral stand that you are likely to follow? Critically examine.
- 4) A positive attitude is considered to be an essential characteristic of a civil servant who isoften required to function under extreme stress. What contributes a positive attitude in person.?2020
- 5) Young people with ethical conduct are not willing to come forward to join active politics.Suggest steps to motivate them to come forward.2017
- 6) In the context of defence services, 'patriotism' demands readiness to even lay down one'slife in protecting the nation. According to you, what does patriotism imply in everyday civil life? Explain with illustrations and justify your answer.2014
- 7) It is often said that 'politics' and 'ethics' do not go together. What is your opinion in this regard? Justify your answer with illustrations 2013

Role of Family, Society, Educational Institutions in Inculcating Values

- 1)"Education is not an injunction; it is an effective and pervasive tool for all-round

development of an individual and social transformation". Examine the New Education Policy, 2020 (NEP, 2020) in light of the above statement. 2020

2) 'Hatred is destructive of a person's wisdom and conscience that can poison a nation's spirit. Do you agree with this view? Justify your answer. 2020

3) The current internet expansion has instilled a different set of cultural values which are in conflict with traditional values. Discuss. 2020

4) Our attitudes towards life, work, other people and society are generally shaped unconsciously by the family and social surroundings in which we grow up. Some of these unconsciously acquired attitudes and values are often undesirable in the citizens of modern

democratic and egalitarian society. (a) Discuss such undesirable values prevalent in today's educated Indians. (b) How can such undesirable attitudes be changed and socio-ethical values be cultivated in the aspiring and serving civil servants?

5) Social values are more important than economic values. Discuss the above statement with examples in the context of inclusive growth of a nation. 2015

6) The current society is plagued with widespread trust-deficit. What are the consequences of this situation for personal well-being and for societal well-being? What can you do at the personal level to make yourself trustworthy? 2014

7) What factors affect the formation of a person's attitude towards social problems? In our society, contrasting attitudes are prevalent about many social problems. What contrasting attitudes do you notice about the caste system in our society? How do you explain the existence of these contrasting attitudes? 2014

8) We are witnessing increasing instances of sexual violence against women in the country. Despite existing legal provisions against it, the number of such incidences is on the rise.

Suggest some innovative measures to tackle this menace. 2014

Social Influence and Persuasion

1) How could social influence and persuasion contribute to the success of Swatchh Bharat Abhiyan?

Civil Service aptitude & foundational values (integrity, impartiality, non-partisanship, objectivity, dedication to public service)

1. "For any kind of social re-engineering by successfully implementing welfare schemes, a civil servant must use reason and critical thinking in an ethical framework." Justify this

statement with suitable examples. (Answer in 150 words) 2025

2. "Constitutional morality is not a natural sentiment but a product of civil education and adherence of the rule of law." Examine the significance of constitutional morality for public servant highlighting the role in promoting good governance and ensuring accountability in public administration. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
3. Write short notes on the following in 30 words each: 2022 (10 M)
 - i. Constitutional morality
 - ii. Conflict of interest
 - iii. Probity in public life
 - iv. Challenges of digitalization
 - v. Devotion to duty
4. What do you understand by the term 'public servant'? Reflect on the expected role of a public servant. 2019
5. "In looking for people to hire, you look for three qualities: integrity, intelligence and energy. And if they do not have the first, the other two will kill you." – Warren Buffett. What do you understand by this statement in the present-day scenario? Explain. 2018
6. What is meant by public interest? What are the principles and procedures to be followed by the civil servants in public interest? 2018
7. State the three basic values, universal in nature, in the context of civil services and bring out their importance. 2018
8. Examine the relevance of the following in the context of civil service: (a) Transparency (b) Accountability (c) Fairness and justice (d) Courage of conviction (e) Spirit of service. 2017
9. One of the tests of integrity is complete refusal to be compromised. Explain with reference to a real-life example. 2017
10. Conflict of interest in the public sector arises when (a) official duties, (b) public interest, and (c) personal interest are taking priority one above the other. How can this conflict in administration be resolved? Describe with an example. 2017
11. Why should impartiality and non-partisanship be considered as foundational values in public services, especially in the present-day socio-political context? Illustrate your answer with examples. 2016
12. Public servants are likely to confront with the issues of 'Conflict of Interest'. What do you understand by the term 'Conflict of Interest' and how does it manifest in the decision making by public servants? If faced with the conflict-of-interest situation, how would you resolve it? Explain with the help of examples. 2015
13. How do the virtues of trustworthiness and fortitude get manifested in public service? Explain with examples. 2015
14. A mere compliance with law is not enough, the public servant also has to have a well-developed sensibility to ethical issues for effective discharge of duties." Do you agree? Explain with the help of two examples, where (i) an act is ethically right, but not legally and (ii) an act is legally right, but not ethically. 2015
15. Two different kinds of attitudes exhibited by public servants towards their work have been identified as the bureaucratic attitude and the democratic attitude. A) Distinguish between these two terms and write their merits and demerits. B) Is it possible to

balance the two to create a better administration for the faster development of our country?2015

16. What does 'accountability' mean in the context of public service? What measures can be adopted to ensure individual and collective accountability of public servants?2014
17. Integrity without knowledge is weak and useless, but knowledge without integrity is dangerous and dreadful. What do you understand by this statement? Explain your stand with illustrations from the modern context.2014
18. There is a heavy ethical responsibility on the public servants because they occupy positions of power, handle huge amounts of public funds, and their decisions have wide-ranging impact on society and environment. What steps have you taken to improve your ethical competence to handle such responsibility?2014
19. What do you understand by the following terms in the context of public service? (5 terms x 3 marks each: a) Integrity b) Perseverance c) Spirit of service d) Commitment e) Courage of conviction f) Personal opinion 2013
20. Indicate two more attributes which you consider important for public service. Justify your answer. 2013

Work Culture

1. It is said that for an ethical work culture, there must be code of ethics in place in every organisation. To ensure value-based and compliance-based work culture, what suitable measures would you adopt in your work place? (Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. In the context of the work environment, differentiate between 'coercion' and 'undue influence' with suitable examples. 2023 (10 M)
3. Discipline generally implies following the order and subordination. However, it may be counter-productive for the organisation. Discuss.2017
4. Public service values & Ethics in Public Administration; Strengthening of ethical & moral values in governance; Accountability & ethical governance; Philosophical basis of governance and probity
5. what is meant by constitutional morality? How does one uphold constitutional morality?2019
6. What do you understand by probity in governance? Based on your understanding of the term, suggest measures for ensuring probity in government. 2019
7. What do you understand by the term's 'governance', 'good governance' and 'ethical governance'?2016
8. What do you understand by 'probity' in public life? What are the difficulties in practicing
9. it in the present times? How can these difficulties be overcome?2014
10. What does ethics seek to promote in human life? Why is it all the more

important in public administration? 2014

11. The good of an individual is contained in the good of all. What do you understand by this statement? How can this principle be implemented in public life? 2013

Problems, Dilemmas in public administration and public service.

1. Keeping the national security in mind, examine the ethical dilemmas related to controversies over environmental clearance of development projects in ecologically sensitive border areas in the country. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. In the present digital age, social media has revolutionised our way of communication and interaction. However, it has raised several ethical issues and challenges. Describe the key ethical dilemmas in this regard. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
3. Wisdom lies in knowing what to reckon with and what to overlook. An officer being engrossed with the periphery, ignoring the core issues before him, is no rare in the bureaucracy. Do you agree that such preoccupation of an administrator leads to travesty of justice to the cause of effective service delivery and good governance? Critically evaluate. 2022 (10 M)
4. Apart from intellectual competency and moral qualities, empathy and compassion are some of the other vital attributes that facilitate the civil servants to be more competent in tackling the crucial issues or taking critical decisions. Explain with suitable illustrations. 2022 (10 M)
5. Distinguish between laws and rules. Discuss the role of ethics in formulating them. 2020
6. What does this quotations mean to you in the present context: "The true rule, in determining to embrace, or reject anything, is not whether it has any evil in it; but whether it has more evil than good. There are few things wholly evil or wholly good. Almost everything, especially of governmental policy, is an inseparable compound of the two; so that our best judgement of the preponderance between them is continually demanded." Abraham Lincoln. 2018
7. Explain the process of resolving ethical dilemmas in Public Administration. 2018
8. Suppose the Government of India is thinking of constructing a dam in a mountain valley bond by forests and inhabited by ethnic communities. What rational policy should it resort to in dealing with unforeseen contingencies 2018

Codes of Ethics; Codes of Conduct; Laws, rules, regulations, conscience as sources of ethical Guidance

1. "The strength of a society is not in its laws, but in the morality of its people." – Swami Vivekananda (Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. The Rules and Regulations provided to all the civil servants are same, yet there is difference in the performance. Positive minded officers are able to interpret the Rules and Regulations in favor of the case and achieve success, whereas negative minded officers are unable to achieve goals by interpreting the same Rules and Regulations against the case. Discuss with illustrations. 2022 (10 M)
3. It is believed that adherence to ethics in human actions would ensure in smooth functioning of an organization/system. If so, what does ethics seek to promote in human life? How do ethical values assist in the resolution of conflicts faced by him in his day-to-day functioning? 2022 (10 M)
4. Conscience a more reliable guide when compared to laws, rules and regulations in the context of ethical decision-making? Discuss. 2023 (10 M)
5. What are the basic principles of public life? Illustrate any three of these with suitable examples. (150 words, 10m) 2019
6. What is meant by 'crisis of conscience'? How does it manifest itself in the public domain? (150 words, 10m) 2019
7. Distinguish between "Code of ethics" and "Code of conduct" with suitable examples. (150 words) 2018
8. Discuss the Public Services Code as recommended by the 2nd Administrative Reforms Commission. 2016

Citizens Charters; Quality of Service Delivery; Probity in Governance, concept of public service

1. To achieve holistic development goal, a civil servant acts as an enabler and active facilitator of growth rather than a regulator. What specific measures will you suggest to achieve this goal? (Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. What do you understand by term 'good governance'? How far recent initiatives in terms of e-Governance steps taken by the State have helped the beneficiaries? Discuss with suitable examples. 2022 (10 M)
3. Online methodology is being used for day-to-day meetings, institutional approvals in the administration and for teaching and learning in education sector to the extent telemedicine in the health sector is getting popular with the approvals of the competent authority. No doubt it has advantages and disadvantages for both the beneficiaries and system at large. Describe and discuss the ethical issues involved in the use of online method particularly to vulnerable section of society. 2022 (10 M)
4. Probity is essential for an effective system of governance and socio-economic

development.' Discuss. 2023 (10 M)

5. Explain the term social capital. How does it enhance good governance? 2023 (10 M)
6. Explain the basic principles of citizens' charter movement and bring out its importance.
7. (150 words, 10m) 2019

(a) An independent and empowered social audit mechanism is an absolute must in every sphere of public service, including judiciary, to ensure performance, accountability and ethical conduct. Elaborate.

(b) "Integrity is a value that empowers the human being." Justify with suitable illustration.

Challenges of Corruption; Utilization of public funds

1. India is an emerging economic power of the world as it has recently secured the status of fourth largest economy of the world as per IMF projection. However, it has been observed that in some sectors, allocated funds remain either under-utilised or misutilised. What specific measures would you recommend for ensuring accountability in this regard to stop leakages and gaining the status of third largest economy of the world in near future? (Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. Whistle blower, who reports corruption and illegal activities, wrongdoing and misconduct to the concerned authorities, runs the risk of being exposed to grave danger, physical harm and victimization by the vested interests, accused persons and his team. What policy measures would you suggest to strengthen protection mechanism to safeguard the whistle blower? 2022 (10 M)
3. "Corruption is the manifestation of the failure of core values in the society." In your opinion, what measures can be adopted to uplift the core values in the society? 2023 (10 M)
4. Effective utilisation of public funds is crucial to meet development goals. Critically examine the reasons for under-utilization and mis-utilisation of public funds and their implications. (150 words, 10m) 2019
5. "Non-performance of duty by a public servant is a form of corruption" Do you agree with
6. this view? Justify your answer (150 words, 10m) 2019
7. What is meant by conflict of interest? Illustrate with examples, the difference between the actual and potential conflicts of interest. (150 words) 2018
8. "If a country is to be corruption free and become a nation of beautiful minds, I strongly feel there are three key societal members who can make a difference. they are father, the mother and the teacher." – A. P. J. Abdul Kalam. Analyse. 2017
9. It is often said that poverty leads to corruption. However, there is no dearth of

instances where affluent and powerful people indulge in corruption in a big way. What are the basic causes of corruption among people? Support your answer with examples. 2014

Information (sharing & transparency in government); RTI;

1. "One who is devoted to one's duty attains highest perfection in life." Analyse this statement with reference to sense of responsibility and personal fulfilment as a civil servant. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
2. There is a view that the official secrets act is an obstacle to the implementation of the Rights to Information act. Do you agree with the view? Discuss (150 words, 10m) 2019
3. "The Right to Information Act is not all about citizens' empowerment alone, it essentially redefines the concept of accountability. Discuss. (150 words) 2018
4. Some recent developments such as introduction of RTI Act, media and judicial activism, etc., are proving helpful in bringing about greater transparency and accountability in the functioning of the government. However, it is also being observed that at times the mechanisms are misused. Another negative effect is that the officers are now afraid to take
5. prompt decisions. Analyze this situation in detail and suggest how this dichotomy can be resolved. Suggest how these negative impacts can be minimized. 2015
6. Today we find that in spite of various measures like prescribing codes of conduct, setting up vigilance cells/commissions, RTI, active media and strengthening of legal mechanisms, corrupt practices are not coming under control. A) Evaluate the effectiveness of these measures with justifications.
B) Suggest more effective strategies to tackle this menace. 2015

Ethical issues in international relations and funding

1. Carl von Clausewitz once said, "War is a diplomacy by other means." Critically analyse the above statement in the present context of contemporary geo-political conflict. (Answer in 150 words) 2025
 2. Russia and Ukraine war has been going on for the last seven months. Different countries have taken independent stands and actions keeping in view their own national interests. We are all aware that war has its own impact on the different aspects of society, including human tragedy. What are those ethical issues that are crucial to be considered while launching the war and its continuation so far? Illustrate with justification the ethical issues involved in the given state of affair. 2022 (10 M)
- 'International aid' is an accepted form of helping 'resource-challenged nations. Comment on 'ethics in contemporary international aid'. Support your answer with suitable examples. 2023 (10 M)

- (a) "Refugees should not be turned back to the country where they would face persecution or human right violation." Examine the statement with reference to ethical dimension being violated by the nation claiming to be democratic with open society.

- (c) Should impartial and being non-partisan be considered as indispensable qualities to make a successful civil servant? Discuss with illustrations. 2021
5. Discuss the role of ethics and values in enhancing the following three major components of Comprehensive National Power (CNP) viz. human capital, soft power (culture and policies), and social harmony. 2020
6. 'The will to power exists, but it can be tamed and be guided by rationality and principles of moral duty.' Examine this statement in the context of international relations. 2020
7. Strength, peace and security are considered to be the pillars of international relations. Elucidate 2017
8. At the international level, the bilateral relations between most nations are governed on the policy of promoting one's own national interest without any regard for the interest of other nations. This leads to conflicts and tensions between the nations. How can ethical consideration help resolve such tensions? Discuss with specific examples. 2015

Corporate Governance; Ethical concerns and dilemmas in government & private institutions

1. In contemporary world, corporate sector's contribution in generating wealth and employment is increasing. In doing so, they are bringing in unprecedented onslaught on the climate, environmental sustainability and living conditions of human beings. In this background, do you Responsibility (CSR) is efficient and sufficient enough to fulfill the social roles and responsibilities needed in the corporate work mandated? Critically examine. 2022 (10 M)
2. What do you understand by 'moral integrity' and 'professional efficiency' in the context of corporate governance in India? Illustrate with suitable examples. 2023 (10 M)
3. Corporate social responsibility makes companies more profitable and sustainable. Analyse. 2017
4. Increased national wealth did not result in equitable distribution of its benefits. It has created only some "enclaves of modernity and prosperity for a small minority at the cost of the majority." Justify. 2017

- (a) Impact of digital technology as reliable source of input for rational decision making is debatable issue. Critically evaluate with suitable

example.

- (b) Besides domain knowledge, a public official needs innovativeness and creativity of a high order as well, while resolving ethical dilemmas. Discuss with suitable example.

Case Studies

1. You are working as an executive in a nationalized bank for several years. One day one of your close colleagues tells you that her father is suffering from heart disease and needs surgery immediately to survive. She also tells you that she has no insurance and the operation will cost about 10 lakh. You are also aware of the fact that her husband is no more and that she is from a lower middle class family. You are empathetic about her situation. However, apart from expressing your sympathy, you do not have the resources to fund her. A few weeks later, you ask her about the well-being of her father and she informs you about his successful surgery and that he is recovering. She then confides in you that the bank manager was kind enough to facilitate the release of 10 lakh from a dormant account of someone to pay for the operation with a promise that it should be confidential and be repaid at the earliest. She has already started paying it back and will continue to do so until it is all returned.

- (a) What are the ethical issues involved?
(b) Evaluate the behavior of the bank manager from an ethical point of view.
(c) How would you react to the situation? 2023 (20 M)

2. A landslide occurred in the middle of the night on 20th July, 2023 in a remote mountain hamlet, approximately 60 kilometers from Uttarkashi. The landslide was caused by torrential rains and has resulted in large-scale destruction of property and life. You, as District Magistrate of that area, have rushed to the spot with a team of doctors, NGOs, media

and police along with numerous support staff to oversee the rescue operations.

A man came running to you with a request for urgent medical help for his pregnant wife who is in labor and is losing blood. You directed your medical team to examine his wife. They return and convey to you that this woman needs blood transfusion immediately. Upon enquiry, you come to know that a few blood collection bags and blood group test kits are available in the ambulance accompanying your team. Few people of your team have already volunteered to donate blood.

Being a physician who has graduated from AIIMS, you know that blood for transfusion needs to be procured only through a recognized blood bank. Your team members are divided on this issue; some favor transfusion, while some others oppose it. The doctors in the team are ready to facilitate the delivery provided they are not penalized for transfusion. Now you are in a dilemma. Your professional training emphasizes on prioritizing service to humanity and saving lives of individuals.

- (a) What are the ethical issues involved in this case?
(b) Evaluate the options available to you, being District Magistrate of the area. 2023 (20 M)

3. At 9pm on Saturday evening, Rashika, a Joint Secretary, was still engrossed in her work in her office. Her husband, Vikram, is an executive in an MNC and frequently out of town in

connection with his work. Their two children aged 5 and 3 are looked after by their domestic helper. At 9:30 pm her superior, Mr. Suresh calls her and asks her to prepare a detailed note on an important matter to be discussed in a meeting in the Ministry. She realizes that she will have to work on Sunday to finish the additional task given by her superior.

She reflects on how she had looked forward to this posting and had worked long hours for months to achieve it. She had kept the welfare of people uppermost in discharging her duties. She feels that she has not done enough justice to her family and she has not fulfilled her duties in discharging essential social obligations. Even as recently as last month she had to leave her sick child in the nanny's care as she had to work in the office. Now, she feels that she must draw a line, beyond which her personal life should take precedence over her professional responsibilities. She thinks that there should be reasonable limits to the work ethics such as punctuality, hard work, dedication to duty and selfless service.

(a) Discuss the ethical issues involved in this case.

(b) Briefly describe at least four laws that have been enacted by the Government with respect to providing a healthy, safe and equitable working environment for women.

(c) Imagine you are in a similar situation. What suggestions would you make to mitigate such working conditions? 2023 (20 M)

4. Vinod is an honest and sincere IAS officer. Recently, he has taken over as Managing Director of the State Road Transport Corporation, his sixth transfer in the past three years. His peers acknowledge his vast knowledge, affability and uprightness.

The Chairman of the State Road Transport Corporation is a powerful politician and is very close to the Chief Minister. Vinod comes to know about many alleged irregularities of the Corporation and the high-handedness of the Chairman in financial matters.

A Board Member of the Corporation belonging to the Opposition Party meets Vinod and hands over a few documents along with a video recording in which the Chairman appears to be demanding bribe for placing a huge order for the supply of QMR tires. Vinod recollects the Chairman expediting clearing of pending bills of QMR tires.

Vinod confronts the Board Member as to why he is shying away from exposing the Chairman with the so-called solid proof he has with him. The member informs him that the Chairman refuses to yield to his threats. He adds that Vinod may earn recognition and public support if he himself exposes the Chairman. Further, he tells Vinod that once his party comes to power, Vinod's professional growth would be assured.

Vinod is aware that he may be penalized if he exposes the Chairman and may further be transferred to a distant place. He knows that the Opposition Party stands a better chance of coming to power in the forthcoming elections. However, he also realizes that the Board Member is trying to use him for his own political gains.

(a) As a conscientious civil servant, evaluate the options available to Vinod.

(b) In the light of the above case, comment upon the ethical issues that may arise due to the politicization of bureaucracy. 2023 (20 M)

5. You have just been appointed as Additional Director General of Central Public Works Department. The Chief Architect of your division, who is to retire in six months, is

passionately working on a very important project, the successful completion of which would earn him a lasting reputation for the rest of his life.

A new lady architect, Seema, trained at Manchester School of Architecture, UK joined as Senior Architect in your division. During the briefing about the project, Seema made some

suggestions which would not only add value to the project, but would also reduce completion time. This has made the Chief Architect insecure and he is constantly worried that all the credit will go to her. Subsequently, he adopted a passive and aggressive behavior towards her and has become disrespectful to her. Seema felt it embarrassing as the Chief Architect left no chance of humiliating her. He would very often correct her in front of other colleagues and raise his voice while speaking to her. This continuous harassment has resulted in her losing confidence and self-esteem. She felt perpetually tensed, anxious and stressed. She appeared to be in awe of him since he has had a long tenure in the office and has vast experience in the area of her work.

You are aware of her outstanding academic credentials and career record in her previous organizations. However, you fear that this harassment may result in compromising her much needed contribution in this important project and may adversely impact her emotional well-being. You have also come to know from her peers that she is contemplating tendering her resignation.

(a) What are the ethical issues involved in the above case?

(b) What are the options available to you in order to complete the project as well as to retain Seema in the organization?

(c) What would be your response to Seema's predicament? What measures would you institute to prevent such occurrences from happening in your organization? 2023 (20 M)

6. You hold a responsible position in a ministry in the government. One day in the morning you received a call from the school of your 11-year-old son that you are required to come and meet the Principal. You proceed to the school and find your son in the Principal's office. The Principal informs you that your son had been found wandering aimlessly in the grounds during the time classes were in progress. The class teacher further informs you that your son has lately become a loner and did not respond to questions in the class, he had also been unable to perform well in the football trials held recently. You bring your son back from the school and in the evening, you along with your wife try to find out the reasons for your son's changed behavior. After repeated cajoling, your son shares that some children had been making fun of him in the class as well as in the WhatsApp group of the students by calling him stunted, duh and a frog. He tells you the names of a few children who are the main culprits but pleads with you to let the matter rest.

After a few days, during a sporting event, where you and your wife have gone to watch your son play, one of your colleague's son shows you a video in which students have caricatured your son. Further, he also points out to the perpetrators who were sitting in the stands. You purposefully walk past them with your son and go home. Next day, you find on social media, a video denigrating you, your son and even your wife, stating that you engaged in physical bullying of children on the sports field. The video became viral on social media. Your friends and colleagues began calling you to find out the details. One of your juniors advised you to

make a counter video giving the background and explaining that nothing had happened on the field. You, in turn posted a video which you have captured during the sporting event, identifying the likely perpetrators who were responsible for your son's predicament. You have also narrated what has actually happened in the field and made attempts to bring out the adverse effects of the misuse of social media.

(a) Based on the above case study, discuss the ethical issues involved in the use of social media.

(b) Discuss the pros and cons of using social media by you to put across the facts to counter the fake propaganda against your family. 2023 (20 M)

7. Prabhat was working as Vice President (Marketing) at Sterling Electric Ltd., a reputed multinational company. But presently the company was passing through the difficult times as the sales were continuously showing downward trend in the last two quarters. His division, which hitherto had been a major revenue contributor to the company's financial health, was now desperately trying to procure some big government order for them. But their best efforts did not yield any positive success or breakthrough.

His was a professional company and his local bosses were under pressure from their London-based HO to show some positive results. In the last performance review meeting taken by the Executive Director (India Head), he was reprimanded for his poor performance. He assured them that his division is working on a special contract from the Ministry of Defense for a secret installation near Gwalior and tender is being submitted shortly.

He was under extreme pressure and he was deeply perturbed. What aggravated the situation further was a warning from the top that if the deal is not clinched in favor of the company, his division might have to be closed and he may have to quit his lucrative job.

There was another dimension which was causing him deep mental torture and agony. This pertained to his personal precarious financial health. He was a single earner in the family with two school-college going children and his old ailing mother. The heavy expenditure on education and medical was causing a big strain to his monthly pay packet. Regular EMI for housing loan taken from bank unavoidable and any default would render him liable for severe legal action.

In the above backdrop, he was hoping for some miracle to happen. There was sudden turn of events. His Secretary informed that a gentleman Subhas Verma wanted to see him as he was interested in the position of Manager which was to be filled by him in the company. He further brought to his notice that his CV has been received through the office of the Minister of Defense.

During interview of the candidate-Subhash Verma, he found him technically sound, resourceful and experienced marketer. He seemed to be well-conversant with tendering procedures and having knack of follow-up and liaising in this regard Prabhat felt that he was better choice than the rest of the candidates who were recently interviewed by him in the last few days.

Subhash Verma also indicated that he was in possession of the copies of the bid documents that the Unique Electronics Ltd. would be submitting the next day to the Defense Ministry for their tender. He offered to hand over those documents subject to his employment in the company on suitable terms and conditions. He made it clear that in the process, the Sterling

Electric Ltd. could outbid their rival company and get the bid and hefty Defense Ministry order. He indicated that it will be win-win situation for both-him and the company.

Prabhat was absolutely stunned. It was a mixed feeling of shock and thrill. He was uncomfortable and perspiring. If accepted, all his problems would vanish instantly and he may be rewarded for securing the much awaited tender and thereby boosting company's sales and financial health. He was in a fix as to the future course of action. He was wonder-struck at the guts of Subhash Verma in having surreptitiously removing his own company papers and offering to the rival company for a job. Being an experienced person, he was examining the pros and cons of the proposal/situation and he asked him to come the next day.

(a) Discuss the ethical issues involved in the case.

(b) Critically examine the options available to Prabhat in the above situation.

(c) Which of the above would be the most appropriate for Prabhat and why?

8. Ramesh is State Civil Services Officer who got the opportunity of getting posted to the capital of a border State after rendering 20 years of service. Ramesh's mother has recently been detected cancer and has been admitted in the leading cancer hospital of the city. His two adolescent children have also got admission in one of the best public schools of the town. After settling down in his appointment as Director in the Home Department of the State, Ramesh got confidential report through intelligence sources that illegal migrants are infiltrating in the State from the neighboring country. He decided to personally carry out surprise check of the border posts along with his Home Department team. To his surprise, he caught red-handed two families of 12 members infiltrated with the connivance of the security personnel at the border posts. On further inquiry and investigation, it was found that after the migrants from neighboring country infiltrate, their documentation like Aadhaar Card, Ration Card and Voter Card are also forged and they are made to settle down in a particular area of the State. Ramesh prepared the detailed and comprehensive report and submitted to the Additional Secretary of the State. However, he has summoned by the Additional Home Secretary after a week and was instructed to withdraw the report. The Additional Home Secretary informed Ramesh that the report submitted by him has not been appreciated by the higher authorities. He further cautioned him that if he fails to withdraw the confidential report, he will not only be posted out from the prestigious appointment from the State capital but his further promotion which is due in near future will also get in jeopardy.

(a) What are the options available to Ramesh as the Director of the Home Department of the bordering State?

(b) What option should Ramesh adopt and why?

(c) Critically evaluate each of the options.

(d) What are the ethical dilemmas being faced by Ramesh?

(e) What policy measures would you suggest to combat the menace of infiltration of illegal migrants from the neighboring country?

9. The Supreme Court has banned mining in the Aravalli Hills to stop degradation the forest cover and to maintain ecological balance. However, the stone mining is still prevalent in the border district of the affected State with connivance of certain corrupt forest officials and

politicians. Young and dynamic SP who was recently posted in the affected district promised to himself to stop this menace. In one of his surprise checks with his team, he found loaded truck with stone trying to escape the mining area. He tried to stop the truck but the truck driver overran the police officer, killing him on the spot and thereafter managed to flee. Police filed FIR but no breakthrough was achieved in the case for almost three months. Ashok who was the Investigative Journalist working with leading TV channel, suo moto started investigating the case. Within one month, Ashok got breakthrough by interacting with local people, stone mining mafia and government officials. He prepared his investigative story and presented to the CMD of the TV channel. He exposed in his investigative report the complete nexus of stone mafia working with blessing of corrupt police and civil officials and politicians. The politician who was involved in the mafia was no one else but local MLA who was considered to be very close to the Chief Minister. After going through the investigative report, the CMD advised Ashok to drop the idea of making the story public through electronic media. He informed that the local MLA was not only the relative of the owner of the TV channel but also had unofficially 20 percent share in the channel. The CMD further informed Ashok that his further promotion and hike in pay will be taken care of in addition the soft loan of 10 lakhs which he has taken from the TV channel for his son's chronic disease will be suitably adjusted if he hands over the investigative report to him.

- (a) What are the options available with Ashok to cope up with the situation?
- (b) Critically evaluate/examine each of the options identified by Ashok.
- (c) What are the ethical dilemmas being faced by Ashok?
- (d) Which of the options, do you think, would be the most appropriate for Ashok to adopt and why?
- (e) In the above scenario, what type of training would you suggest for police officers posted to such districts where stone mining illegal activities are rampant?

10. You have done MBA from a reputed institution three years back but could not get campus placement due to COVID-19 generated recession. However, after a lot of persuasion and series of competitive tests including written and interview, you managed to get a job in a leading shoe company. You have aged parents who are dependent and staying with you. You also recently got married after getting this decent job. You were allotted the Inspection Section which is responsible for clearing the final product. In first one year, you learnt your job well and was appreciated for your performance by the management. The company is

doing good business for last five years in domestic market and this year it is decided even to export to Europe and Gulf countries. However, one large consignment to Europe was rejected by their Inspecting Team due to certain poor quality and was sent back. The top management ordered that ibid consignment to be cleared for the domestic market. As a part of Inspecting Team, you observed the glaring poor quality and brought to the knowledge of the Team Commander. However, the top management advised all the members of the team to overlook these defects as the management cannot bear such a huge loss. Rest of the team members except you promptly signed and cleared the consignment for domestic market,

overlooking glaring defects. You again brought to the knowledge of the Team Commander that such consignment, if cleared even for domestic market, will tarnish the image and reputation of the company and will be counter-productive in the long run. However, you were further advised by the top management that if you do not clear the consignment, the company will not hesitate to terminate your services citing certain innocuous reasons.

(a) Under the given conditions, what are the options available to you as a member of the Inspecting Team?

(b) Critically evaluate each of the options listed by you.

(c) What option would you adopt and why?

(d) What are the ethical dilemmas being faced by you?

(e) What can be the consequences of overlooking the observations raised by the Inspecting Team?

11. Rakesh was working as a Joint Commissioner in Transport department of a city. As a part of his job profile, among others, he was entrusted with the task of overseeing the control and functioning of City Transport Department. A case strike by drivers' union of City Transport Department over the issue of compensation to a driver who died on duty while driving the bus came up before him for decision in the matter.

He gathered that the driver (deceased) was plying Bus No. 528 which passed through busy and congested roads of the city. It so happened that near an intersection on the way, there was an accident involving the middle-aged man. It was found that there was altercation between the driver and the car driver. Heated arguments between them led to fight and the driver gave him a blow. Lot of passengers had gathered and tried to intervene but without success. Eventually, both of them were badly injured and profusely bleeding and were taken to the nearby hospital. The driver succumbed to the injuries and could not be saved. The middle-aged driver's condition was also critical but after a day, he recovered and was discharged. Police had immediately come to the spot and FIR was registered. Police investigation revealed that the quarrel was started by the bus driver and he had resorted to physical violence. There exchange of blows between them.

The City Transport Department management is considering of not giving any extra compensation to the driver's (deceased) family. The family is very aggrieved, depressed and agitated against the discriminatory and non-sympathetic approach of the City Transport Department management. The bus driver (deceased) was 52 years of age, was survived by his wife and two school-college going daughters. He was the sole earner of the family. The City Transport Department workers' union took up this case and when found no favorable response from the management, decided to go on strike. The union's demand was twofold.

First was full extra compensation as given to other drivers who died on duty and secondly employment to one family member. The strike has continued for 10 days and the deadlock remains.

(a) What are the options available to Rakesh to meet the above situation?

(b) Critically examine each of the options identified by Rakesh

(c) What are the ethical dilemmas being faced by Rakesh?

(d) What course of action would Rakesh adopt to diffuse the above situation?

12. You are appointed as an officer heading the section in Environment Pollution Control Board to ensure compliance and it's follow-up. In that region, there were large number of small and medium industries which had been granted clearance. You learnt that these industries provide employment to many migrant worker. Most of the industrial units have got environmental clearance certificate in their possession. The environmental clearance seeks to curb industries and projects that supposedly hamper environment and living species in the region, but in practice, most of these units remain to be polluting units in several ways like air, water and soil pollution. As such, local people encountered persistent health problems.

It was confirmed that majority of the industries were violating environmental compliance. You issued notice to all the industrial units to apply for fresh environmental clearance certificate from the competent authority. However, your action met with hostile response

from a section of the industrial units, other vested interest persons and a section of the local politicians. The workers also became hostile to you as they felt that your action would lead to the closure of these industrial units, and the resultant unemployment will lead to insecurity uncertainty in their livelihood. Many owners of the industries approached you with the plea that you should not initiate harsh action as it would compel them their units, and cause huge financial loss, shortage of their products in the market. These would obviously add to the sufferings of the laborers and the consumers alike. The labor union also sent you representation requesting against the closure of the units. You simultaneously started receiving threats from unknown corners. You however received supports from some of your colleagues, who advised you to act freely to ensure environmental compliance. Local NGOs also came to your support and they demanded the closure of the polluting units immediately.

- (a) What are the options available to you under the given situation?
- (b) Critically examine the options listed by you.
- (c) What type of mechanism would you suggest to ensure environmental compliance?
- (d) What are the ethical dilemmas you faced in exercising your option?